

Survival 72+

The guide on paper – for when there is no power, internet or battery

Keep one copy in your bag, one in the car and one by the door. Read it ONCE now, calmly – in a crisis you won't have time.

112

European emergency number – free, no SIM needed

Version v37 · 14/11/2026
The app (free, works offline): georgiosbarbaris-creator.github.io/hull-steel-toolkit/survival/

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Powered by Overland's Habit Creator

These instructions are general information and do not replace 112, the official authorities or first-aid training.

✂️ Pocket card – cut, fold, always carry it

112

Works **without a SIM**, on any network, and by **SMS**. Say: WHAT happened – WHERE you are – HOW MANY. Don't hang up first.

Ambulance **166** · Fire **199** · Police **100** · Coast Guard **108** · Poison centre **+30 210 779 3777**

🪪 My details

Name:

Blood type: · Allergies:

Medicines:

Emergency contacts:

Meeting point:

🏚️ Earthquake

DROP – COVER – HOLD ON under a strong table. Away from glass. No lift, no stairs while shaking. After: out to open space, check the gas.

🔥 Fire

Home: get out LOW, close doors behind you, 112. Wildfire: leave EARLY, not uphill, against the wind. Trapped: on already burnt or bare ground, wet cloth over your mouth.

🌊 Flood

Go HIGH, never basements. NEVER drive or walk through moving water – 30 cm of water can sweep a car away. Switch off power if safe.

❤️ CPR

Unresponsive, not breathing normally → 112, ask for a defibrillator. **30 compressions** centre of chest, 5–6 cm deep, **100–120/min** («Stayin' Alive»). If trained: 2 breaths. DON'T stop.

🩸 Bleeding

Press HARD and steadily with a cloth for 10 minutes without peeking. Spurting from an arm/leg that won't stop: tourniquet 5–7 cm above the wound, write the time.

🫁 Choking

Can cough → keep coughing. Cannot → **5 back blows**, **5 abdominal thrusts** (Heimlich), alternate. Unconscious → 112 + CPR.

🛌 Recovery position

Unconscious but breathing: on their side, top leg bent, head tilted back, mouth downwards. Keep checking breathing.

🆘 SOS

··· — — — ··· · 3 of anything = distress
Ground: **V** help · **X** doctor · **N** no · **Y** yes
Rule of 3: 3 min without air · 3 h without warmth (cold) · 3 days without water · 3 weeks without food.

💧 Water

3–4 litres per person per day. Boil 1 minute. Or 2 drops of plain unscented bleach per litre, wait 30 minutes.

☢️ Chemical / nuclear

GET in – STAY in – TUNE in (radio). Close doors, windows, air-con. Bag your outer clothes, wash.

🪪 My family plan

Emergency contacts

Out-of-town contact person

Meeting point near home

Meeting point outside town

Where to shut off gas / water / power

Name

Blood type

Allergies

Medicines I take

Health notes

Other notes

Family members – school / work

Pets – vet

📞 Emergency numbers (Greece)

112	European emergency number Works without a SIM, on any network, and by SMS
166	EKAB – Ambulance
199	Fire Service
100	Police
108	Coast Guard Sea, shipwreck, person overboard
15900	SOS line for violence against women 24 hours, free, all year round
210 779 3777	Poison Centre 24 hours – medicines, chemicals, mushrooms, snakes
1056	The Smile of the Child Child in danger / missing
197	Social Help (EKKA)
1018	Suicide prevention helpline Klimaka – 24 hours
116000	Missing children European line – 24 hours
11188	Cyber Crime Division (scams, hacking)

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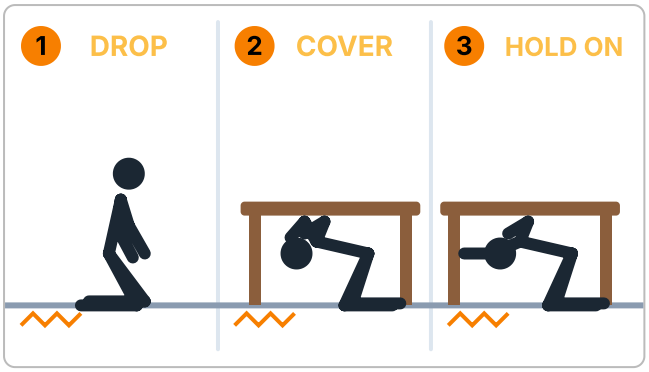
📡 **Signals – SOS – Morse**

🚨 What is happening now?

🏚️ Earthquake

Drop – Cover – Hold on

NOW, while it is shaking



1 Drop to your knees · 2 Cover head and neck under a strong table · 3 Hold on to the table leg until it stops.

1. DROP to your knees, so the quake does not knock you down.
2. COVER your head and neck. Get under a strong table or desk.
3. HOLD ON to the table leg until the shaking stops.
4. If there is no table: sit next to an inside wall, away from glass, and cover your head with your arms.

⚠ DO NOT run outside during the quake. Most people are hurt by falling objects.

⚠ DO NOT use the lift. DO NOT stand on stairs or a balcony.

If you are in bed

- Stay there. Turn face down and cover your head with the pillow.

If you are outside

- Go to an open space, away from buildings, poles, power lines and trees.
- Drop down and cover your head.

If you are driving

- Slow down and stop in a safe place. Not under bridges, poles or power lines.
- Stay in the car with your seat belt on until it stops.

As soon as it stops

1. Check that you and the people with you are OK.
2. Put on shoes (broken glass!).
3. Turn off the gas/LPG and the main power switch if there is damage or a smell.
4. Take the emergency backpack and leave CALMLY by the stairs.
5. Go to your area's assembly point (an open space).
6. Listen to the radio and the 112 messages.

⚠ Smell of gas? DO NOT turn on lights, lighters or switches. Open the windows and get out.

⚠ Expect aftershocks. Do not go back into a building with cracks until an engineer checks it.

If you are trapped under rubble

1. Do not light a fire or a match.
2. Cover your mouth and nose with cloth against the dust.
3. Tap on a pipe or wall (3 taps, pause) or blow a whistle.
4. Shout only when you hear rescuers – save your strength.
5. Do not move without need, do not raise dust.

Near the sea?

⚠ If the quake was strong or lasted long and you are on the coast: go to high ground AT ONCE. See "Tsunami".

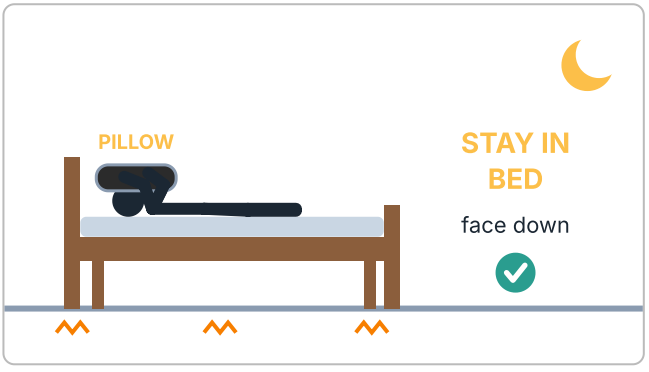
💡 Get ready: fix wardrobes and bookcases to the wall, heavy things low, no pictures above the bed.

💡 Teach children "Drop-Cover-Hold on" and practise 2 times a year.

🌙 Earthquake at night

In the dark, woken from sleep

While the ground is shaking



In bed: stay there, turn face down and cover your head and neck with the pillow.

1. If you are in bed: STAY there. Turn face down and cover your head and neck with the pillow.
2. If there is a heavy light fitting, shelf or picture above the bed: get down on the floor next to the bed, “DROP – COVER – HOLD ON”.
3. DO NOT run in the dark: broken glass, fallen furniture, stairs.

As soon as it stops



When it stops: 1 put shoes on first (broken glass) · 2 use a torch – NO lighter, match or candle.

1. Shoes FIRST (keep them next to the bed).
2. Flashlight – NOT a lighter, match or candle (there may be a gas leak).
3. Call out everyone’s name. Go to the children first.
4. Smell gas? Do not touch switches, open the windows, close the gas bottle or the main valve, get out.
5. Leave calmly by the stairs – NEVER the lift. Take your backpack, warm clothes, a blanket.
6. Go to the assembly point or an open area, away from buildings, poles, power lines.

⚠ Expect aftershocks. Do not go back inside if the building has cracks, until an engineer has checked it.

Prepare the bedroom TONIGHT

- ☐ Shoes, flashlight, glasses, mobile phone next to the bed (in a small bag tied to the bed leg)
- ☐ Whistle on the bedside table
- ☐ Nothing heavy above the bed (pictures, shelves, unsecured air conditioner)
- ☐ Bed away from large windows
- ☐ Wardrobes and bookcases fixed to the wall
- ☐ Outdoor clothes on a chair (so you do not go out in pyjamas in the cold)

🧱 Trapped under rubble

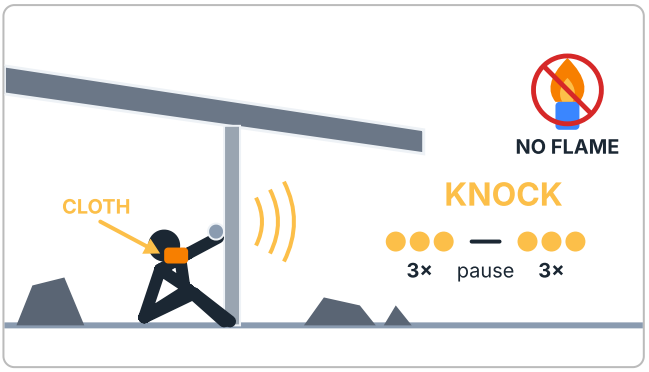
How they find you and how you hold on

💡 Rescuers search for DAYS. Many people come out alive after 3, 5 or even more days. Your job is to hold on and to be heard.

Right away

1. DO NOT light a fire, match or lighter – gas and dust can catch fire.
2. Cover your nose and mouth with cloth or a T-shirt (dust).
3. Move as little as possible, so you do not raise dust or bring down more debris. Do not pull on beams that hold things up.
4. Check yourself for bleeding – press hard with cloth.

Make them hear you



Cloth over nose and mouth. Tap a pipe or column: 3 knocks, pause, 3 again. No flame (gas, dust).

1. TAP on a pipe, column or wall: 3 taps, pause, 3 again. Sound travels far through concrete and metal.
2. Whistle: 3 blasts, pause, again.
3. SHOUT only when you hear rescuers nearby. Shouting tires you and makes you breathe in dust.
4. When you hear rescuers call for “silence” (they stop the machines to listen): then tap or shout.

Your mobile phone

- If it has signal: 112 – say exactly where you are (floor, room, who else is with you). If the call does not go through, send an SMS to 112 or to your family.
- Then low-power mode, low brightness. Turn the signal on for a short time every 30–60 minutes. Use its flashlight only briefly.

Hold on

- Whatever water you have, drink it little by little but regularly.
- Keep your body warm: any cloth you find, underneath you and on top.
- Keep your mind busy: count, pray, think of your loved ones, talk to others who are trapped. Tell yourself: “They are looking for me. They will find me.”

- Sleep when you can – but tap again when you wake up.

🏃 Evacuation in 10 minutes

What to grab and in what order



The order: people and shoes → go-bag, medicines, documents → water and warm clothes → leave.

💡 When they say "leave", people lose minutes looking for things. Learn this order NOW and stick it inside the wardrobe door.

⚠ If you see fire, water or smoke coming: LEAVE IMMEDIATELY, with whatever you have on you. People first. Things can be replaced.

Minute 0–1: People

- ☐ Everyone together: children, elderly people, pets (lead / carrier)
- ☐ Shoes on everyone
- ☐ Mobile phone

Minute 1–3: What cannot be replaced

- ☐ 72-hour backpack (ready by the door)
- ☐ Daily MEDICINES + prescriptions, glasses, hearing aids, dentures
- ☐ Document folder (ID cards, passports, insurance, contracts)
- ☐ House and car keys, wallet, cash
- ☐ Chargers and powerbank

Minute 3–5: Life away from home

- ☐ Water (bottles)
- ☐ Warm jacket, change of clothes, blanket
- ☐ Baby supplies / pet food if needed

Minute 5–8: The house (only if there is time)

- ☐ Gas off (bottle / main valve)
- ☐ Flood: power off at the main switch – ONLY with dry hands and feet. Water off
- ☐ Wildfire: windows and doors CLOSED (not locked), curtains away from the glass, flammables away from the house, lights on so the house can be seen in the smoke
- ☐ Note on the door: "We are X people, all OK, gone to ..., date-time"

Minute 8–10: Leave the right way

1. Follow the route given by 112 or Civil Protection – not the "shortest" one.
2. Send an SMS to your out-of-area contact: "We have left, all OK, going to ...".
3. Call out or knock on your neighbours' doors – especially elderly people who live alone.

⚠ DO NOT go back for anything until the authorities say it is safe.

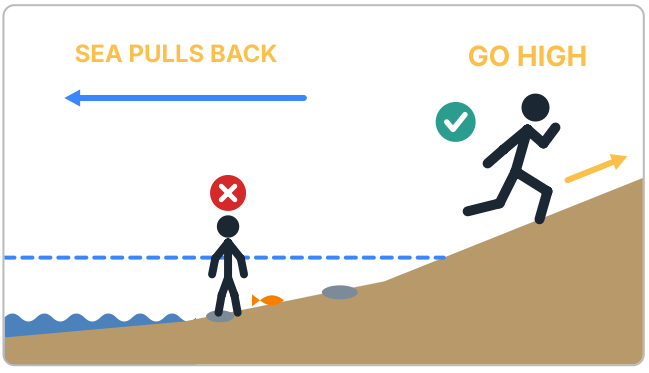
Prepare from today

- Backpack ready, document folder in one place, photos of documents on your phone.
- Do a drill: time your family – can you get out in 10 minutes?
- Car fuel tank always above half, parked facing the exit.

🌊 Tsunami

Go high, right now

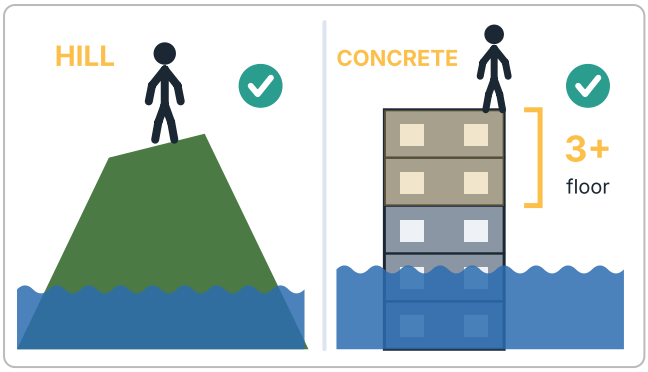
Signs that it is coming



The sea suddenly pulls back and the seabed shows: do NOT go to look. Run uphill at once.

- A strong or long earthquake while you are near the sea.
- The sea suddenly pulls back and the seabed shows.
- A loud roar from the sea.
- A 112 message.

What to do



Go up a hill. If there is no time, climb a strong concrete building, 3rd floor or higher. Stay high for hours.

1. DO NOT wait for instructions. Leave at once.
2. Go to high ground (a hill) or as far from the coast as you can.
3. If there is no time: go up a tall, strong concrete building (3rd floor and above).
4. Go on foot if the roads are blocked.
5. Stay high for hours. Many waves come and the first is often NOT the biggest.

⚠ NEVER go to look at the sea that has pulled back.

If you are on a boat

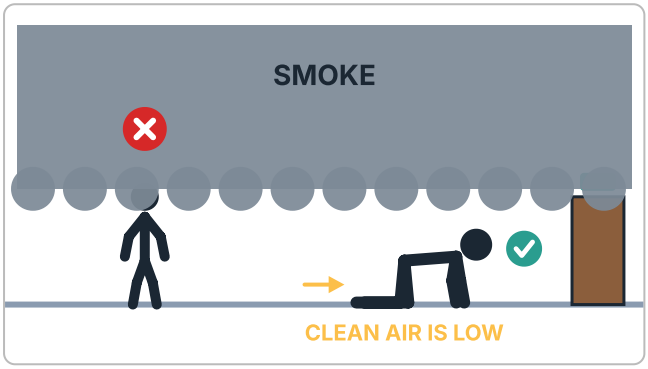
- In deep water (over ~50 m) a tsunami can hardly be seen. If there is time, head out to open sea.
- Inside the harbour: leave the boat and go to high ground on land.

💡 If you live or holiday on a coast: find the nearest hill and the road to it in advance.

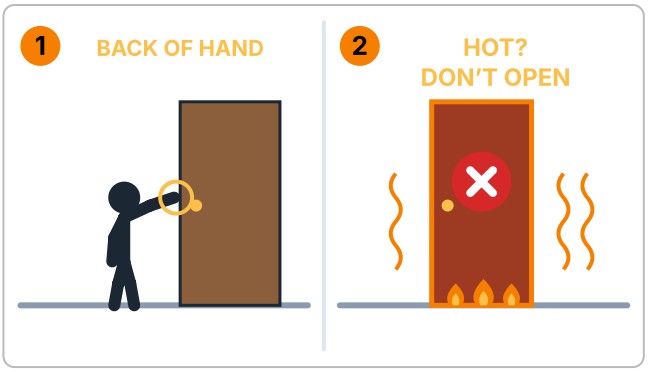
🔥 House fire

Get out, stay out, call 199

What to do



Smoke collects up high. Get down and crawl to the exit – the clean air is low.



Before opening a door, touch it with the back of your hand. If it is hot, do NOT open it – find another way out.

1. Shout "FIRE!" to wake everyone up.
2. Get out at once. Do not collect things.
3. If there is smoke: get low and crawl. Clean air is near the floor.
4. Before you open a door, touch it with the back of your hand. If it is hot, DO NOT open it – find another way out.
5. Close doors behind you. A closed door slows the fire.
6. Outside, call 199 or 112.

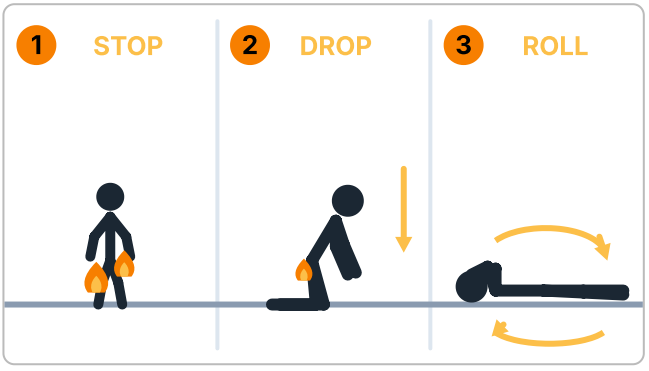
⚠ NEVER go back inside. Not for a pet, not for things.

⚠ DO NOT use the lift.

If you are trapped in a room

1. Close the door and put wet towels in the gaps.
2. Call 112 and say exactly which room and floor you are on.
3. Open the window and signal with a torch or a cloth.

If your clothes catch fire



If your clothes catch fire: 1 STOP (don't run) · 2 DROP to the ground · 3 ROLL with hands over your face.

1. STOP (do not run).
2. DROP to the ground.
3. ROLL and cover your face with your hands.

Small kitchen fire

- Pan with oil: turn off the hob and cover with a lid or a wet towel (wrung out). NEVER water on oil!

- Small fire: fire extinguisher. Pull the pin, aim at the BASE of the fire, squeeze, sweep side to side.

⚠ If the fire does not go out in a few seconds or grows: get out.

💡 Fit a smoke alarm on every floor and a carbon monoxide (CO) alarm near bedrooms. Test them every month.

💡 Keep a 6 kg dry powder fire extinguisher and a fire blanket in the kitchen.

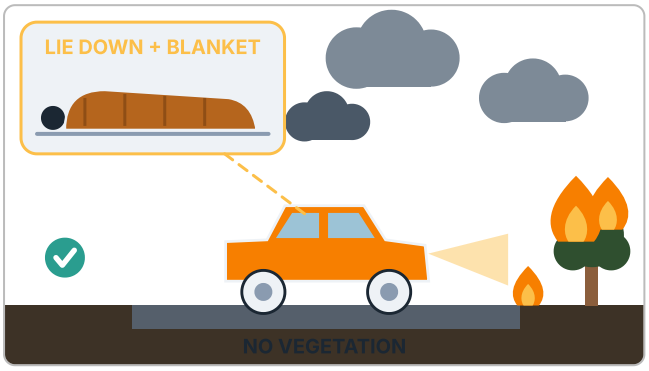
🌲 Wildfire

Leave early – listen to 112

Before it comes

- Leave EARLY when 112 or Civil Protection tells you. The most dangerous moment is a late escape by car through the smoke.
- Take your backpack, medicines, documents, pets.
- Wear cotton or wool clothes that cover the whole body, strong shoes, a wet scarf. NO synthetics (they melt).
- Turn off the gas, move LPG bottles away from the house.

If you are in a car and the fire catches you

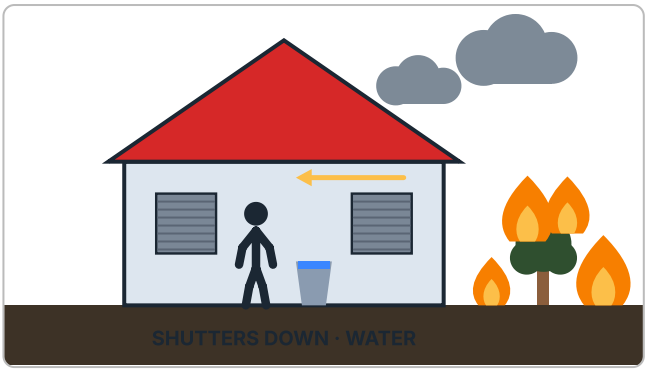


Stop where there is no vegetation, close the windows, lights on. Lie on the car floor under a wool blanket.

1. Stop in a place with no plants (dirt road, asphalt, rocks).
2. Close windows and air vents, turn on the lights, leave the engine running.
3. Lie on the floor of the car and cover yourself with a wool blanket.
4. Stay inside until the fire front passes. The car protects you from the heat.

⚠ DO NOT get out and run through the smoke. Radiant heat kills.

If you are in a house and cannot leave



Stay in a strong house: shutters down, doors and windows shut, water in baths and buckets, in a room away from the fire.

1. Stay inside a strong house (stone, concrete). Close all windows and doors.
2. Lower the shutters, take curtains off the windows.
3. Fill baths and buckets with water, keep wet towels ready.
4. Stay in a room away from the side of the fire.
5. When the fire front has passed, go out and put out small fires around the house.

If you are on foot

- Go to an area that has already burned, a rocky area, or into the sea/water.
- Do not climb uphill – fire goes uphill faster than you.
- Move across the wind direction, not in front of the fire.
- If you are on a beach: go into the water if needed, cover your head with a wet cloth.

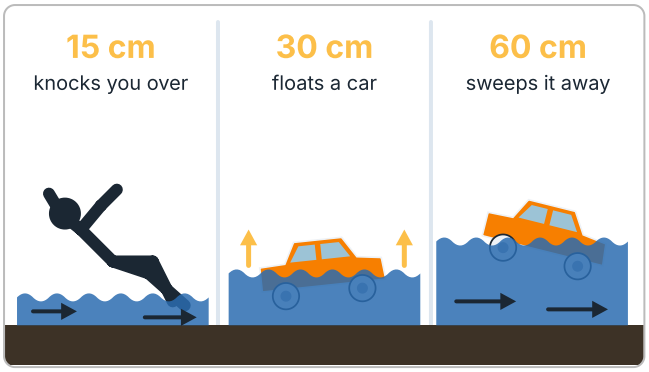
💡 Clear dry grass and branches 10 m around the house before summer.

💡 Keep a garden hose that reaches all around the house, and a pump/generator if you have a well.

🌧️ Flood – storm

Stay out of fast water

What to do



Moving water: 15 cm knocks a person over, 30 cm floats a car, 60 cm sweeps it away. Don't walk or drive in it.

1. Go up high (upper floor, hill). Not into basements.
2. Turn off power and gas if water is coming into the house.
3. Do not walk in moving water. Just 15 cm of fast water can knock a person down.
4. Do not drive on a flooded road. 30 cm of water lifts a car, 60 cm sweeps it away.
5. Keep away from streams, stream bridges, drains.

⚠ The road you know may be washed away under the water. Do not rely on "I drive this way every day".

If you are trapped in the car and the water is rising

1. Take off your seat belt.
2. Open or break the SIDE window (not the windscreen).
3. Get out through the window. Children first.

💡 Keep a window-breaking hammer with a belt cutter in the car.

If the water sweeps you away

- Feet first, pointing downstream, on your back. Grab something fixed. Do not fight against the current.

Lightning

- If you can hear thunder, lightning can reach you. Go into a building or a closed car.
- Not under a lone tree, not on a hilltop, get out of the water.
- If you are outdoors with no cover: crouch on your toes, feet together, hands over your ears. Do not lie down.
- After the last thunder, wait 30 minutes.

After the flood

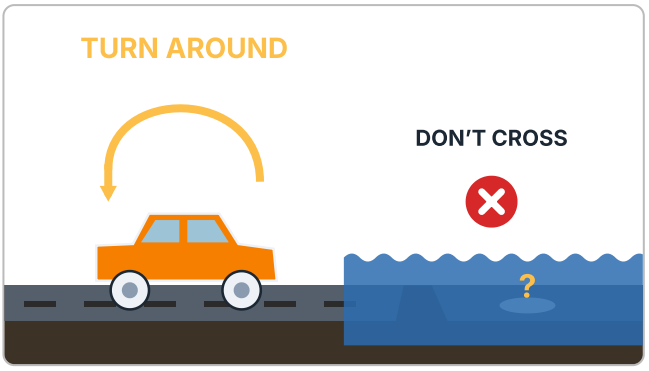
- Do not turn on the power if the wiring got wet. Electrician first.
- Flood water is dirty (sewage). Gloves, boots. Throw away food that got wet.

🌊 Flooded road – car in the water

Turn back – do not drown

⚠ Most flood deaths happen INSIDE CARS that tried to drive through water. NEVER cross a road, stream or underpass with flowing water.

How much water is dangerous



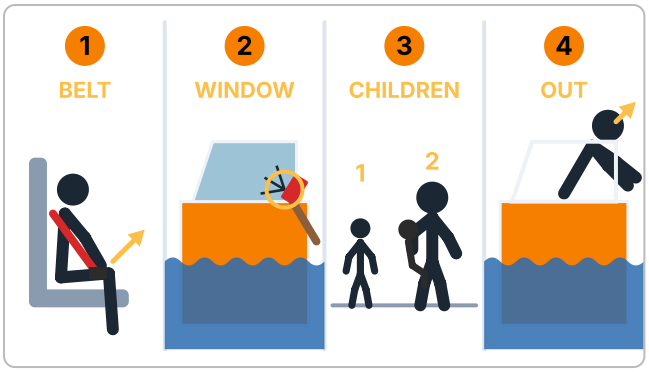
Water on the road? TURN AROUND. You can't tell how deep it is or whether the road is still there.

- 15 cm of flowing water: knocks a person down.
- 30 cm: lifts and sweeps away most cars.
- 60 cm: sweeps away even 4×4s and vans.
- You do not know if the road is still there underneath – water eats away the asphalt. You cannot see open manholes.
- Underpasses: they fill up within a few minutes. They are traps.

What to do

1. You see water on the road: TURN BACK. Look for a higher road, or stop on high ground and wait.
2. Do not park next to streams, dry riverbeds or under bridges.
3. If the car stalls in rising water: get out IMMEDIATELY and go to high ground. Leave the car.

If the car falls or is swept into the water: B-W-C-O



Car in water: 1 unbuckle · 2 open or break the SIDE window (at the corner) · 3 children out before you, older ones first · 4 you get out last, with the small ones.

1. BELT: undo your seat belt at once.
2. WINDOW: open the side window IMMEDIATELY, before the electrics fail. If it does not open, break the side window with a safety hammer or belt cutter (in the corner of the glass). NOT the windscreen – it does not break.
3. CHILDREN: get the children out of the window BEFORE you – the older ones first (so they can help), keep the small ones with you.
4. OUT: you last, with the small ones, through the window, at once. DO NOT wait for it to fill up, do not try to open a door, do not phone first.

💡 Buy a safety hammer with a belt cutter TODAY and keep it where the driver can reach it (not in the glovebox or the back). It costs as much as a coffee.

If you fall into the water

- Lie on your back with your feet first, pointing downstream – so you push obstacles away with your feet.
- Do not fight the current. Swim at an angle towards the bank.
- Hold on to something fixed and shout / whistle for help.

☀️ Heatwave

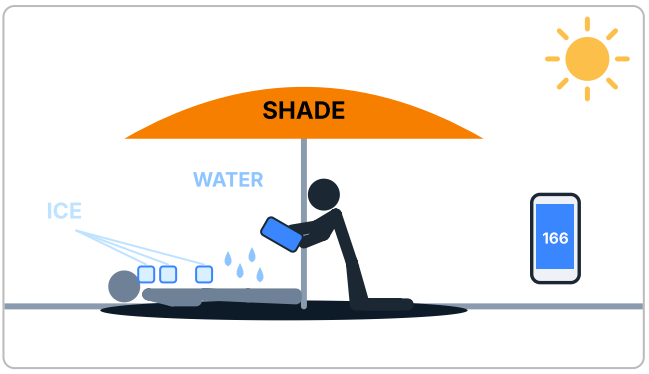
Cool, water, shade

What to do

1. Stay inside 11:00–17:00. Close shutters by day, open them at night.
2. Drink water often, even if you are not thirsty. No alcohol, little coffee.
3. Light, light-coloured, loose clothes, a hat.
4. Cool showers, a wet towel on the neck.
5. If you have no air conditioning: go to a cool place (municipal cooling centres, shopping centre).
6. Call elderly neighbours and relatives every day.

⚠ NEVER leave a child or an animal in a closed car. Not even for 2 minutes.

Heatstroke – URGENT



Heat stroke: call 166/112, move them to shade, wet the whole body and fan, ice on neck, armpits and groin.

- Signs: very hot skin, confusion, strange behaviour, fainting, fits.

1. Call 166 / 112.
2. Move the person to shade/a cool place, take off clothes.
3. Cool them AT ONCE: water all over the body and air, ice on the neck, armpits, groin.
4. If fully awake, give a little cool water to drink.

Heat exhaustion

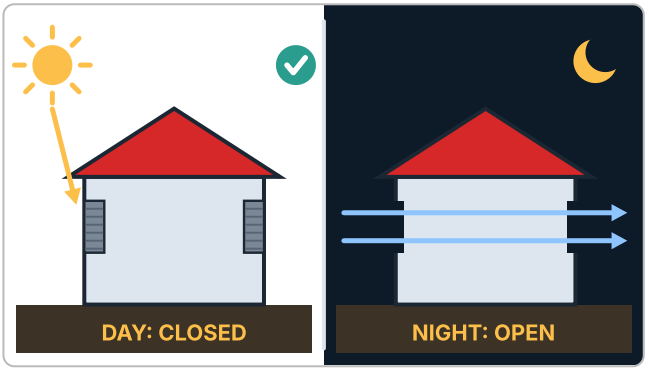
- Dizziness, heavy sweating, headache, nausea, cramps: shade, lie down, water with a little salt/electrolytes. If not better in 30 minutes → doctor.

🥵 Heatwave without power

Staying cool without air conditioning

💡 In a heatwave, elderly people, babies, sick people and those who live alone are at risk first. Call them 2 times a day.

The house



DAY: shutters and curtains closed, keep the sun out. NIGHT: open windows on opposite sides for a cross-breeze.

1. Stay in the coolest room: lower floor, north side, away from the roof.

2. DAYTIME: shutters, curtains, awnings CLOSED. Keep the sun out.
3. NIGHT and early morning: open windows on opposite sides for a draught.
4. A wet sheet hung in the open window or over a battery fan = cool air.
5. Bottles of ice (if you have them) in front of a fan.
6. Switch off anything that heats: oven, lights, appliances.

The body

- Drink water often, before you get thirsty. Light-coloured urine = good. Dark = drink more.
- Lukewarm shower (not ice-cold) or a wet cloth on the neck, armpits, wrists, feet in a basin of water.
- Wet your clothes or a T-shirt and wear it – evaporation cools you.
- Light, loose, light-coloured cotton clothes. A hat outdoors.
- Light meals, fruit, salt if you sweat a lot. NO alcohol, less coffee.
- Go out only early in the morning or late in the afternoon.
- If the house is unbearable: municipal cooling centres, churches, shopping centres, libraries.

Medicines in the heat

- Insulin and some medicines spoil in the heat. Special cooling cases that you soak in water keep insulin cool for days without a fridge.
- Some medicines (diuretics, blood pressure, psychiatric medicines) increase the risk of heatstroke. Ask your doctor in advance.

⚠ NEVER leave a child or animal in a parked car – not even for 2 minutes.

Heatstroke = EMERGENCY

- Signs: very hot skin (dry or sweaty), confusion, delirium, fainting, seizures, vomiting, headache.

1. Call 166 / 112.
2. Move to shade or a cool place, remove clothing.
3. Cool them IMMEDIATELY and aggressively: cold water over the whole body + air (fan, hand fan), wet towels changed constantly, ice on the neck, armpits, groin. If possible, immerse in cold water up to the neck.
4. Give water to drink ONLY if they are fully awake and able to swallow.

❄ Cold – snow – frost

Warmth without danger

At home without heating



Everyone together in ONE small room, layers and a hat, blankets. NEVER a brazier, barbecue or generator indoors – CO kills.

1. Gather the family in ONE room, the smallest one, with few windows.
2. Close the other rooms. Blankets on the windows, towels under the doors.
3. Dress in layers: inner wool/thermal, fleece, outer layer. A hat (you lose a lot of heat from your head), wool socks.
4. Sleep together, with a mat under the mattress/sleeping bag – the cold comes from below. Even better: set up a tent inside the room (see “Home without heating – microclimate”).
5. Hot drinks and food. The body needs “fuel” to warm up.
6. A bottle of hot water (not boiling) inside the sleeping bag.

⚠ NEVER use a charcoal brazier, barbecue, camping gas stove or generator inside the house. Carbon monoxide (CO) has no smell and kills in your sleep.

⚠ Gas/paraffin heater: only with air flow (window slightly open) and never while sleeping.

Hypothermia

- Signs: strong shivering, then the shivering stops (bad sign!), mixed-up speech, sleepiness, clumsiness.

1. Get inside a warm place or out of the wind.
2. Take off wet clothes, put on dry ones.
3. Wrap in blankets, head and neck too. Warm the body core first (chest, neck, groin).
4. A warm sweet drink only if the person is awake and can swallow.
5. Call 166 / 112 for serious hypothermia.

⚠ Handle the person gently. DO NOT rub arms and legs. DO NOT give alcohol.

Frostbite

- White, waxy, numb skin on fingers, nose, ears.
- Warm in lukewarm (not hot) water. Do not rub. Do not rewarm if it may freeze again.

Stuck in a car in the snow

1. Stay in the car. Call 112.
2. Run the engine 10 minutes every hour for heat, with a window slightly open.
3. CLEAR snow from the exhaust before you start the engine (danger of CO).
4. Move arms and legs, use blankets, do not all sleep at once – one stays awake.
5. Tie a red cloth to the aerial.

💡 More details: “Home without heating – microclimate” and “Sleeping in the car”.

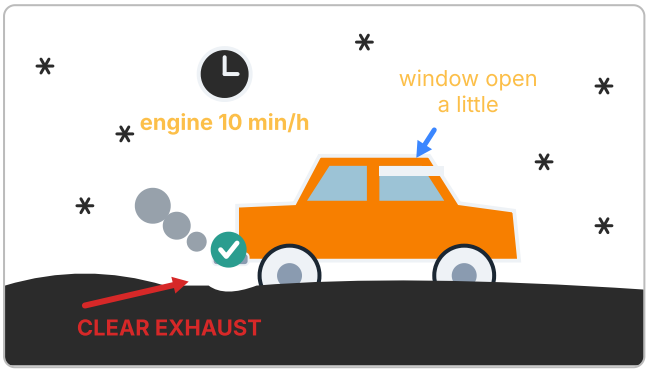
🚗 Car in a snowstorm

Stuck in the snow – what to do

Before you set off

- ☐ Check the forecast and whether the roads are open. If they say “snow chains only” or “avoid travel” – do not go.
- ☐ Full fuel tank, snow chains you know how to fit, car kit, sleeping bag or blankets, water, food, shovel, flashlight
- ☐ Tell someone your route and what time you will arrive

If you get stuck



Stay inside. Clear the exhaust of snow (again every hour), open a window slightly on the side away from the wind, run the engine 10 minutes every hour.

1. STAY IN THE CAR. It is a shelter and can be seen from far away. In a snowstorm you get lost within a few metres.
2. Call 112: give the road, direction, kilometre marker or nearest village, how many people you are. Also send the coordinates from the app’s compass/GPS.
3. Hazard lights on for a short time every now and then. Tie something brightly coloured to the aerial or the window.
4. CLEAR THE EXHAUST of snow – and again every hour.
5. Run the engine 10 minutes every hour for heat, with the window slightly open on the side away from the wind.

⚠ Blocked exhaust = carbon monoxide gets inside and kills in your sleep. If you have a headache, feel dizzy or unusually sleepy: switch off the engine, open the windows.

Stay warm

- Everyone close together, blankets, sleeping bag, foil blanket. Hat, gloves.
- Move inside the car: arms, legs, fingers and toes – for circulation.
- Drink water and eat little by little. DO NOT eat snow – it chills you. Melt it in a bottle inside your jacket or with the heater.
- If there are several of you: sleep in shifts – one person always awake to check the exhaust and heating.
- Go outside ONLY to clear the exhaust, or if you see help or a house very close. Tie a rope to the car if you cannot see.

🏠 Home without heating – microclimate

Your body is the heater

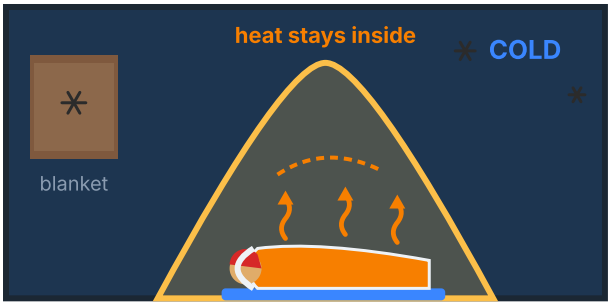
💡 When the power is off for many hours in winter, the house becomes a big fridge. You do not heat the whole house. You heat a SMALL space around your body.

What is a microclimate (in simple words)

- Your body gives off heat all the time, like a small heater (about as much as a 100 W bulb).
- In a big room this heat is lost. In a small closed space (sleeping bag, tent) it stays around you and warms the air.
- The smaller and better insulated the space, the warmer it is. That is why we want a good sleeping bag: so our heat does not “escape”.

- In northern countries (Scandinavia, Canada) people do this when the power goes off: they set up a tent INSIDE the house.

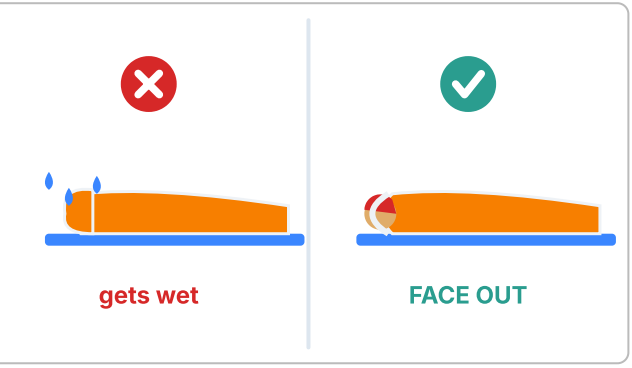
How to set it up – step by step



A tent INSIDE the smallest room. Pad underneath, sleeping bag, face out. Your body heat stays inside the tent.

1. Choose the smallest room, with few windows, if possible an inner room or one facing the sun.
2. Close the other rooms. Blankets on the windows, towels under the doors, curtains closed.
3. SET UP A TENT inside the room (no pegs needed – put weights in the corners). If you have no tent: a "cave" made of a table covered with blankets, or blankets hung around the bed.
4. INSULATION FROM BELOW: never directly on tiles or marble. Rug → mat (foam) → air mattress or mattress → blanket. See "Insulation from below".
5. Inside the tent: a sleeping bag for each person. Sleep close to each other – every person is one more heater.
6. Foil blanket (space blanket) over the tent or under the mat, shiny side in: it sends the heat back.
7. In the daytime: stay in the same room, dressed in layers, with a hat. Get into the sleeping bags even while sitting.

Head OUT of the sleeping bag



Wrong: nose and mouth inside – your breath makes the bag wet. Right: face out, hood pulled tight around it.

⚠ Do not put your nose and mouth inside the sleeping bag. Your breath gives off a lot of moisture that stays in the filling – the sleeping bag gets wet inside and freezes.

- Keep your face out. Wear a hat, pull the hood tight around your face so only a small hole is left for nose and mouth.
- A buff or scarf on your neck if your face is very cold.

Insulation from below

- The ground/floor "sucks" heat away 10 times faster than air. Insulation below is more important than a blanket on top.
- Best: foam mat + air mattress with R-value 4–5+ on top. R-values add up.
- Improvised: cardboard (many layers), rugs, a bed mattress on the floor, sofa cushions, thick folded blankets, polystyrene.
- Foil blanket under the mat: sends heat back and blocks the damp from the floor.

Tricks for a warm sleep

- Eat something fatty/hot before sleep (nuts, chocolate, soup). The body needs "fuel".
- Do 2 minutes of exercise (squats) before getting into the sleeping bag – you go in warm, not cold.
- A bottle of hot (not boiling) water, tightly closed, between your thighs or at your feet.
- Dry wool socks ONLY for sleeping. Not clothes you sweated in.
- Put the next day's clothes inside the sleeping bag – in the morning they are warm.
- Pee before you sleep. Keep a container nearby for the night.

⚠ NEVER use a charcoal brazier, barbecue, gas stove or generator inside the house or inside the tent. Carbon monoxide (CO) – no smell, kills in your sleep. The tent inside the house is only for body heat.

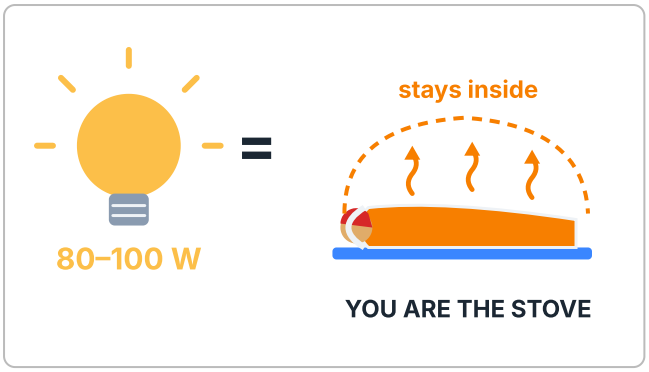
💡 Put a battery CO alarm in the room where you sleep.

🔥 Your body is the stove

How to keep warm without heating

💡 The most important secret about cold: a sleeping bag and a blanket DO NOT make heat. They just KEEP the heat your body makes. You are the stove.

How it works (simply)



Your body gives off heat like an 80–100 W bulb, all night long. The sleeping bag does not heat – it keeps that heat in.

- Lying down, your body gives off heat like an 80–100 W light bulb. All night, without electricity.
- Food is the fuel. Without food the stove goes out.
- Water keeps the stove running. When you are dehydrated you get cold faster.
- Your job: DO NOT lose the heat – from below (the ground), to the air, through wet clothes.

Add "fuel" before sleep

1. Eat something fatty and sweet before lying down: nuts, halva, chocolate, peanut butter, cheese. Fats "burn" slowly, all night.
2. Drink something hot and sweet (tea with honey, cocoa).
3. Do 20–30 squats or push-ups just before getting into the sleeping bag – to warm up, NOT to sweat.
4. Go to the toilet before sleep. The body uses heat to keep a full bladder warm.

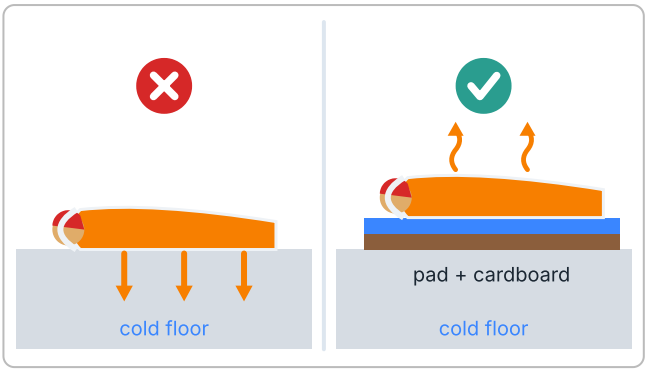
The hot water bottle trick

1. Boil water and fill a metal bottle or a bottle that can take boiling water (e.g. Nalgene). Screw it VERY tight and turn it upside down to check it does not drip.
2. Wrap it in a sock or towel – NEVER bare against the skin.
3. Put it in the sleeping bag 10 minutes before you get in, to warm it up.
4. Then place it between your thighs (large veins pass there and all your blood warms up) or at your feet.

- One litre of boiling water stays warm for 6–8 hours inside the sleeping bag. In the morning you drink it – warm water without lighting a fire.
- A classic rubber hot water bottle does the same job: hot (not boiling) water, squeeze out the air, close it well.
- A thermos flask of boiling water next to the bed: a hot drink during the night and in the morning.

⚠ Babies, small children, elderly people, diabetics: they do not feel burns well. Only a lukewarm bottle, well wrapped, and keep checking.

Do not lose heat



The floor sucks the heat out of you. Put a pad, cardboard or blankets UNDER you – more than you put on top.

- You lose the most FROM BELOW: the floor and the ground "suck out" heat. Sleeping mat, cardboard, blankets UNDER you – more than you put on top.
- Wear a hat in bed too. It covers your head and ears, which lose a lot.
- Dry socks for sleeping, not tight (tightness cuts off blood flow and you get cold).
- Do not breathe inside the sleeping bag: the moisture of your breath makes it damp and it loses its warmth.
- Wet or sweaty clothes = a fridge. Change at once.
- Sleep together, in ONE room. Children in the middle. Each person is a 100 W stove – 4 people = 400 W in a small room.
- Small room, doors closed, blankets or cardboard on the windows, a towel along the gap under the door.

⚠ NO alcohol to warm up. It gives a false feeling of warmth but widens the blood vessels and you lose heat faster.

⚠ NO camping gas heater, brazier, charcoal or barbecue indoors – carbon monoxide kills in your sleep and has no smell.

Hypothermia: when someone is in danger

- Early stage: shivering, cold hands, red nose. Put on dry clothes, give food, a hot sweet drink, movement.

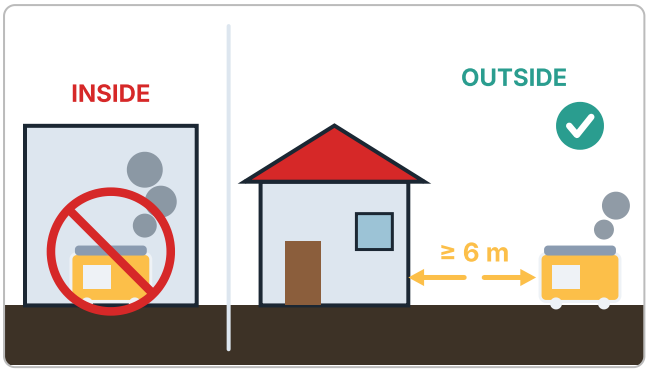
- DANGER: stumbling, slurred speech, cannot do up buttons, irritable or apathetic.

⚠ If they STOP shivering and are confused or drowsy: SEVERE HYPOTHERMIA. Call 112/166. Wrap them up (underneath too), keep them lying flat, handle gently, warm the trunk (armpits, chest) – NO rubbing of arms and legs.

💡 Power cut

Light, fridge, safety

What to do



Generator ONLY outdoors, at least 6 m from doors and windows. Never inside the house, a garage or a closed balcony – carbon monoxide kills.

1. Torches – NOT candles if possible (fires).
2. Unplug sensitive devices (when the power comes back, there is a surge).
3. Leave one light switched on so you know when the power is back.
4. Keep fridge and freezer CLOSED. The fridge keeps cold ~4 hours, a full freezer ~48 hours (half full ~24).
5. Charge phones in the car or with a powerbank. Put the phone on power saving mode.
6. Battery radio for news.

⚠ Generator ONLY outside, away from doors and windows (at least 6 m). Never in a garage or a closed balcony.

⚠ If someone at home needs a medical device that uses power (oxygen etc.): have a plan in advance and tell your power company.

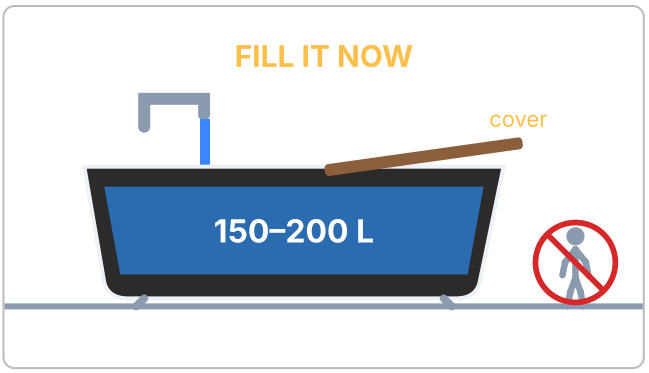
Has the food gone bad?

- If the fridge was above 4 °C for 2+ hours: throw away meat, fish, milk, eggs, cooked food. "When in doubt, throw it out".

💡 Fill the empty space in the freezer with bottles of water. It keeps the cold longer and you have drinking water.

🛁 Water at home: bathtub and hidden stores

Fill up BEFORE the water is cut



As soon as you hear of a disaster or water cut: fill the bathtub at once (150–200 litres) and cover it – drowning risk for small children.

💡 As soon as you hear of an earthquake, war, storm or water cut: FILL THE BATHTUB IMMEDIATELY. The water in the pipes can be cut within a few hours.

How much water a bathtub holds

- Small bathtub (150 × 70 cm): about 120–150 litres.
- Standard bathtub (170 × 70 cm): about 150–200 litres.
- Large or corner bathtub: 250–350 litres.
- To work out yours: length × width × water depth in decimetres (10 cm = 1 dm) × 0.7 (because the sides slope). Example: 16 × 6 × 3.5 × 0.7 ≈ 235 litres.

How many days it lasts

- For DRINKING only (4 litres/person/day): 200 litres = 4 people for 12 days.
- For EVERYTHING (drinking, cooking, washing, toilet ~10–15 litres/person/day): 200 litres = 4 people for 3–5 days. So save water from the first hour.

The right steps

1. Quickly wash the bathtub (without many chemicals) and rinse.
2. Put in the plug and seal over it with cling film or tape – plugs slowly leak. Test this once NOW.
3. Fill to just below the overflow.
4. Cover with plastic sheeting or a board against dust, animals and CHILDREN.
5. Take water with a clean jug – not with your hands in it.

⚠ **A full bathtub = drowning risk for a small child. Keep the bathroom door closed, the tub covered, and supervise.**

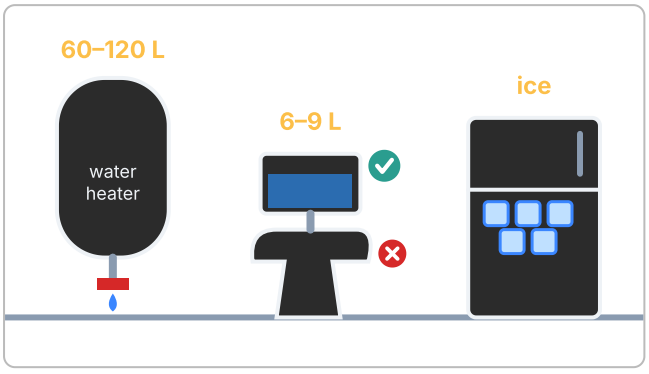
⚠ **Bathtub water is NOT safe to drink. Boil for 1 minute or disinfect (bleach: 2 drops/litre, wait 30 minutes) or filter. Untreated: only for the toilet and washing.**

💡 There are special bathtub water bags (100–400 L) with a tap: they keep the water clean for drinking. Cheap and useful.

ALSO fill these

- ☐ Pots, bottles, jerrycans, buckets – anything with a lid
- ☐ Sinks with the plug in (for washing)
- ☐ Washing machine: run a wash NOW, later you will not be able to

Hidden water stores at home



Hidden water at home: water heater (60–120 L, from the tap at the bottom, power off), toilet cistern (6–9 L, not the bowl), ice from the freezer.

- Electric water heater: 60–120 litres. Switch OFF its power first. Close the supply, open a hot tap to let air in, and drain water from the valve at the bottom. Boil before drinking.
- Solar water heater on the roof: 120–200 litres. A big store we forget about.
- Pipes: close the main valve, open the highest tap to let air in, collect from the lowest: 5–20 litres.
- Toilet cistern (NOT the bowl): 6–9 litres of clean water – if it has no colour tablets/chemicals.
- Ice from the freezer and liquid from canned vegetables/fruit.
- Rainwater from gutters: for washing. For drinking only with a filter + boiling.

⚠ **If the authorities say the mains water is contaminated, DO NOT fill up from the tap – and close the main valve so dirty water does not get into the water heater.**

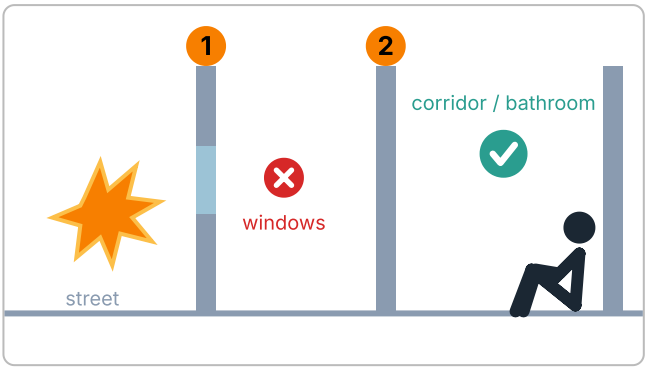
Toilet with little water

- A 4–6 litre bucket poured quickly and sharply into the bowl = a flush. Only for “number two”.
- For “number one”: a rubbish bag inside the bowl + cat litter, sawdust or ash. Tie it up and change it.

War – air raid

Protecting civilians

Siren / air raid warning



The "two walls" rule: go to an inner corridor or bathroom, so there are two walls between you and the street, away from windows.

1. Go at once to a shelter, basement or underground station.
2. If there is no time: an inner room or corridor, low floor, away from windows. The “2 walls” rule: put two walls between you and the street.
3. A bathroom or corridor with no windows is often the best place in a flat.
4. If you are outside: lie face down in a ditch or behind a low wall, hands on your head, mouth slightly open.
5. Stay in the shelter until the all-clear signal.

⚠ **DO NOT go out to look or take photos. DO NOT post videos showing positions or military vehicles on social media – it can help the enemy and put you in danger.**

Preparing the home

- Tape in an X shape on the glass or anti-shatter film, curtains closed.
- Blackout at night if the authorities ask (blankets/black plastic).
- Supplies for 2 weeks: water, food, medicines, batteries, cash.

- A backpack ready by the door for each member.
- Copies of documents (paper + USB), photos of the family members.

If the family gets separated

- Agree in advance on 2 meeting points (one nearby, one outside the city) and a relative far away who will be the “contact centre”.
- For children: a card in the pocket with name, phone numbers, blood group, allergies.

Moving – checkpoints

- Stay calm, hands visible, answer briefly and truthfully. Documents in an easy pocket.
- Move by day, on known roads, follow the official evacuation routes.
- Do not wear camouflage or clothes that look military.

Suspicious objects / ammunition

⚠ DO NOT touch, pick up or kick an unknown metal object, shell, mine or fallen drone.

1. Stop. Go back the way you came, in your own footsteps.
2. Mark the spot from a distance (stones, cloth).
3. Report to 100 / 112.
4. Teach children: “I don't touch, I go away, I tell a grown-up”.

Drones

- If you hear a drone close by: go into a building or under trees/cover, do not look up and do not run into open ground.

💡 Find out now where the nearest shelters and basements are in your neighbourhood, at work and at your children's school.

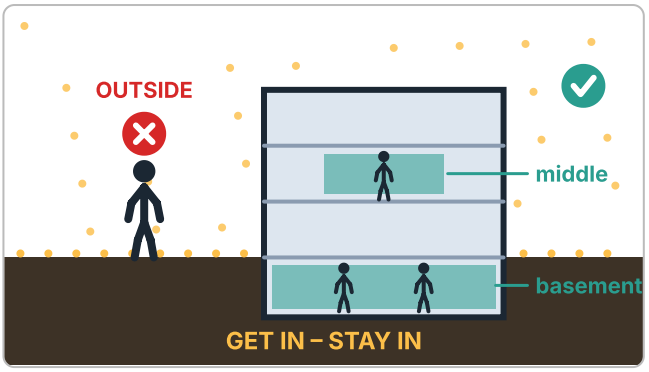
☢ Nuclear explosion – radiation

Get inside – Stay inside – Stay tuned

If you see a flash / explosion

1. DO NOT look at the flash.
2. Drop face down behind anything that protects you, cover your head and put your hands under your body.
3. Stay down until the blast wave passes (it may come seconds or even minutes later).

After: the radioactive dust (fallout)



Get into a solid concrete or brick building. Go to the basement or the MIDDLE, away from the roof and outer walls. Outside is the most dangerous place.

- The dangerous dust falls within 10–30 minutes. You have a little time to get into a good building.

1. GET INSIDE the strongest building you can find (concrete, brick).
2. Go to the basement or the MIDDLE of the building, away from outer walls and the roof. In a block of flats: the middle floors in the centre are good.
3. Close doors, windows, air conditioning, ventilation.
4. STAY INSIDE at least 24 hours, unless the authorities say otherwise. Radiation drops fast: after 7 hours ~10 times less, after 2 days ~100 times less.
5. STAY TUNED to a battery radio and 112.

⚠ Do not get into a car to leave unless you are told to. A car does not protect from radiation.

Decontamination (if you were outside)



1 Take off your outer clothes before going in and put them in a tied bag. 2 Shower with soap and shampoo, without hard scrubbing.

1. Before you enter the clean space, take off your outer clothes – this removes most of the dust.
2. Put them in a plastic bag, tied, away from people.
3. Shower with soap and shampoo. NO conditioner (it sticks the dust to the hair). Do not scrub hard.
4. If there is no shower: wipe face, hands, hair with a wet cloth. Blow your nose, clean ears and eyelashes.
5. Clean clothes from a closed wardrobe.

Food and water

- Food in sealed packs and water in sealed bottles are safe. Wipe the outside before you open them.
- Do not eat fruit/vegetables from the garden or milk from local animals without instructions from the authorities.

Potassium iodide (KI)

⚠ ONLY when the authorities say so. It protects ONLY the thyroid from radioactive iodine. It does not protect from anything else. Do not take it "just in case". Never take iodine antiseptic (Betadine) by mouth.

Accident at a nuclear power plant (e.g. in a nearby country)

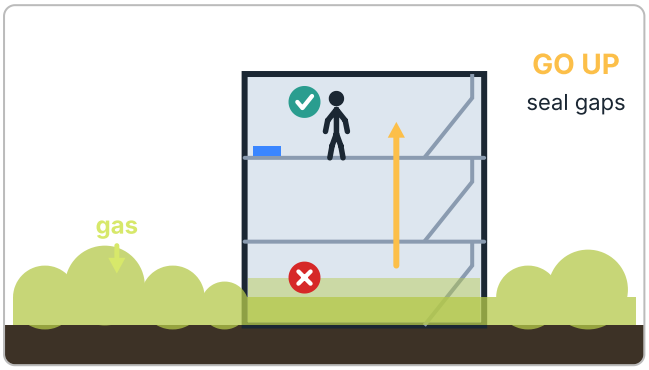
- Usually there is time. Follow the instructions: stay inside, windows closed, stay informed. Do not panic.

💡 A battery or wind-up radio is the most important tool here. Also keep water/food for 3–14 days inside.

☣ Chemical – toxic cloud

Inside, sealed, up high

What to do



Most chemical gases are heavy and collect low down. Go to a room HIGH up and seal the gaps with wet towels or plastic and tape.

1. Get inside a building at once. Close doors, windows, fireplace.
2. Turn off air conditioning, ventilation, cooker hood.
3. Go to a room HIGH UP (most chemical gases are heavy and collect low down – the OPPOSITE of radiation).
4. Seal gaps with wet towels or plastic sheet and tape.
5. Listen to the radio/112. Go out only when the authorities say so.

If you are outside

- Move away across the wind direction, towards higher ground. Cover nose and mouth with a wet cloth.
- Keep away from the cloud, the smell, liquids on the ground.

If you were exposed

1. Take off your clothes (cut them off instead of pulling them over your head).
2. Rinse with plenty of water and soap.
3. Eyes: rinse with clean water for 15 minutes.
4. Call 166 and the Poison Centre 210 7793777.

⚠ An FFP2/FFP3 mask filters dust, NOT gases. Do not think a simple mask protects you from chemical gas.

Gas leak at home

- Do not turn switches on/off, do not ring the doorbell. Close the valve, open windows, get out, call 199 from outside.

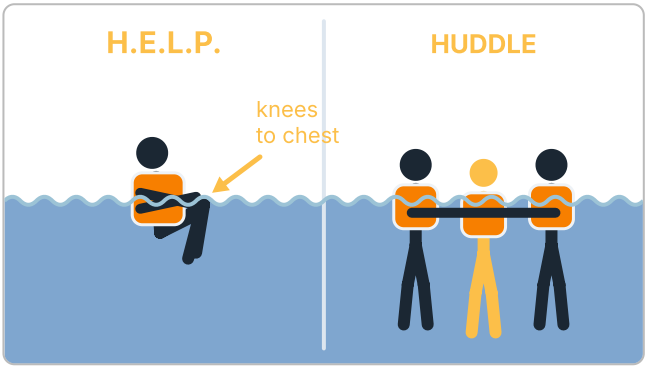
⚓ Shipwreck – man overboard

Lifejacket, warmth, being found

Before you abandon ship

1. Put on a lifejacket and warm clothes – as many as possible, they keep heat even when wet.
2. Take the grab bag, EPIRB, SART, portable VHF, water, medicines.
3. Send MAYDAY (VHF Ch16 / DSC) with your position.
4. Get into the liferaft directly if you can, without getting wet. If you must jump: from low down, arms crossed over the lifejacket, hold your nose, feet together, look ahead.

In the water



H.E.L.P. position: knees to chest, arms tight around the body, wearing a lifejacket. With others: a tight huddle, children and injured in the middle.

- First minute: cold water shock – do not panic, control your breathing (1-10-1 rule: 1 minute to breathe, 10 minutes of useful movement, ~1 hour before hypothermia in cold water).
- Do not swim without need. H.E.L.P. position: knees to chest, arms tight around the body.
- With others: a tight circle (huddle), children/injured in the middle.
- Climb onto anything that floats – less body in the water = less heat loss.

In the liferaft

1. Cut the painter, get clear of the ship, stream the sea anchor (drogue).
2. Pick up other survivors, close the entrance, dry the floor.
3. Take seasickness medicine AT ONCE (vomiting = losing water).
4. Activate EPIRB/SART. Set lookout watches.
5. NO water in the first 24 hours (except the injured), then ~0.5 litre/person/day. Collect rainwater.

⚠ NEVER seawater, NEVER urine. Without water, do not eat.

- Flares ONLY when you see/hear a ship or aircraft. Signal mirror by day.

Man overboard (MOB) from a boat

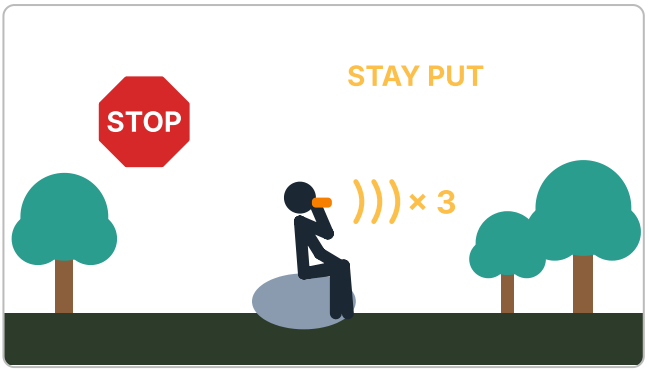
1. Shout “Man overboard – starboard/port!”.
2. Throw a lifebuoy/light buoy at once.
3. ONE person only keeps watching and pointing with the arm all the time.
4. Press MOB on the GPS. Call VHF/112/108 Coast Guard.

💡 Coast Guard phone: 108. At sea, 112 also works where there is signal.

🧭 Lost in the wild

STOP – Think – Observe – Plan

The STOP rule



STOP: stop, sit down, drink water. Usually the best plan is to stay put and let them find you. Blow a whistle 3 times so they can hear you.

1. STOP. Sit down. Drink water. Panic kills more than the cold.
2. THINK: where did I come from? How many hours of light do I have? What do I have with me?
3. OBSERVE: roads, sounds of cars, streams, peaks, power poles.
4. PLAN: Usually the best thing is to STAY WHERE YOU ARE and let them find you.

What to do

- Call 112 (it works on any network). Send your coordinates from the app's Compass.
- Save battery: turn off mobile data, screen brightness low, turn on the phone once an hour.
- Make yourself visible: bright clothes in an open spot, whistle 3 times, smoke by day, light at night.
- Before dark: build a shelter from the wind, with insulation from the ground (branches, leaves). See “Shelter”.
- If you decide to move: follow a stream or path DOWNHILL – but watch out for cliffs and waterfalls. Leave marks behind you.

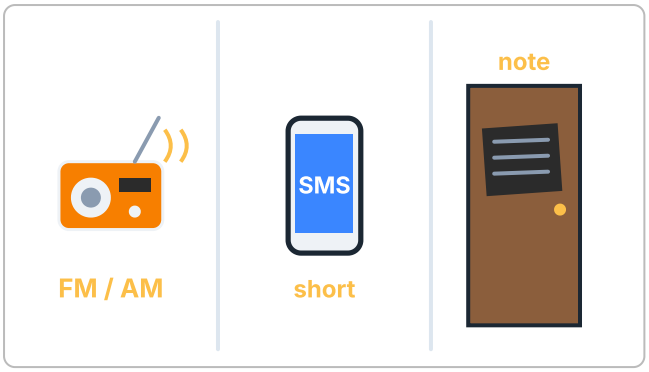
⚠ Do not walk at night. Do not enter a gorge if you do not know where it comes out.

💡 Always tell someone where you are going and when you will be back.

📻 No internet and no phone

How to get news and stay in touch

What to do



Battery or crank radio for announcements. A short SMS when calls do not go through. A note on the door: who, when, where you went.

- Battery or wind-up FM/AM radio: ERT (Greek public radio) broadcasts emergency announcements.
- SMS often gets through when calls do not. Keep it short.
- 112 works even without a SIM card or on another network.
- An agreed meeting place and time (e.g. “every day at 12:00 in the square”).
- A note on the door: who, when they left, where they went.
- Radio amateurs (ham radio) help in big disasters.

💡 Write the phone numbers you need on paper. Nobody remembers phone numbers any more.

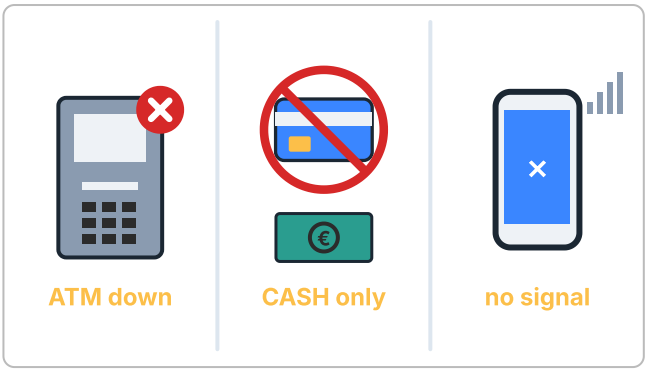
💻 Cyberattack

No banks, cards or internet – and lots of scams

What it is (in plain words)

- Someone "breaks into" the computers that run electricity, water, banks, phones or hospitals – or gets into your own phone and accounts.
- The European Union asks every household to manage 72 hours on its own. A cyberattack is one of the main reasons.
- Two kinds: (a) a BIG attack on infrastructure = like a power or bank outage for everyone. (b) An attack on YOU = stolen money, passwords, phone.

Signs that a big attack is happening



Signs of a big attack: ATMs and cards don't work, "cash only" everywhere, phone with no signal or internet.

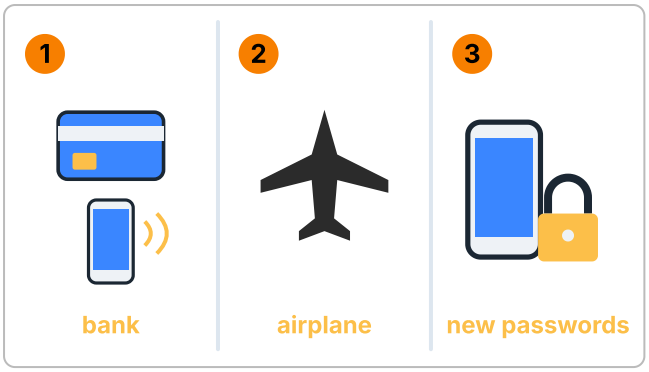
- ATMs and cards don't work, banking apps are "down".
- Petrol stations, supermarkets and pharmacies take cash only.
- Internet, mobile network or power drop in many areas at once, with no bad weather.
- A flood of scary messages, videos and "leaks" on social media. Many are fake – on purpose.

Big attack: what I do NOW

1. Stay calm. Treat it like a power cut – see also the cards "Power cut" and "No internet and no phone".
2. Get news ONLY from official sources: battery radio (ERT), 112 messages, civilprotection.gov.gr. Not from forwarded messages.
3. DON'T forward anything you haven't checked. Disinformation is part of the attack – it wants panic.
4. Use the cash from your bag only for essentials. Don't empty the shelves.
5. Phone charged and on power saving. Calls only for emergencies – 112 first.
6. At ATMs and in queues, watch out for "helpful strangers" who want to see your card or PIN.
7. Never enter passwords on pages someone sent you "to check if you were affected".

⚠ In every crisis scams multiply: fake SMS "from gov.gr, 112, the power company, your bank, a courier", fake benefits, fake charities.

I've been hacked – what to do, in order

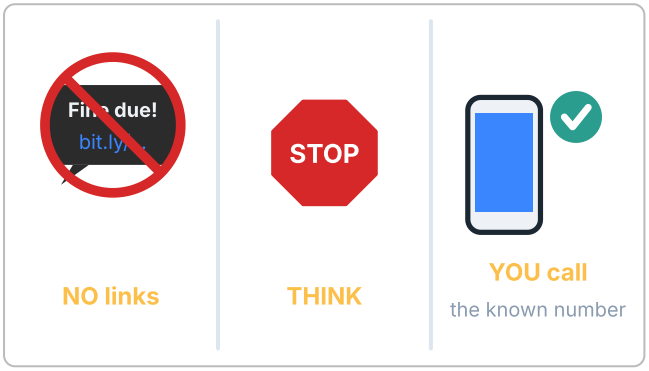


Hacked: 1) call your bank, 2) airplane mode, 3) new passwords from another, clean device.

1. Your bank AT ONCE: call the number on the back of your card and ask to block the card and transactions. Every minute counts.
2. Disconnect the device from the internet (airplane mode, Wi-Fi off). Don't switch it off – it holds evidence.
3. From ANOTHER, clean device change passwords: email first, then the bank, then the rest. A different password for each.
4. Turn on 2FA (two-step verification) and tap "sign out of all devices".
5. If your phone suddenly says "No service" while the area has signal: call your mobile provider at once. It may be a SIM swap – they steal your number to receive your bank codes.
6. Screenshots of messages, amounts, times, numbers. Don't delete anything.
7. Report it to the Cyber Crime Division: 11188 (24 hours, free) or ccu@cybercrimeunit.gov.gr.
8. Warn friends and family: "If you get a money request from my phone or Viber, it's not me."

⚠ If they demand a ransom (ransomware: "we locked your files – pay"), DON'T pay. You get no guarantee. Report it and restore from your backup.

The 5 golden rules against scams



STOP – THINK – CHECK. Don't tap links in SMS. Hang up and call the number you know yourself.

- STOP – THINK – CHECK. Hurry is their weapon. Anything that "expires in 1 hour" is suspicious.
- Banks, police and the state NEVER ask for passwords, PINs or the one-time code (OTP) you got by SMS. Never.
- Public bodies don't send SMS with a link to pay a fine or give card details. Go to the official site or app yourself.
- Hang up and call back YOURSELF, on the number you know (back of the card, official site) – not the one they gave you.
- NEVER install an app because someone on the phone told you to (AnyDesk, TeamViewer, a "security app"). You'd be handing them your phone.

⚠ A voice that sounds like your child or parent ("I lost my phone, send money") may be made with AI. Hang up, call the known number or ask for the family's secret word.

Preparation – do it TODAY

- ☐ Cash for 72 hours in small notes and coins, split up (home, bag, car).
- ☐ Paper list of key phone numbers: family, doctor, bank (fraud line), mobile provider, 11188.
- ☐ A family secret word for emergencies – say it only face to face, never in a message.
- ☐ Automatic updates on phone, computer and router.
- ☐ A strong, different password for every account: a phrase of 4+ words or a password manager.
- ☐ 2FA on email, bank and social media – better with an authenticator app or passkey than SMS.
- ☐ Screen lock with PIN or fingerprint, and a PIN on the SIM card.
- ☐ Ask your mobile provider for protection against SIM change and number porting without being there in person.
- ☐ Backup 3-2-1: 3 copies, on 2 different media, 1 away from home. The external drive stays UNPLUGGED when not in use.
- ☐ Photos of your documents kept offline too (see the "Documents" list and the app's vault).
- ☐ Maps of your area downloaded offline on the phone – plus one paper map.
- ☐ Router: change the admin password and the Wi-Fi password from the factory ones. Same for cameras and "smart" devices.
- ☐ Bank alerts on for every transaction, and a low daily limit for online purchases.
- ☐ Talk to parents and grandparents about phone scams – they are the first target.

☐ Car tank above half – in an attack, petrol stations may not take cards.

💡 To children: "If someone online asks you for photos, passwords, or to keep it from your parents, tell us straight away. We won't be angry."

💡 On public Wi-Fi (café, airport) don't log into your bank. Use your phone's mobile data.

🚩 Assembly points – what to do

When and how to go, what happens there

💡 Assembly point = an open, safe space set by your municipality / Civil Protection: square, sports ground, park, schoolyard. Away from buildings, power poles and cables.

Before – today

1. On mysafetyplan.gov.gr find the nearest point to your home, work and the children's school.
2. Walk the route once. How long does it take? Are there narrow streets, tall buildings, cables? Find a 2nd route too.
3. Save the point in the app's 🧭 Compass – it guides you even without internet.
4. Agree with your family: "If we get separated, we meet THERE". And a 2nd point outside the area (e.g. a relative's house).
5. Write them in 🪪 "My card" and on a note in your wallet.

When to go

- NOT while it is shaking: Drop – Cover – Hold on. Go out when it stops.
- After a strong earthquake, if the building is damaged (cracks, broken glass, gas smell) or you do not feel safe.
- When a 112 message, Civil Protection, the municipality or the police say so.

⚠ Tsunami: NOT to a point by the sea – go HIGH and away from the coast. Fire / flood: follow the 112 evacuation route – it may be a different point.

How to go

1. Take the 🎒 bag, keys, phone, medicines, shoes. Turn off gas and power if you can.
2. Stairs – NOT the lift.
3. ON FOOT. Cars block the roads for ambulances and fire engines.
4. Walk in the middle of the street, away from façades, balconies, glass, poles and cables. Watch for aftershocks.
5. Help elderly, disabled people and children in the neighbourhood. Take pets on a lead / in a carrier.

There

1. Tell the people in charge (Civil Protection, municipality, volunteers) who you are and who is missing from your family.
2. There they give information, water, first aid and instructions on where you will stay.
3. Send ✅ "I am OK" by SMS – it gets through when calls do not.
4. Stay until you are told. DO NOT go home if the building is damaged, before an engineer checks it.

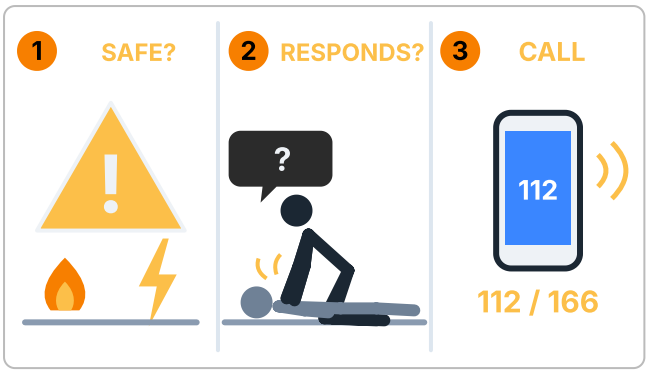
Children at school

- Schools have their own plan: teachers take children to the yard or the school's point. Find out beforehand which it is.
- Do not rush to the school by car – go on foot when it is safe, and collect your child from the teacher.

🩹 First aid

🆘 First things first

Safety – Check – Call



1 Is it safe to approach? · 2 Tap the shoulders gently and ask loudly "Are you OK?" · 3 Call 112 or 166 on speaker.

1. SAFETY: Is it safe to approach? (fire, electricity, traffic, collapse). If not, do not become a victim too.
2. RESPONDING? Tap the shoulders gently and ask loudly "Are you OK?".
3. BREATHING? Tilt the head back, lift the chin, look-listen-feel for 10 seconds.
4. CALL 112 or 166. Put the phone on speaker and do what they tell you.
5. Not breathing normally → CPR right away ("CPR" button).
6. Breathing but not responding → Recovery position (on the side).
7. Heavy bleeding → Press on it right away.

What to say to 112 / 166

- WHERE you are (address or coordinates from the "Compass").
- WHAT happened. HOW MANY injured. Whether they are BREATHING.
- Your phone number. DO NOT hang up first.

🫁 Panic attack – psychological first aid

For someone else and for yourself

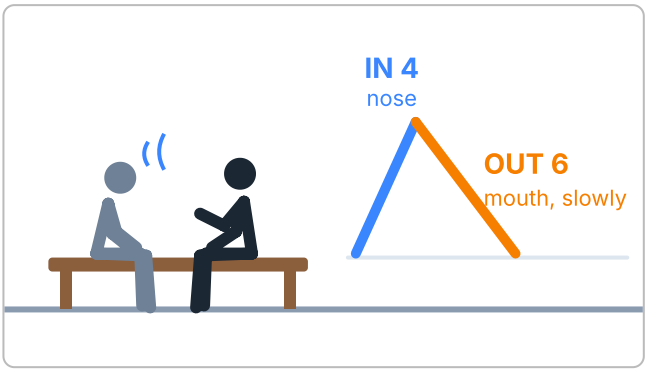
💡 In disasters most people are not injured in the body – they are hurt in the mind. A calm person beside them is the first aid.

How to recognise a panic attack

- Sudden, very intense fear. Pounding heart, breathlessness, "I can't get enough air", chest tightness, dizziness, numbness in hands or lips, trembling, sweating, "I'm going to die" or "I'm going crazy".
- It peaks within about 10 minutes and then eases. It is very frightening but is NOT dangerous in itself.

⚠ It may be the HEART and not panic: first time, over 40 years old, pain spreading to the arm, jaw or back, cold sweat, not passing within 15–20 minutes, known heart disease or asthma. If in DOUBT: 166 / 112. Better an unnecessary call.

Helping someone having a panic attack



Sit with them, at their level, and breathe together: IN through the nose counting 4, OUT through the mouth slowly counting 6.

1. Stay calm. Panic is "contagious" – and so is calm. Speak slowly and softly.
2. Take them to a quieter place, away from crowds and noise. Get down to their level.
3. Say simply: "I am here. You are safe. This is a panic attack, it will pass in a few minutes. Breathe with me."
4. Breathe with them: IN through the nose counting 4 ... OUT through the mouth slowly counting 6. The long EXHALE calms the heart. You count out loud.
5. Grounding 5-4-3-2-1: "Tell me 5 things you see, 4 you can touch, 3 you hear, 2 you smell, 1 you taste." It brings the mind back to the present.
6. Give them something to hold: a cool bottle of water, a wet towel on the face, feet firmly on the floor.
7. Stay with them until it passes. Then water and rest.

- DO NOT say "calm down", "it's nothing", "stop it". It does not help and causes shame.

- DO NOT put a paper bag over their mouth. It is outdated advice and can cause harm – especially if it turns out to be the heart or asthma.

If it happens to me

1. Tell yourself: "This is panic. I have had it before or I know about it. It will pass. Nothing will happen to me."
2. Sit down or lean against a wall. Feet on the floor.
3. Breathe 4 in – 6 out, for 2–3 minutes. Or "box breathing": 4 in, hold 4, 4 out, hold 4.
4. Grounding 5-4-3-2-1 on your own, or count objects around you.
5. Do not run away if you are safe – the wave passes faster when you do not fight it.

Psychological first aid after a disaster

- LOOK: is the area safe? Who is injured, who is in shock, who is alone?
- LISTEN: approach, introduce yourself, ask what they need. Listen without pressing them to talk. Silent presence beside them is also help.
- LINK: water, blanket, food, a phone to find their family, accurate information. Do not promise what you do not know ("they will surely be found").
- Give them a small task if they can: holding the flashlight, handing out water. They feel in control of something again.
- Crying, anger, numbness, sleeplessness, nightmares in the first days are NORMAL after something frightening.

Children

- Keep them TOGETHER with their parents. Hugs, holding hands, close by.
- Explain simply and truthfully: "There was an earthquake. Now we are safe. The grown-ups are taking care of things."
- Let them play, draw, ask the same questions again and again – that is how they "digest" it.
- Turn off the TV showing images of the disaster. Keep routine as much as possible: meals, sleep, bedtime story.

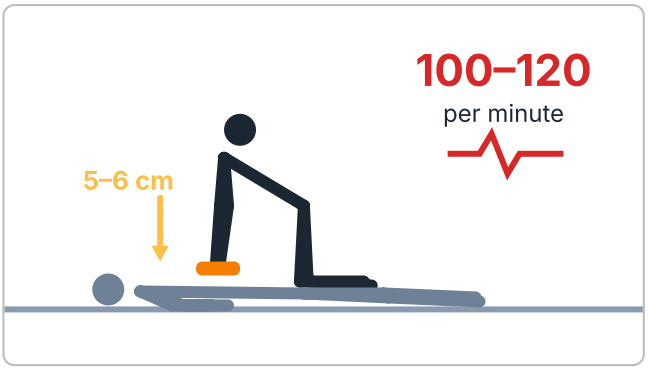
When a specialist is needed

- If after 2–4 weeks someone cannot function, cannot sleep, keeps reliving the event, or talks about death or that life is "not worth living".
- 10306: National Psychosocial Support Line – free, anonymous, 24 hours a day (also for children and families).
- 1018: Suicide Prevention Helpline (KLIMAKA), 24 hours.
- 1056: The Smile of the Child – helpline for children, 24 hours.

⚠ If someone is at risk of harming themselves NOW: do not leave them alone and call 112.

❤️ Adult CPR

Hard and fast in the centre of the chest



Heel of the hand in the CENTRE of the chest, other hand on top, arms straight, shoulders right above. Push 5–6 cm, 100–120 times a minute.

1. Lay the person on their back on a hard surface.
2. Call 112/166. If there is a defibrillator (AED), shout for someone to bring it.
3. Put the heel of your hand on the CENTRE of the chest, the other hand on top, arms straight.
4. Push HARD 5–6 cm deep, FAST 100–120 times a minute. Press the ♪ button for the rhythm.
5. If you know how: 30 compressions – 2 rescue breaths. If you don't know or don't want to: compressions ONLY, without stopping.
6. As soon as a defibrillator arrives: switch it on and do what it says out loud.
7. Do not stop until the EKAB ambulance (166) arrives, the person starts breathing, or you are exhausted. Swap every 2 minutes if there are two of you.

⚠ Doing CPR wrong is better than doing nothing. You cannot make them worse.

Child (1 year – puberty)

- One or two hands, depth ~5 cm (1/3 of the chest). If you are alone, do 1 minute of CPR before you leave to call.

Baby (under 1 year)

- Two fingers in the centre of the chest, just below the nipples, depth ~4 cm, 100–120 a minute.

💡 Take a Basic Life Support (BLS) course – a few hours, it could save someone you love.

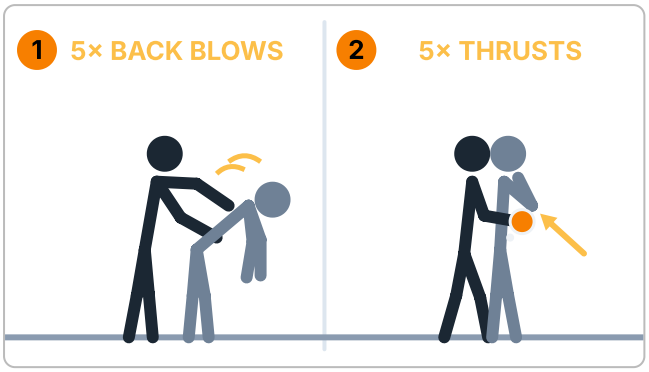
😮 Choking

Something stuck in the throat

Adult / child who is coughing

- Encourage them to cough hard. Do not hit yet.

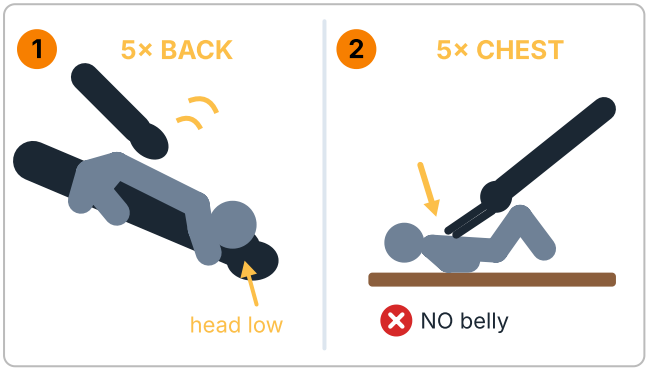
Cannot cough, speak or breathe



1 Lean them forward and give 5 hard blows between the shoulder blades with the heel of your hand · 2 From behind, fist above the belly button, other hand on top: 5 sharp thrusts in and up.

1. 5 back blows: lean them forward, hit hard between the shoulder blades with the heel of your hand.
2. 5 abdominal thrusts (Heimlich): from behind, fist above the belly button, other hand on top, pull sharply in and up.
3. Keep going 5 + 5 until it comes out.
4. If they become unconscious: lay them down, call 112, start CPR.

Baby



Baby: face down on your forearm, head low, 5 back blows. Then on its back, 5 chest pushes with 2 fingers. NO abdominal thrusts.

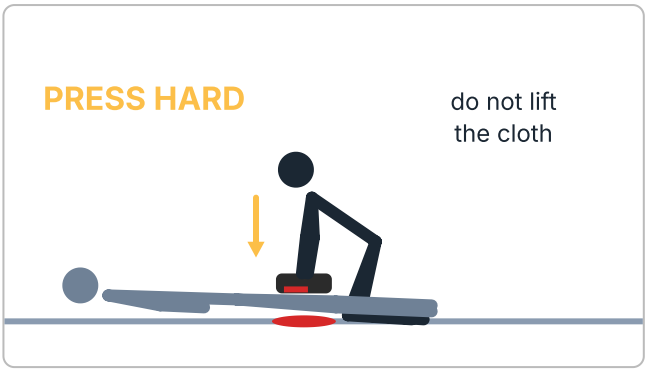
- Face down along your forearm, head low: 5 back blows. Then on the back: 5 chest thrusts with 2 fingers. NO abdominal thrusts on a baby.

Are you alone?

- Give yourself abdominal thrusts with your fist, or push hard against the back of a chair.

🩸 Heavy bleeding

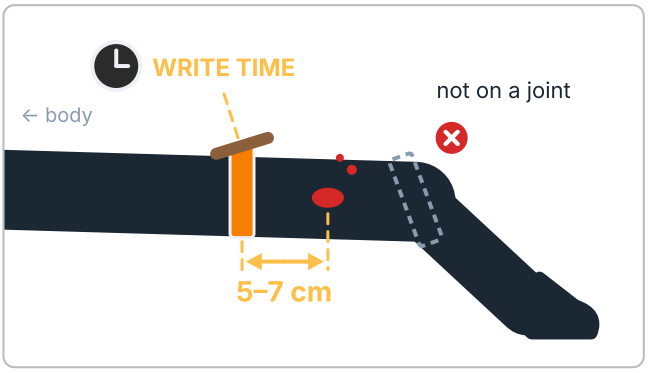
PRESS – PRESS – PRESS



Press HARD on the wound with a clean cloth, using all your weight. Do not lift the cloth – if it soaks through, add more on top.

1. Put on gloves if you have them (or a plastic bag).
2. Press HARD on the wound with a clean cloth/gauze. Use all your weight.
3. Do not lift the cloth to look. If it soaks through, put more on top.
4. Tie a bandage tightly over the cloth.
5. Lay them down, cover them (shock). Call 166.

Blood spurting or not stopping on an arm/leg → Tourniquet



Tourniquet 5–7 cm ABOVE the wound, not on a joint. Tighten until the bleeding stops and write down the TIME.

1. Put the tourniquet 5–7 cm ABOVE the wound (not on a joint).
2. Tighten by turning the rod until the bleeding stops. It hurts – that is normal.
3. Write down the TIME (on the forehead or on the tourniquet).
4. DO NOT loosen it. Only the hospital removes it.

💡 Improvised: wide cloth (4 cm+) and a stick/spoon to twist. No wire or thin cord.

Wound on the body / neck / armpit / groin

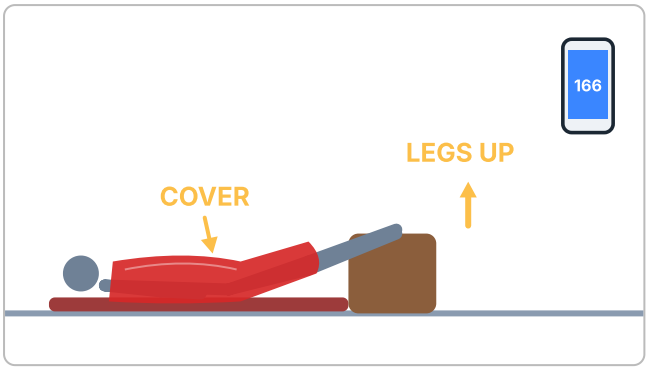
- Pack the wound with gauze (packing) and press hard for at least 3 minutes. Do not pull out objects stuck in the body – hold them in place.

Nosebleed

- Sit, lean FORWARD (not back), pinch the soft part of the nose for 10–15 minutes.

😰 Shock – fainting

Lay down, keep warm, call



Lay them on their back, raise the legs a little (if legs/pelvis are not injured) and cover them, underneath too. Call 166.

- Signs: pale, cold, sweaty skin, fast weak pulse, dizziness, thirst, confusion.

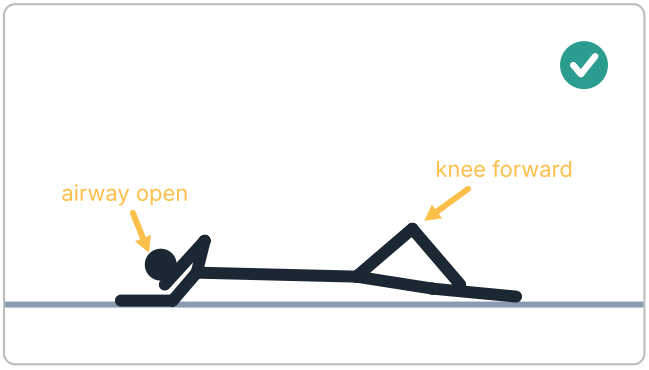
1. Stop any bleeding.
2. Lay them on their back. If the legs/pelvis are not injured, raise the legs a little.
3. Cover them (underneath too). Talk to them calmly.
4. Nothing to eat or drink.
5. Call 166.

Fainting

- Lie down, legs up. If not recovered in 1 minute → 166 and recovery position.

🛌 Recovery position

Breathing but not responding



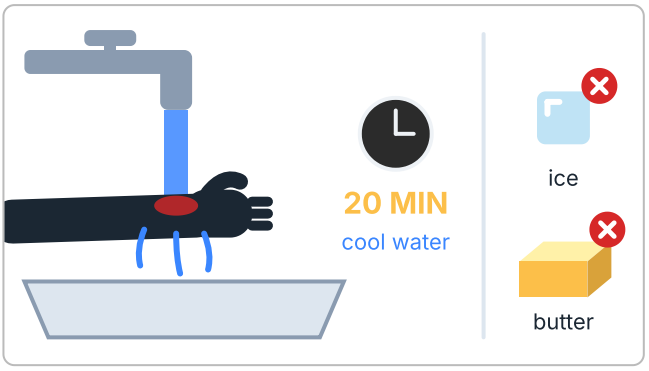
On the side, top knee bent forward for support, hand under the cheek, head tilted back and mouth facing down.

1. Kneel beside them. Place their arm nearest you at a right angle, palm up.
2. Their other arm: back of the hand against their cheek.
3. Bend the far knee and pull on the knee to roll them onto their side towards you.
4. Tilt the head back to keep the airway open, mouth facing down (so vomit can drain).
5. Keep checking their breathing. If it stops → CPR.

⚠ If you suspect a spinal injury (fall, car crash), do not move them unless needed for them to breathe or to save them.

🔥 Burns

Cool water for 20 minutes



Cool running water for 20 minutes. NO ice, NO butter, toothpaste or oil.

1. Move away from the fire/source. Clothes on fire: put them out.
2. Cool running water (not ice-cold, no ice) for 20 minutes.
3. Remove rings, watch, clothing (if not stuck to the skin).
4. Cover loosely with clear cling film or a clean plastic bag.
5. Call 166 if: large burn, face, hands, genitals, child/elderly person, electrical or chemical.

⚠ NO butter, toothpaste, oil, yoghurt. DO NOT pop blisters.

Chemical burn

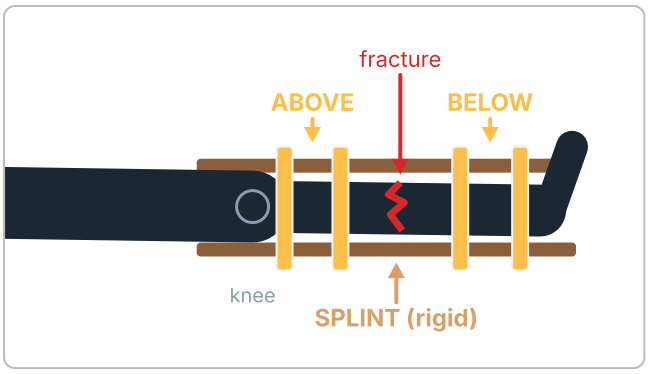
- Rinse with plenty of water for at least 20 minutes. Remove contaminated clothing.

Electric shock

- Turn off the power FIRST. Do not touch them while they are in contact. Then check breathing → 166.

🦴 Fracture – sprain

Keep it still



Do not straighten the bone. A splint from something rigid (cardboard, magazine, branch) tied ABOVE and BELOW the fracture.

1. Do not try to straighten the bone.
2. Keep it still as it is: splint from cardboard, a magazine, a branch, tied above and below the fracture.
3. Arm: sling from a triangular cloth or a T-shirt.
4. Ice wrapped in a cloth for 20 minutes.
5. Open fracture (bone showing): cover with clean gauze, press around it (not on it), 166.

Sprain (twisted joint)

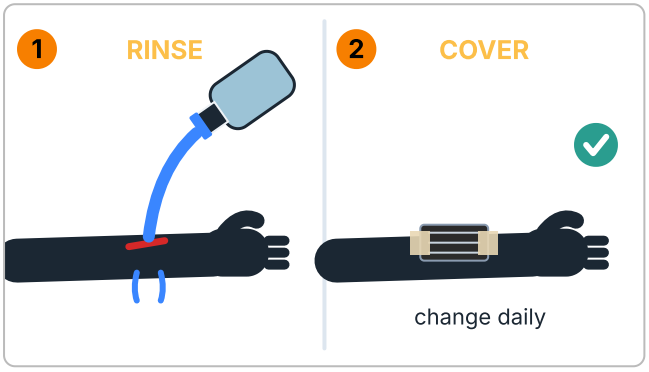
- Rest, ice 20 min, elastic bandage, raise it.

Head injury

- Vomiting, drowsiness, confusion, unequal pupils, fluid from nose/ears → 166 at once. Do not leave them alone for 24 hours.

🩹 Cuts – wounds

Clean, cover, watch for infection



1 Rinse the wound with plenty of clean (drinking) water · 2 Cover with sterile gauze and change it every day.

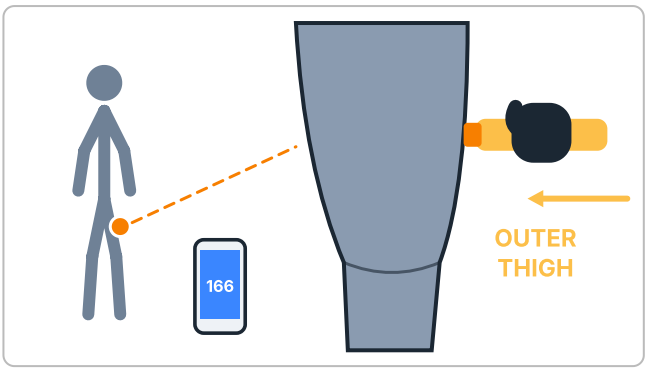
1. Wash your hands, put on gloves.
2. Rinse the wound with plenty of clean (drinking) water for several minutes. Remove dirt.
3. Antiseptic around the wound, no alcohol inside it.
4. Cover with sterile gauze or a dressing. Change it every day.

- Signs of infection: spreading redness, warmth, pus, fever, red streaks → doctor.

💡 Is your tetanus vaccine up to date? Booster every 10 years.

💉 Severe allergy (anaphylaxis)

Adrenaline at once



Adrenaline auto-injector (EpiPen etc.) into the OUTER thigh – it works through clothing too. Then 166, even if they get better.

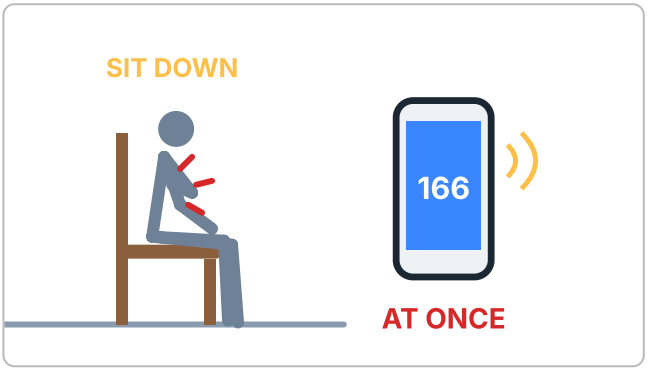
- Signs: swelling of face/tongue, trouble breathing, wheezing, hives all over the body, dizziness.

1. If they have an adrenaline auto-injector (EpiPen etc.): into the outer thigh, even through clothing.
2. Call 166 – even if they get better.
3. Trouble breathing: let them sit up. Dizzy: lie down, legs up.
4. If no better in 5–15 minutes and there is a second injector, use it.

🫀 Heart attack – Stroke

Every minute counts

Heart attack

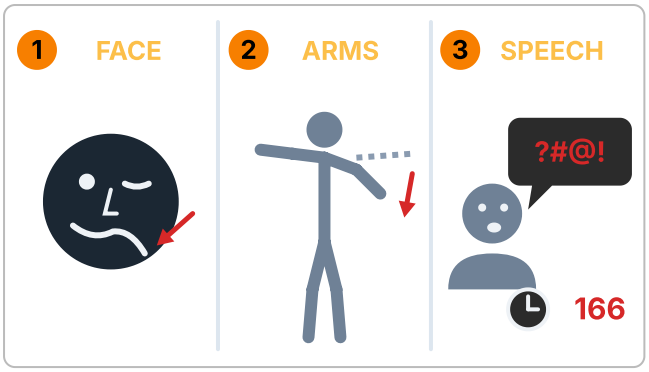


Heart attack: call 166 at once and sit them down to rest.

- Chest pain/tightness spreading to the arm, jaw, back, with sweating, nausea, shortness of breath.

1. 166 at once.
2. Sit them down to rest.
3. If not allergic and not forbidden by a doctor: 1 aspirin 300 mg to chew.

Stroke – FAST test

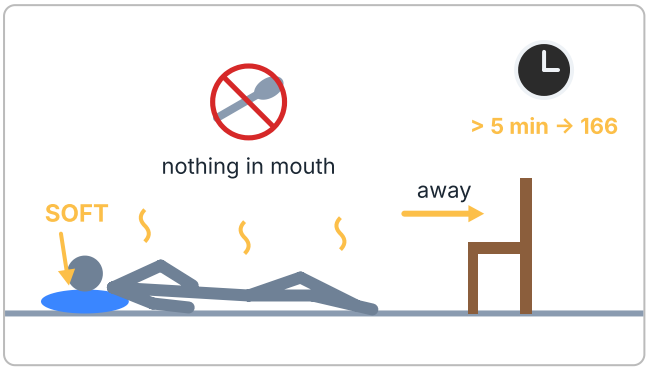


Stroke test: 1 FACE – drooping? · 2 ARMS – one drifts down? · 3 SPEECH – mixed up? Any one = 166 NOW, note the time.

- FACE: Smile – does one side droop?
- ARMS: Raise both arms – does one drift down?
- SPEECH: Say a sentence – are the words mixed up?
- Any one of these = 166 NOW. Note the time it started.

⚡ Seizures – Epilepsy

Protect, do not hold down



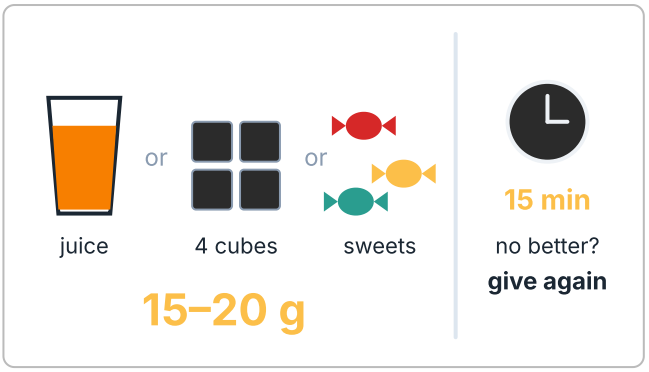
Move hard objects away, put something soft under the head. DO NOT hold them down, NOTHING in the mouth. Time it: over 5 minutes → 166.

1. Move hard objects away. Something soft under the head.
2. DO NOT hold them down. DO NOT put anything in the mouth.
3. Time it. Over 5 minutes → 166.
4. When it stops: recovery position, stay with them.

🍬 Low blood sugar

(hypoglycaemia)

Sugar fast

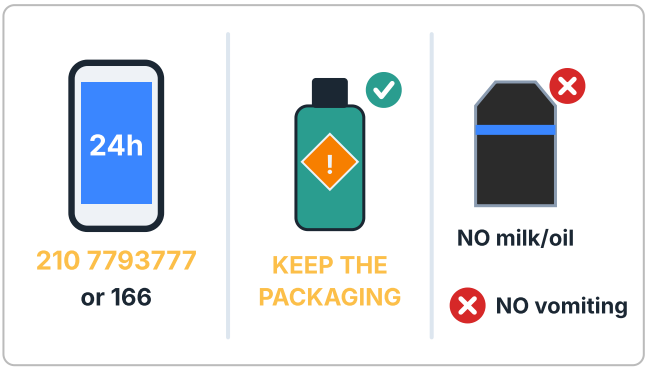


Give 15–20 g of sugar: juice, 4 sugar cubes or sweets. If no better in 15 minutes, give again.

- Diabetic who is sweating, shaking, confused: give 15–20 g sugar (juice, 4 sugar cubes, sweets).
- If no better in 15 minutes, give again. If they become unconscious: nothing by mouth, recovery position, 166.

🧪 Poisoning

Poison Centre 210 7793777



Call the Poison Centre 210 7793777 or 166 and keep the packaging. DO NOT make them vomit, DO NOT give milk or oil unless told to.

1. Call the Poison Centre 210 7793777 (24 hours) or 166.
2. Keep the product packaging.
3. DO NOT make them vomit. DO NOT give milk or oil unless told to.
4. On skin/eyes: rinse with water for 15–20 minutes.

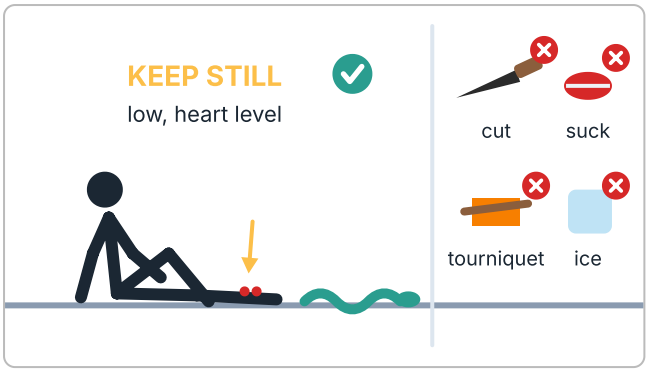
Carbon monoxide (CO)

- Headache, dizziness, nausea in several people in the same house, drowsiness → FRESH AIR at once, get everyone out, 166.

🐍 Bites – stings

Snake, scorpion, bee, tick

Viper



Viper: stay calm, keep the limb still and low at heart level, and go to hospital/166. NO cutting, sucking, tourniquet or ice.

1. Stay calm. Keep the limb still, low at heart level.
2. Remove rings, watches (it will swell).
3. Go to hospital/166. Note the time.

⚠ NO cutting, NO sucking, NO tourniquet, NO ice.

Bee – wasp

- Scrape the sting out with a fingernail or a card. Cold compress. Watch for allergy if face/throat swells.

Tick

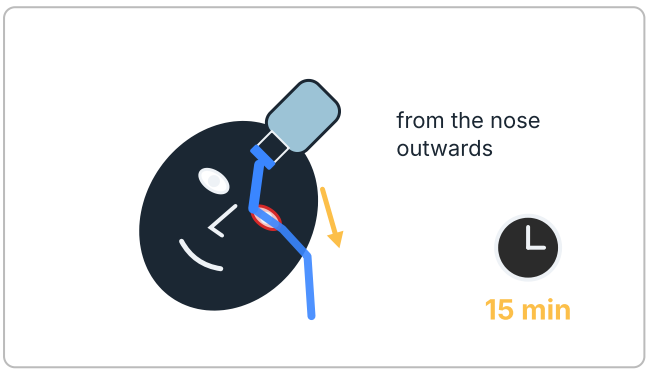
- Tweezers very close to the skin, pull straight out without twisting. Note the date. Fever or red ring in the following weeks → doctor.

Sea urchin – weever fish

- Weever fish/stingray: soak in hot water (as hot as you can bear, ~45 °C) for 30–90 minutes – the pain eases.

👁 Eye

Rinse, do not rub

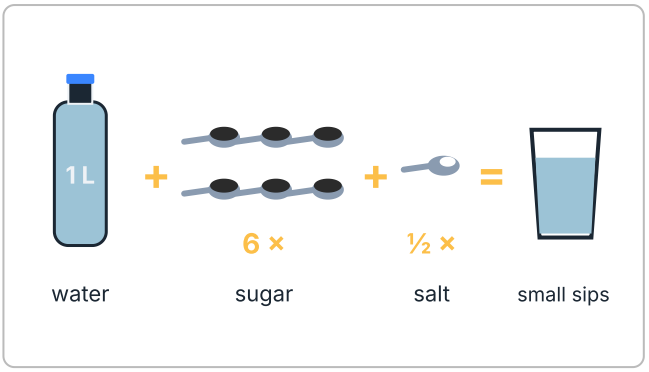


Tilt the head towards the injured eye and rinse with clean water for at least 15 minutes, from the nose side outwards.

- Dust/chemical: rinse with clean water for at least 15 minutes, from the nose side outwards.
- Object stuck in the eye: do not remove it, cover BOTH eyes (so they don't move), 166.

💧 Dehydration – diarrhoea

Fluids with salt and sugar



Rehydration drink: 1 litre of clean water + 6 teaspoons of sugar + ½ teaspoon of salt. Drink it in small sips.

- Signs: thirst, dark urine, dry mouth, dizziness. In children: few wet nappies, sunken eyes.
- Rehydration drink (if you have no pharmacy sachets): 1 litre clean water + 6 teaspoons sugar + 1/2 teaspoon salt. Sip by sip.

⚠ Babies, elderly people, blood in the stool, high fever → doctor.

🎒 Equipment lists

🎒 72-hour bag (per person)

Grab it and go in 2 minutes



One bag per person, ready by the door: water, food, torch, radio, first-aid kit, documents, cash, whistle. Weight no more than ~20% of your body weight.

💡 Weight: no more than ~20% of your body weight (less for children). Try walking for 1 hour with it.

Water and food

- ☐ Water 3 litres (bottles or flasks)
- ☐ Water filter or water purification tablets
- ☐ Cereal / energy bars (6+)
- ☐ Nuts, dried fruit
- ☐ Easy-open cans (tuna, beans) or ready meals (MRE)
- ☐ Chocolate, rusks, crackers
- ☐ Spoon-fork, can opener

Clothes and sleep

- ☐ Change of clothes: underwear, wool socks (2 pairs)
- ☐ Thermal base layer set (merino or synthetic)
- ☐ Fleece or warm sweater
- ☐ Waterproof jacket with hood
- ☐ Hat and gloves
- ☐ Sun hat, sunglasses
- ☐ Sturdy comfortable shoes (worn in, not new)
- ☐ Foil blanket (survival blanket) ×2
- ☐ Sleeping bag or wool blanket (if it fits)
- ☐ Foldable mat (insulation from the ground)
- ☐ Poncho / waterproof bag cover

Light, power, communication

- ☐ Head torch (headlamp) + spare batteries
- ☐ Small hand torch
- ☐ Charged power bank (10,000 mAh+) + cables
- ☐ Battery/crank radio
- ☐ Whistle (hung on the shoulder strap)
- ☐ Paper with phone numbers and addresses
- ☐ Paper map of the area + compass
- ☐ Light sticks (chemical light) ×2

Tools

- ☐ Multi-tool or pocket knife
- ☐ Lighters ×2 + waterproof matches
- ☐ Duct tape (a little, wrapped around a pencil or bottle)
- ☐ Paracord 10–15 m
- ☐ Work gloves
- ☐ FFP2 masks ×5
- ☐ Large rubbish bags ×3 (rain cover, shelter, storage)
- ☐ Zip bags
- ☐ Pencil and small notepad
- ☐ Small sewing kit, safety pins

Health and hygiene

- ☐ Small first-aid kit (see list “Bag / car first-aid kit”)
- ☐ Personal medicines for 7 days + list of medicines
- ☐ Spare glasses / contact lenses
- ☐ Toothbrush, toothpaste
- ☐ Soap, hand sanitiser, wet wipes
- ☐ Toilet paper
- ☐ Period products
- ☐ Sunscreen, insect repellent
- ☐ Small microfibre towel

Documents and money

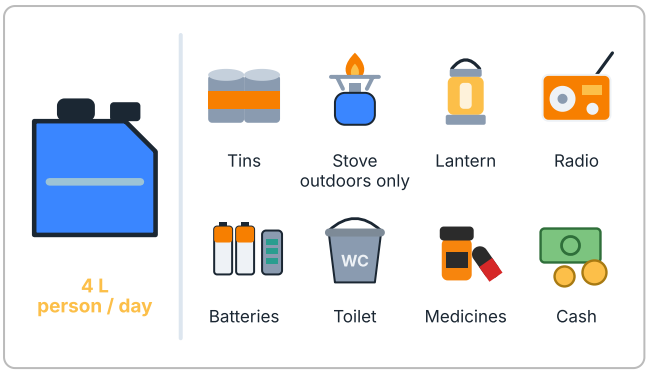
- ☐ Photocopies of ID card / passport in a waterproof pouch
- ☐ Copies of insurance, medical, property papers (also on USB)
- ☐ Cash in small notes and coins
- ☐ Spare house and car keys
- ☐ Recent photos of family members

Morale

- ☐ Playing cards, small book, paper and pencil for children
- ☐ One favourite small toy for a child

🏠 Home: 72 hours to 2 weeks

Supplies to stay inside



At home: 4 litres of water per person per day, food that needs no fridge, light, radio, batteries, emergency toilet, medicines and cash. Camping stove outdoors only.

💡 72 hours is the minimum goal. For war or a major disaster aim for 2 weeks. Use the calculator at the top of the list.

Water

- ☐ Drinking water 4 litres / person / day (bottled)
- ☐ Extra water for toilet/washing (jerrycans, full bathtub in a crisis)
- ☐ Plain unscented bleach (to disinfect water)
- ☐ Water filter (gravity / hand pump)
- ☐ Clean water containers with lids (jerrycans 10–20 L)

Food that needs no fridge

- ☐ Cans: beans/lentils, fish, meat, vegetables, fruit
- ☐ Pasta, rice, bulgur (if you can cook)
- ☐ Long-life milk / powdered milk
- ☐ Peanut butter, tahini, honey
- ☐ Rusks, crackers, toast crispbread
- ☐ Nuts, dried fruit
- ☐ Cereal, oats
- ☐ Oil, salt, sugar
- ☐ Coffee, tea, chamomile, cocoa
- ☐ Chocolate, bars, halva
- ☐ Baby formula / baby food (if needed)
- ☐ Pet food

Cooking without power

- ☐ Camping gas stove + canisters (ONLY outdoors / on an open balcony)
- ☐ Lighters, matches
- ☐ Pot / saucepan, frying pan, ladle
- ☐ Manual can opener
- ☐ Disposable plates, cups, cutlery
- ☐ Aluminium foil, cling film

Light and power

- ☐ Torches in every room (one for each person)
- ☐ LED lantern for the table
- ☐ Spare AA/AAA batteries (many)
- ☐ Power bank ×2 charged
- ☐ USB car charger
- ☐ Solar charging panel or power station (if possible)
- ☐ Battery / crank / solar radio
- ☐ Tea lights or candles ONLY with care, on a stable base

Heating – cooling

- ☐ Wool blankets (1–2 per person)
- ☐ Sleeping bag for each person
- ☐ Hot water bottles / hand warmers
- ☐ Warm clothes and socks
- ☐ Battery or hand fan (summer)

Hygiene and toilet

- ☐ Toilet paper (lots), kitchen roll
- ☐ Heavy-duty rubbish bags
- ☐ Bucket with lid (emergency toilet) + bags
- ☐ Bleach, disinfectant, soap
- ☐ Wet wipes, hand sanitiser
- ☐ Period products, nappies (baby / adult)
- ☐ Disposable gloves

Tools and safety

- ☐ Fire extinguisher 6 kg and fire blanket
- ☐ Battery smoke alarm and CO alarm
- ☐ Key/tool to shut off gas and water
- ☐ Screwdrivers, pliers, hammer, crowbar
- ☐ Duct tape, plastic sheeting, rope
- ☐ Whistle for each person
- ☐ FFP2/FFP3 masks
- ☐ Work gloves, safety glasses
- ☐ Document bag (ready to grab)

Medicines

- ☐ Prescription medicines for at least 2 weeks
- ☐ Home first-aid kit (see list “Home first-aid kit”)

Money and papers

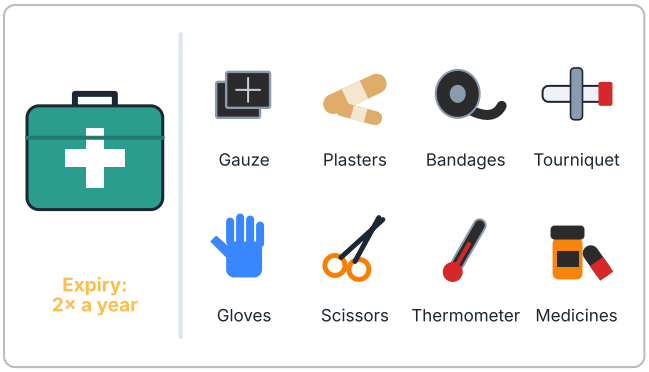
- ☐ Cash (cards and ATMs do not work without power)
- ☐ Phone list on paper
- ☐ Paper city map

Entertainment

- ☐ Books, board games, playing cards, crayons for children

🧰 Home first-aid kit

Full home first-aid kit



The home first-aid kit: gauze, plasters, bandages, tourniquet, gloves, scissors, thermometer and medicines. Check expiry dates twice a year.

💡 Check expiry dates 2 times a year. Box in a cool dry place, not in the bathroom. For medicines, ask your doctor/pharmacist what suits you.

Dressings

- ☐ Sterile gauze pads, various sizes (5×5, 10×10)
- ☐ Adhesive plasters, various sizes
- ☐ Elastic bandages (8 cm, 10 cm)
- ☐ Gauze roller bandages
- ☐ Triangular bandage ×2 (sling)
- ☐ Medical tape roll
- ☐ Steri-strips (wound closure strips)
- ☐ Burn dressings (gel)
- ☐ Pressure bandage for bleeding (Israeli bandage)
- ☐ CAT-type tourniquet – and learn how to apply it
- ☐ Foil blanket

Tools

- ☐ Nitrile gloves (many pairs)
- ☐ Blunt-tip scissors (bandage scissors)
- ☐ Tweezers for splinters/ticks
- ☐ Thermometer
- ☐ Blood pressure monitor
- ☐ Finger pulse oximeter
- ☐ CPR mask (pocket mask)
- ☐ Safety pins
- ☐ Pen torch
- ☐ Instant cold pack
- ☐ 20 ml syringe for rinsing wounds

Cleaning

- ☐ Saline (ampoules) – wounds and eyes
- ☐ Antiseptic (povidone-iodine or chlorhexidine)
- ☐ Rubbing alcohol (for tools/skin around a wound)
- ☐ Hand sanitiser

Non-prescription medicines (on pharmacist's advice)

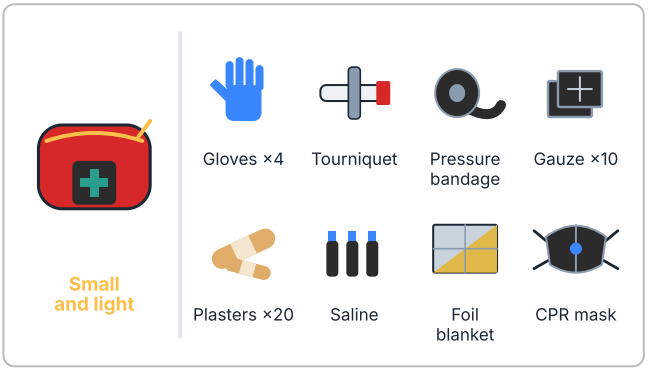
- ☐ Painkiller / fever reducer (e.g. paracetamol) – and child form if you have children
- ☐ Anti-inflammatory (e.g. ibuprofen)
- ☐ Aspirin (for suspected heart attack, only if no allergy)
- ☐ Antihistamine tablet (allergies)
- ☐ Antihistamine / cortisone cream for bites and stings
- ☐ Anti-diarrhoea medicine
- ☐ Electrolyte sachets (rehydration)
- ☐ Antacid / stomach medicine
- ☐ Nausea / travel sickness medicine
- ☐ Mild laxative
- ☐ Antibiotic ointment
- ☐ Burn cream / aloe vera
- ☐ Lubricating eye drops
- ☐ Throat lozenges
- ☐ Sunscreen, after sun
- ☐ Insect repellent

Personal

- ☐ The family's regular medicines + written list with doses
- ☐ Adrenaline injector if someone has a severe allergy
- ☐ Asthma inhalers
- ☐ Spare glasses
- ☐ First-aid guide on paper

⛑️ Bag / car first-aid kit

Small and light



Small, light kit for the bag or car: gloves, tourniquet, pressure bandage, gauze, plasters, saline, foil blanket, CPR mask.

- ☐ Nitrile gloves ×4 pairs

- ☐ CAT tourniquet ×1
- ☐ Pressure bandage (Israeli) ×1
- ☐ Sterile gauze pads ×10
- ☐ Assorted plasters ×20
- ☐ Elastic bandage ×1
- ☐ Triangular bandage ×1
- ☐ Medical tape
- ☐ Small scissors, tweezers
- ☐ Antiseptic wipes
- ☐ Saline ampoules ×5
- ☐ Painkiller, antihistamine, anti-diarrhoea, electrolytes
- ☐ Blister plasters (Compeed)
- ☐ Foil blanket
- ☐ CPR mask
- ☐ Personal medicines

🚗 Car kit

For being trapped, fire, snow

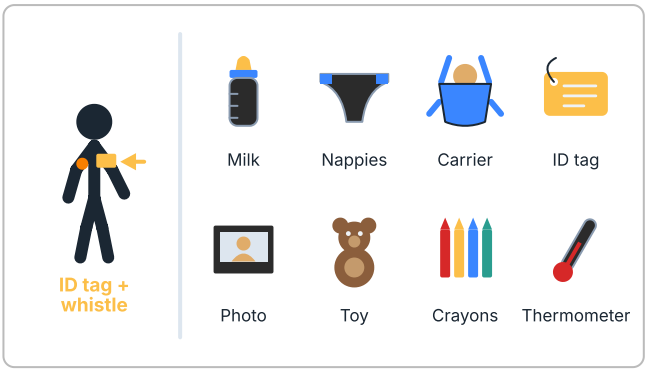


Car kit: warning triangle, extinguisher, first-aid kit, glass-breaking hammer near the driver, water, blanket, torch, shovel. Fuel tank always above half.

- ☐ Warning triangle, reflective vest (mandatory)
- ☐ Car fire extinguisher
- ☐ Car first-aid kit
- ☐ Window-breaking hammer with seatbelt cutter (near the driver)
- ☐ Water 6 litres
- ☐ Bars, nuts
- ☐ Wool blanket (also for fire)
- ☐ Foil blankets
- ☐ Torch + batteries
- ☐ USB charger for the lighter socket
- ☐ Jump leads / booster
- ☐ Snow chains, folding shovel
- ☐ Ice scraper
- ☐ Tow rope/strap
- ☐ Gloves, hat, raincoat
- ☐ Paper towels, bags
- ☐ Masks
- ☐ Paper map
- ☐ Sleeping bag for each passenger (winter)
- ☐ Window insulation panels (Reflectix) cut to size
- ☐ Battery CO alarm (if you sleep inside)
- ☐ Bottle for the night, towel for condensation on the windows
- ☐ Fuel tank always above half (rule)

🧸 Children and babies

What I add



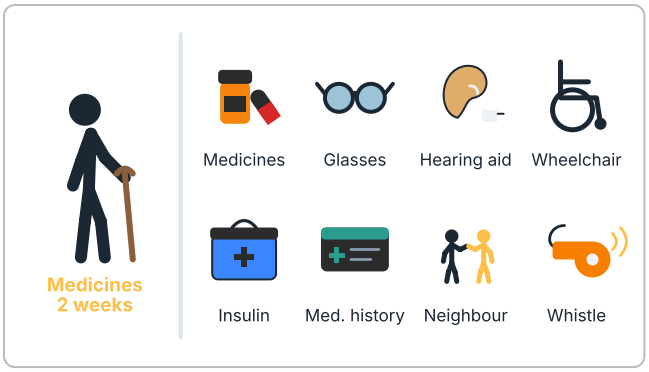
For children and babies: milk, nappies, baby carrier, ID tag with name and phone numbers, recent photo, whistle on the jacket, favourite toy.

- ☐ Baby formula, bottles, clean water to prepare it
- ☐ Baby food, small spoons
- ☐ Nappies (for 1 week), baby wipes, nappy rash cream
- ☐ Changes of clothes, warm clothes
- ☐ Baby carrier (prams cannot cross rubble)
- ☐ Children's painkiller / fever reducer at the right dose for weight
- ☐ Thermometer
- ☐ Card in pocket/wristband: name, parents, phone numbers, allergies, blood type
- ☐ Recent photo of the child on your phone and on paper
- ☐ Whistle on their jacket
- ☐ Favourite toy / soft toy
- ☐ Crayons, paper, small book
- ☐ Snacks they like

👵 Elderly and people with

disabilities

What I add

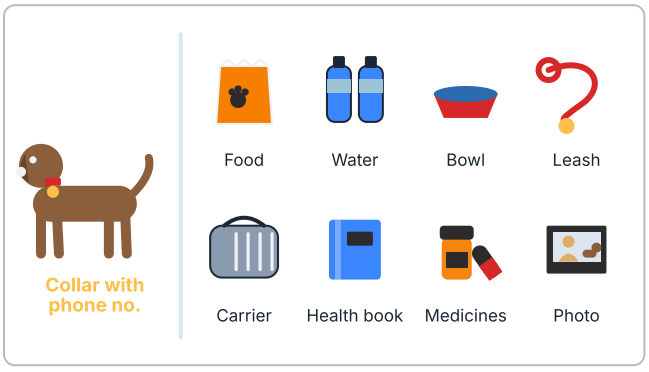


For elderly and disabled people: medicines for 2 weeks with a list, spare glasses, hearing aid, wheelchair, insulin cool bag, medical history card, a neighbour who helps, whistle.

- ☐ Medicines for 2 weeks + list with doses and doctor
- ☐ Spare glasses, hearing aids + batteries
- ☐ Dentures + case
- ☐ Walking stick / walker / wheelchair (and spare tyre)
- ☐ Adult nappies
- ☐ Plan for powered devices (oxygen, CPAP) – battery/generator
- ☐ Small cool box/cool bag for insulin + ice packs
- ☐ Card with medical history and diagnoses
- ☐ A "buddy" neighbour who knows how to help
- ☐ Bell or whistle to call for help

🐕 Pets

Don't forget them

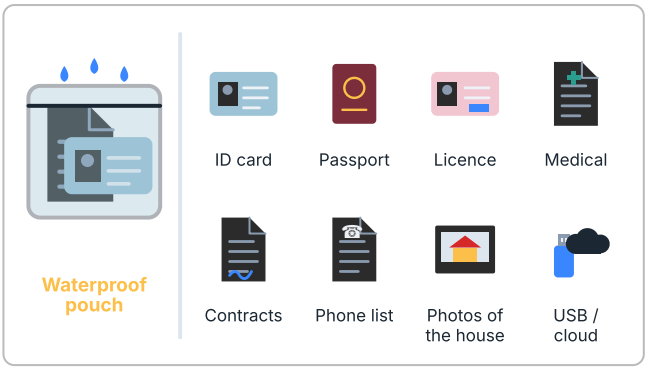


For your pet: food for 1–2 weeks, water, bowl, leash and collar with phone number, carrier, health booklet, medicines and a photo of you together.

- ☐ Food for 1–2 weeks
- ☐ Extra water
- ☐ Folding bowl
- ☐ Lead, collar with ID tag and phone number
- ☐ Dog muzzle – even if he never wears it: it may be required to enter a shelter, ship or bus. Get him used to it beforehand (a few minutes with a treat)
- ☐ Cage / carrier bag
- ☐ Health booklet, vaccinations, microchip (number)
- ☐ The animal's medicines
- ☐ Poo bags, cat litter
- ☐ Photo of you together (proof of ownership)

📂 Documents

Copies in a waterproof pouch and USB/cloud

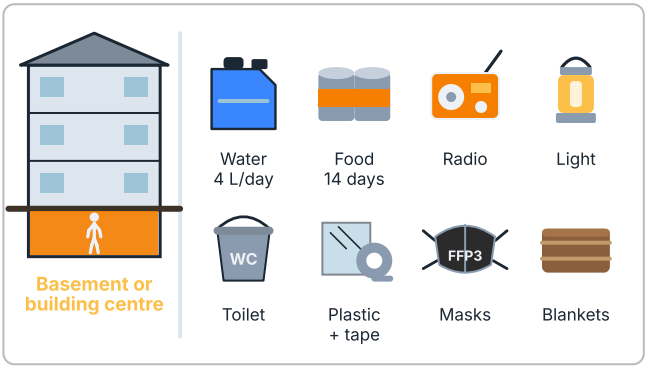


Copies of important documents in a waterproof pouch, and digital copies on USB or cloud: IDs, passports, licences, medical papers, contracts, phone list, photos of the house.

- ☐ ID cards, passports
- ☐ Driving licence, vehicle registration
- ☐ AMKA (social security no.), AFM (tax no.), health booklets
- ☐ Medical history, prescriptions, blood type, vaccinations
- ☐ House contracts, insurance policies (home, car, life)
- ☐ Birth certificates, family status certificates
- ☐ Property title deeds
- ☐ Bank account numbers (in a safe place)
- ☐ Seafarer/professional certificates, degrees
- ☐ List of phone numbers and addresses
- ☐ Photos of the house and belongings (for insurance/compensation)

☢️ Shelter: nuclear / war

For staying inside 2 weeks



Shelter for 2 weeks: a room in the basement or the centre of the building with no windows, with water 4 L/person/day, food, radio, light, bucket toilet, plastic sheet and tape, FFP3 masks, blankets.

- ☐ Chosen room: basement or centre of the building, no windows

- ☐ Water 4 L/person/day × 14 days
- ☐ Food for 14 days with no cooking
- ☐ Battery/crank radio + batteries
- ☐ Torches, LED lanterns
- ☐ Bucket toilet, bags, bleach, sawdust/sand
- ☐ Thick plastic sheeting and tape for windows/gaps
- ☐ Blankets, sleeping bags, mattresses
- ☐ First-aid kit and medicines
- ☐ FFP3 masks, gloves, waterproof clothes (for emergency trips outside)
- ☐ Bags for contaminated clothes
- ☐ Wet wipes, soap, shampoo without conditioner
- ☐ Books, games – long wait
- ☐ Potassium iodide ONLY if the authorities hand it out – take only when instructed

Winter kit

Cold, snowstorm, no heating



Winter kit for cold without heating: a sleeping bag for low temperatures, a tent set up indoors, foil blanket, blankets, sleeping mat, hat and gloves, hot-water bottle, thermos, CO alarm.

- ☐ Sleeping bag comfort −15 to −20 °C (northern Greece / mountains) or −5 °C (south)
- ☐ Sleeping bag liner (+2 to +5 °C)
- ☐ Tent set up INSIDE the house (microclimate) or swag / bivy
- ☐ Foil blanket for each person (+ one in the car)
- ☐ Wool blankets
- ☐ Insulating mat (R-value 3+)
- ☐ Merino thermal underwear
- ☐ Wool socks, hat, scarf, gloves (and mittens)
- ☐ Down or synthetic jacket
- ☐ Hot water bottles
- ☐ Hand/foot warmers
- ☐ Thermos for hot drinks
- ☐ Battery CO alarm
- ☐ Salt/sand for ice at the entrance
- ☐ Snow shovel

Summer – wildfires

Heatwave and forest fire

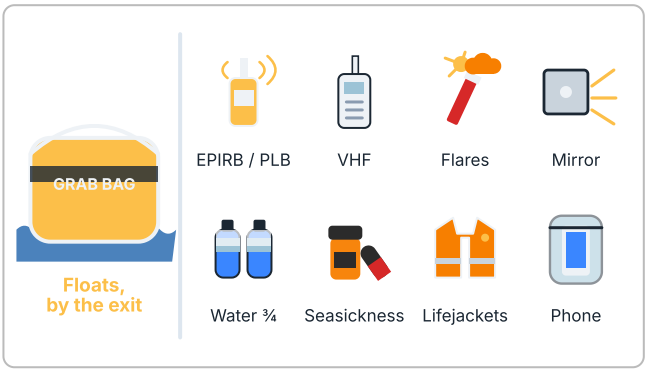


For heatwave and wildfire: dry grass cut 10 m around the house, FFP2 mask, goggles, cotton or wool clothes that cover the whole body, sturdy shoes, garden hose, buckets, wool blanket, plenty of water.

- ☐ FFP2 masks for smoke
- ☐ Safety goggles (smoke, ash)
- ☐ Cotton/wool clothes that cover the whole body (not synthetic)
- ☐ Sturdy shoes with leather soles
- ☐ Garden hose that reaches all around the house
- ☐ Buckets, shovel, rake
- ☐ Wool blanket
- ☐ Electrolytes, lots of water
- ☐ Battery fan, water spray bottle
- ☐ Dry grass cut around the house (10 m)
- ☐ Registered with 112 alerts / know the escape routes

Boat grab bag

For leisure boats and crew



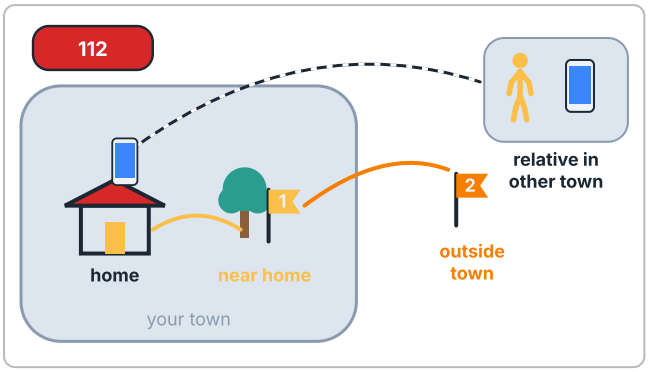
Boat grab bag: EPIRB/PLB, handheld VHF, flares, signal mirror, water in containers filled 3/4 so they float, seasickness tablets, lifejackets for everyone, phone in a waterproof pouch.

- ☐ Registered EPIRB / PLB
- ☐ Waterproof handheld VHF + batteries
- ☐ SART (if available)
- ☐ Hand flares and smoke signals (in date)
- ☐ Signal mirror, whistle
- ☐ Water in small containers, 3/4 full (so they float)
- ☐ Survival bars

- ☐ Seasickness medicine
- ☐ Waterproof torch, light sticks
- ☐ Blunt-tip knife (for life raft)
- ☐ Foil blankets / thermal protective aids
- ☐ Sunscreen, hat, sunglasses
- ☐ Waterproof first-aid kit
- ☐ Copies of documents in a waterproof pouch
- ☐ Phone in a waterproof pouch + power bank
- ☐ Lifejackets for everyone with light and whistle

📋 Family plan – check

What we must have agreed



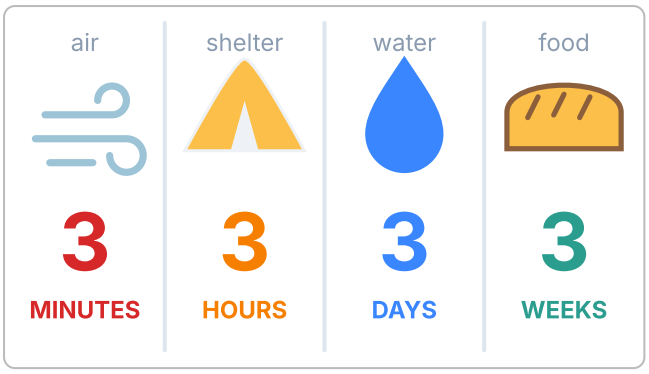
Agree in advance: meeting point 1 near home, point 2 outside the neighbourhood/town, and a relative in another town as the «contact centre». Everyone knows 112.

- ☐ Everyone knows 112 and when to call it
- ☐ Meeting point near the house
- ☐ Meeting point outside the neighbourhood/town
- ☐ Relative as “contact centre” in another town
- ☐ We know where to shut off gas, water, power
- ☐ We know 2 exit routes from the house and from the neighbourhood
- ☐ We know the nearest shelter / open assembly area
- ☐ We know the school's plan for the children
- ☐ Every person has a bag
- ☐ Earthquake and fire drill 2 times a year
- ☐ Check supplies and expiry dates every 6 months (e.g. March and September)
- ☐ We learned CPR and first aid
- ☐ We know which neighbour needs help
- ☐ We filled in “My Card” in this app
- ☐ A family secret word for emergencies – said only face to face, never in a message
- ☐ Cash for 72 hours at home in small notes (in a cyberattack cards and ATMs may not work)
- ☐ The whole family knows the 5 anti-scam rules – we did the quiz "Would they fool you?" together

🏕️ After 72 hours – Survival

3️⃣ The rule of 3

What is most urgent



The order of danger: 3 minutes without air, 3 hours without shelter in harsh weather, 3 days without water, 3 weeks without food.

- 3 MINUTES without air (or with heavy bleeding).
- 3 HOURS without protection in harsh weather (cold, rain, heatwave).
- 3 DAYS without water.
- 3 WEEKS without food.

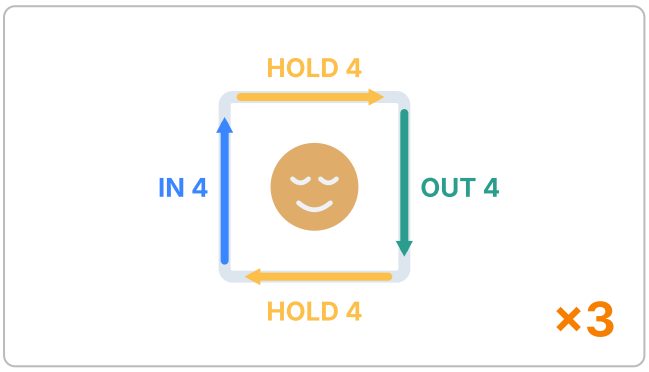
So the order is:

1. Safety and first aid.
2. Shelter – warmth/cooling.
3. Water.
4. Signals so they can find you.
5. Food (last!).

💡 And above all: STAY CALM and keep the will to live. Survivors are usually not the strongest, but those who do not give up.

🧠 Mind – staying calm

The most important tool



Box breathing: in 4, hold 4, out 4, hold 4 – around the square. Three times.

- Box breathing 4-4-4-4: breathe in 4, hold 4, breathe out 4, hold 4. Three times. It calms panic.
- Take SMALL steps: “now I build the shelter”, not “how will I get out of this”.
- Routine: set times for water, food, sleep, checks. Routine keeps the mind steady.
- Give everyone a job, children too. Work drives fear away.
- Talk, keep a diary, pray if it helps you. Think of the people waiting for you.
- After the crisis: anxiety, nightmares and anger are normal. Talk to someone. Ask for help if it lasts.

🏕️ Shelter in the wild

From wind, rain and the ground

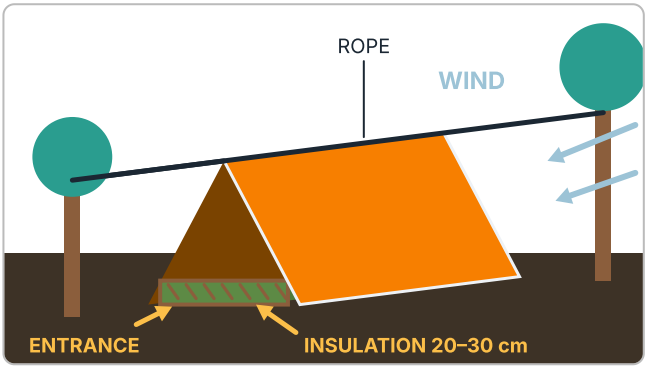
Where



Put the shelter where it is sheltered from the wind (e.g. behind a rock). NOT in a stream or dry riverbed, NOT under dead branches, NOT on a summit.

- Sheltered from wind (behind a rock, inside a forest), NOT in a stream or dry riverbed, NOT under dead branches, NOT on a summit.
- Near water but not next to it (50+ m).

How



Rope between 2 trees, sheet over it like an “A”. First insulate from the ground with 20–30 cm of branches and leaves. Closed side to the wind, entrance facing away.

1. Insulate from the ground FIRST: 20–30 cm of branches, leaves, pine needles.
2. Small shelter – you heat a small space with your body.
3. With a tarp/plastic sheet: rope between 2 trees, sheet over it like an "A", windward side closed.
4. With nothing: a ridge pole leaning on a trunk, branches along the sides like ribs, 50+ cm of leaves on top.
5. Entrance facing away from the wind.

In snow

- Dig a hollow in the snow or under a fir tree. Make an air hole. Snow insulates.

💡 A large bin bag with a hole for the head = waterproof and windproof in 10 seconds.

💧 Water: where to find it

Treat all water from nature as contaminated

How much I need

- 2–3 litres a day for drinking, per person. In heat or hard work: 4–6 litres.
- Plus 1–2 litres for cooking and hand washing.

💡 Do not "save" water in the bottle while you are thirsty. Drink little and often, but DRINK. Cut effort and sweat, not water.

⚠ Signs of dehydration: dark urine, headache, dizziness, dry mouth. Children and elderly people dehydrate faster.

At home (when the water is cut off)

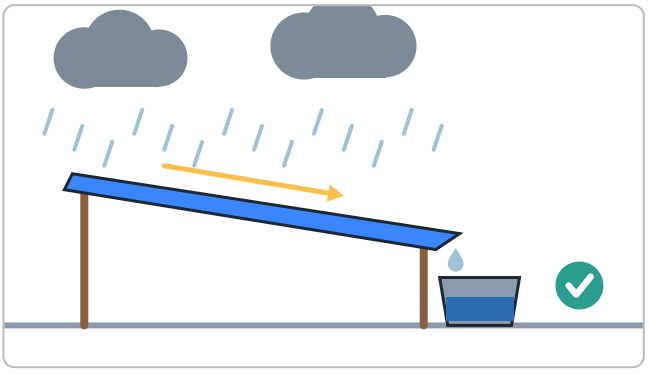
- Water heater: switch off the power, close the supply, open the drain tap at the bottom. 40–120 litres of clean water.
- Toilet cistern (the tank, NOT the bowl), if it has no chemical tablets.
- Pipes: open the tap at the highest point of the house and collect from the lowest.
- Canned fruit and vegetables (their liquid), ice cubes in the freezer.
- As soon as you hear the water will be cut: fill the bathtub, pots and bottles.

⚠ Water from radiators, pools, aquariums: only for flushing and washing, NOT for drinking.

In the wild

- Running water (spring, stream) is better than still water. A spring where it comes out of the rock is best.
- Look low: gorges, valley floors, green vegetation, plane trees, reeds, brambles.
- Animal trails going downhill, birds flying low and straight at dusk, bees and wasps (water within 1–2 km).
- Dry stream: dig on the outside of a bend, at the lowest point. If you find wet sand, dig 30–50 cm and wait for water to collect.
- On the beach: dig behind the first sand dune, above the high-tide line. The first water to collect is less salty.

Collect from the sky



Rain: spread a plastic sheet or tarp sloping down into a container. Let the first minutes wash off the dust.

1. Rain: spread plastic, canvas or a tarp sloping into a container. Let the first minutes rinse off the dust.
2. Dew: at dawn wipe the grass with a cotton cloth or T-shirt and wring it out. Half a litre an hour with good dew.
3. Snow and ice: melt them in a pot. Put a little water in the bottom first so it does not burn. Ice gives more water than snow.

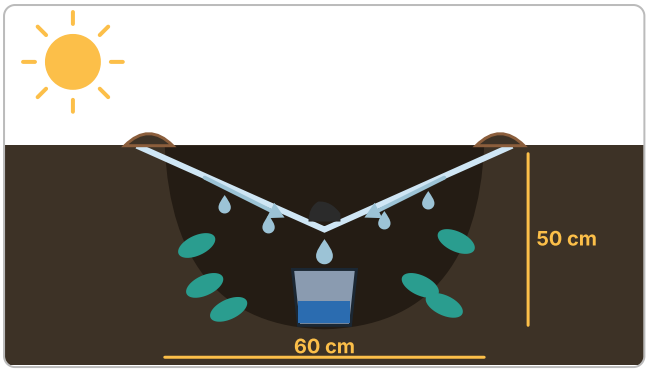
⚠ Do not eat snow – it lowers your body temperature and causes hypothermia.

Transpiration bag

1. Put a clear plastic bag around a branch with lots of green leaves, in the sun.
2. Tie the opening tightly. Put a small pebble inside so the water collects in one corner.
3. In 4–6 hours you have a little clean water. Use many bags on different trees.

⚠ Not on poisonous plants (e.g. oleander). If you do not know the plant, do not drink it.

Solar still



A pit 60 cm wide and 50 cm deep, a container in the middle, green leaves around it. Clear plastic on top, soil on the edges, a stone in the centre. Drops run down and fall clean into the container.

1. Dig a pit 60 cm wide and 50 cm deep, in the sun, in damp ground.
2. Put a container in the centre. Around it put green leaves or salty/dirty water or urine.
3. Cover with clear plastic, seal the edges with soil, put a stone in the centre, right above the container.
4. Water evaporates, forms drops on the plastic and drips CLEAN into the container.

💡 It gives little (0.2–0.5 litres a day). It is for emergencies, not to live on.

Water you DO NOT drink

⚠ NEVER seawater, urine or alcohol – they dehydrate you faster.

⚠ Flood water: it contains sewage, oil and chemicals. Not even treated, if there is another option.

⚠ Avoid water with dead animals nearby, with green-blue scum (cyanobacteria – the toxins are NOT removed by boiling), downstream of villages, sprayed fields, mines, factories.

🚰 Water filtering & treatment

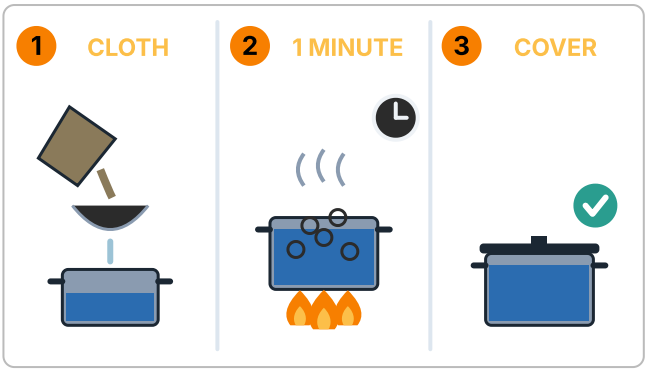
Boiling, bleach, tablets, filters, DIY filter

The 3 steps

1. CLARIFY: remove mud and debris (settling, cloth, sand filter).
2. FILTER: remove bacteria and parasites (0.1–0.2 µm filter).
3. DISINFECT: kill viruses too (boiling, bleach, tablets, UV).

💡 Cloudy water? Always do step 1 first. Mud "hides" germs from bleach and sunlight, and clogs filters.

1. Boiling – the surest method



1 Cloudy water? Pass it through a cloth. 2 Rolling boil for 1 minute (above 2000 m: 3 minutes). 3 Let it cool covered.

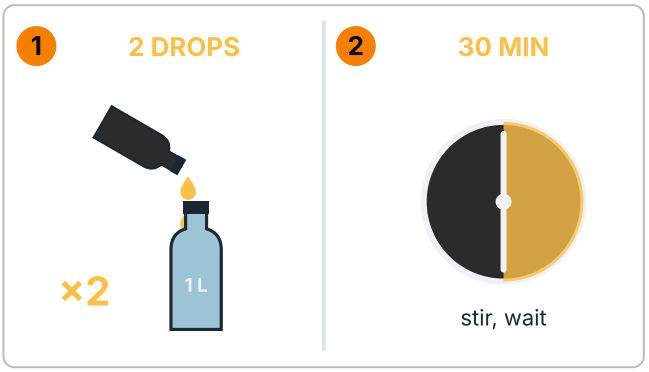
1. Pass the water through a cloth if it is cloudy.
2. Bring to a ROLLING boil (big bubbles) for 1 minute. Above 2000 m altitude: 3 minutes.
3. Let it cool covered. To remove the "flat" taste, pour it back and forth between containers.

- Kills ALL germs: bacteria, viruses, parasites.

⚠ Does NOT remove salt, chemicals, oil, heavy metals or algae toxins.

💡 No pot: a plastic bottle filled COMPLETELY with water, hung over embers (not flames), boils without melting. Or heat stones in the fire and drop them into a container of water (not river stones – they explode).

2. Household bleach



Plain unscented bleach: 2 drops in 1 litre of clear water (cloudy or very cold: 4). Stir and wait 30 minutes.

1. ONLY plain bleach, unscented, no detergent (5–6% sodium hypochlorite, it says on the label).
2. Clear water: 2 drops per litre (8 drops per 4 litres).
3. Cloudy or very cold water: 4 drops per litre.
4. Stir and wait 30 minutes (cold water: 1 hour).
5. It should smell SLIGHTLY of chlorine. If it does not, add the same dose again and wait another 15 minutes.

- Kills bacteria and viruses. Some parasites (Cryptosporidium) survive.

💡 Keep a small dropper bottle of bleach in your backpack. Bleach loses strength after 6–12 months – replace it.

3. Tablets

- Chlorine dioxide (e.g. Micropur MP1, Aquamira): kills parasites TOO. Wait 30 minutes for bacteria/viruses and 4 hours for Cryptosporidium. The best tablet for the backpack.
- NaDCC / chlorine (e.g. Aquatabs): fast, cheap, like bleach.
- Iodine: 5 drops of 2% iodine tincture per litre, 30 minutes. NOT for pregnant women, children, thyroid conditions or use for more than a few weeks.

💡 ALWAYS follow the package instructions. Check the expiry date.

4. Portable filters

- 0.1 µm hollow-fibre filters (Sawyer Squeeze/Mini, LifeStraw, Katadyn BeFree): stop bacteria and parasites, not viruses. Light, cheap, filter thousands of litres.
- Ceramic filters (e.g. Katadyn): tough, cleaned with a brush.
- Activated carbon filters: improve taste and remove some chemicals – on their own they do not kill germs.

1. Filter from the cleanest spot, not from the bottom.
2. Do not let the "dirty" end touch the clean bottle.
3. Backflush when the flow drops.

⚠ FREEZING DAMAGES fibre filters without showing it. In winter sleep with the filter inside your sleeping bag.

⚠ In floods or near villages (sewage = viruses): after filtering ALSO add bleach or boil.

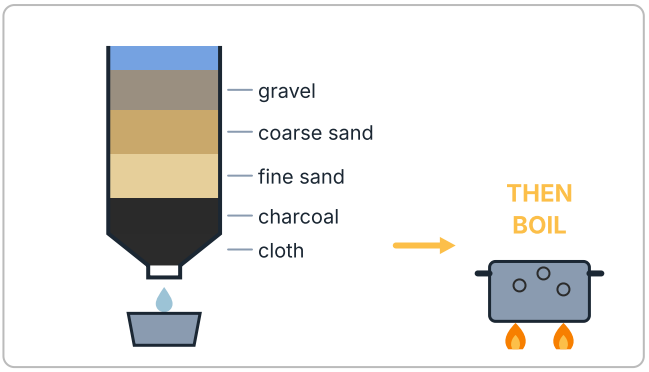
- UV pen (e.g. SteriPEN): kills all germs in 90″ in CLEAR water. Needs a battery.

5. Sun – SODIS

1. Clear PET plastic bottle up to 2 litres, no label, NO scratches.
2. Fill it with CLEAR water (if you can read letters through it, it is fine).
3. Lay it in the sun, ideally on metal sheeting or a roof, for 6 hours. Cloudy: 2 days. Rain: it does not work.

💡 Last resort, but better than nothing. Needs no fuel.

DIY bottle filter



DIY filter: an upside-down bottle, from bottom to top: cloth, charcoal, fine sand, coarse sand, gravel. It only clears the water – then ALWAYS boil it or add bleach.

1. Cut the bottom off a 1.5–2 litre plastic bottle and turn it upside down (cap at the bottom, pierced or unscrewed).
2. Put cotton wool, gauze or a piece of T-shirt in the neck.
3. On top, 3–5 cm of crushed CHARCOAL from your fire (not briquettes with chemicals).
4. Then fine sand, then coarse sand, fine gravel on the very top.
5. Pour water slowly. Throw away the water from the first 2–3 fillings (it washes out charcoal dust).

⚠ This filter only CLARIFIES. It does NOT make water safe to drink. ALWAYS boil, add bleach or a tablet afterwards.

💡 Quick fix: tie a sock or T-shirt into a funnel shape, fill it with sand and pour the water through.

Salty or chemical water – distillation

- Only distillation removes salt and most chemicals.

1. Pot with seawater/dirty water on the fire.
2. Inside, in the centre, a mug standing on a stone (not touching the water).
3. Cover with the lid UPSIDE DOWN (handle pointing down, above the mug). Put cold water or snow on top of the lid.
4. The steam forms drops on the lid and drips clean into the mug.

💡 Or: a tube/reed from the spout of a covered boiling container, leading to a container sitting in cold water.

Quick table

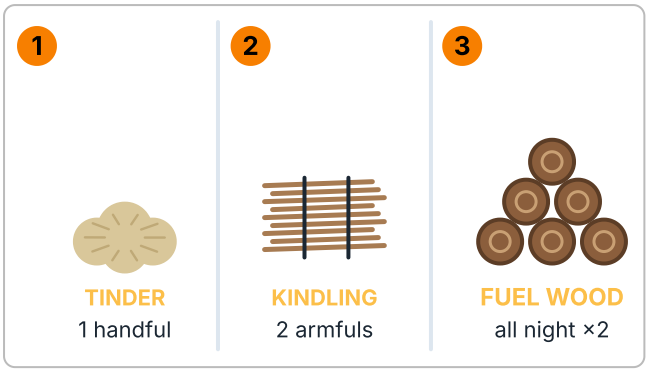
- Cloudy water → settling + cloth → boiling or bleach.
- Mountain stream → 0.1 µm filter (or boiling).

- Flood water or water near a village → cloth → filter → AND bleach or boiling.
- Seawater → distillation only.
- Water with oil, chemicals, green scum → DO NOT drink it. Find another source.

🔥 Fire: how to build it

Warmth, boiling, signal, morale

The 3 materials – gather them BEFORE you light



Gather BEFORE you light: 1 tinder (a handful), 2 kindling (lots – two armfuls), 3 fuel wood for the whole night, and bring double.

- TINDER (catches from a spark): one big handful.
- KINDLING (match to pencil thickness): LOTS – two armfuls.
- FUEL WOOD (finger to arm thickness): enough for the whole night. Whatever you think, bring double.

💡 The most common failure is too little kindling. That is where the fire dies.

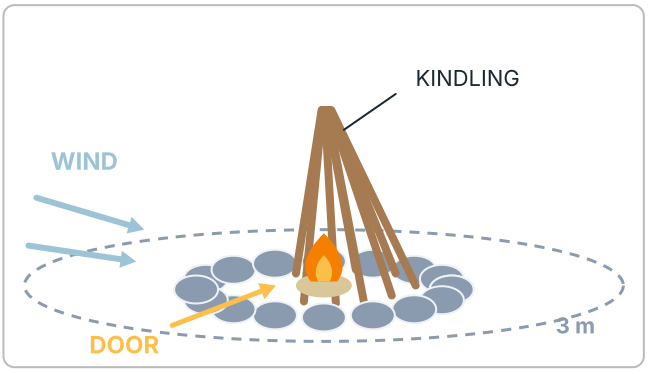
The best tinder

- Cotton balls with petroleum jelly: catch with one spark and burn 2–3 minutes. Put 10–20 balls in a small bag or tin – the No.1 item in your backpack.
- Fatwood (resin-soaked wood from a pine root or stump, smells of resin, reddish): lights even when wet.
- Pine resin running from the trunk.
- Bark of birch, cedar, cypress, grapevine – rub it into fluff.
- Dry grass, dry pine needles, bird nests, cattail (Typha) and thistle fluff.
- Shavings: carve a dry stick with the knife into thin "curls" that stay attached (feather stick).
- From home/car: paper, egg cartons, dryer lint, hand sanitiser gel (alcohol), crisps, candle wax, petroleum-jelly gauze from the pharmacy.

Rain and damp

- Take dead branches that are STILL on the tree, not from the ground.
- Under fallen trunks, rocks and dense firs the wood is drier.
- Split thick wood: the inside is dry. Make feather sticks from it.
- Put damp wood AROUND the fire to dry before adding it.
- Make a base of sticks or bark, not on wet soil or snow.
- Dead branches that SNAP with a "crack" are dry. If they bend, they are damp.

How to light it



Tipi lay: tinder in the middle, kindling around it, with a "door" on the wind side. Light it from there and blow gently at the base. A clear circle of 3 m around.

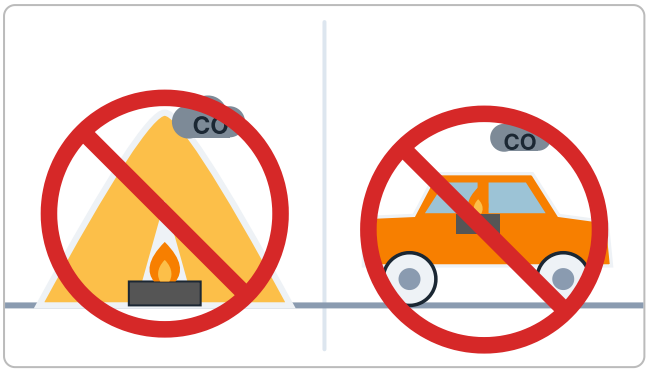
1. Clear a 3 m circle of dry material. Away from trees, overhanging branches and tents. In strong wind – do not light.
2. Ring of stones (NOT river stones or wet stones – they explode) or dig a small pit.
3. Base of dry sticks. Tinder in the middle.
4. Around the tinder stand the kindling in a tent shape (tipi), leaving a "door" on the windward side.
5. Light the tinder from the windward side. Blow gently and steadily at the base, not from above.
6. When the kindling catches, slowly add bigger pieces. Do not smother it – fire needs air.

Fire lays

- Tipi (tent): lights fast, strong flame. For warmth, boiling, signalling.
- Log cabin (crossed logs like a hut): stable, makes good embers. For cooking.

- Lean-to: one thick log toward the wind, kindling leaning on it. For windy conditions.
- Star: 5–6 thick logs like spokes, push them inward as they burn. Saves wood, lasts all night.
- Dakota (hidden): two 30 cm pits joined at the bottom by a tunnel. Fire in one, air from the other. Little smoke, little wood, not visible, wind-resistant.

Warmth for sleeping



NEVER a fire, brazier, charcoal or gas stove inside a tent, car or closed room. Carbon monoxide (CO) has no smell and kills in your sleep.

- Reflector wall behind the fire (logs or stones): turns the heat toward you.
- Sleep 1–1.5 m from a long, low fire, with the wall behind the fire or behind you.
- Hot stones (not from a river) wrapped in cloth in the sleeping bag, or a bottle of hot water.

⚠ NEVER a fire, brazier, charcoal or gas stove inside a tent, car or closed room. Carbon monoxide: it has no smell and kills in your sleep.

Safety and the law

⚠ In Greece, during the fire season (1 May – 31 October) fires are banned in forests, fields and open country. Only in real danger to life, with extreme care.

⚠ Always keep water or soil next to you. Never leave a burning fire.

⚠ Putting it out: water, stir with a stick, water again, until it is COLD to the touch. Embers under the ash can reignite hours later.

💡 If it gets away: do not try to put it out alone if it has grown. Move upwind and downhill, and call 199/112.

🪵 8 ways to start a fire

From the lighter to the bow drill

1. Lighter

- The easiest. Carry 2–3 simple flint-wheel lighters (e.g. BIC) – in different pockets.
- In the cold the gas will not flow: keep it in an inside pocket, close to your body.
- Got wet? Blow on it and rub the wheel on clothing until dry. Even empty, the wheel throws sparks onto petroleum-jelly cotton.

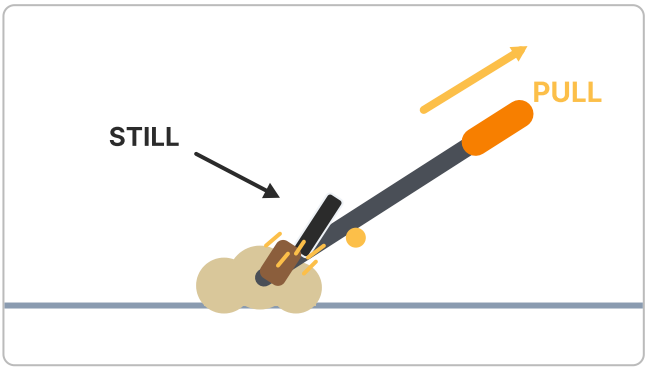
💡 In wind: make a “cave” with your body and palms and light close to the tinder.

2. Matches

- Stormproof matches: burn in wind and relight after getting wet. In a waterproof case together with the striker.
- Ordinary matches: dip the heads in melted wax – they become waterproof. Scrape off the wax before lighting.

1. Hold the match with the head slightly down, so the flame climbs the stick.
2. Bring it straight to the tinder, sheltered from the wind.

3. Ferro rod



Ferro rod: rod tip IN the tinder, scraper held still, and you PULL the rod back. The sparks fall onto the tinder.

- Works wet, in wind, in cold, for thousands of strikes. The best backup – put one in your kit.

1. Put the tip of the rod INTO the tinder.
2. Hold the striker (or the knife spine) still against the rod.
3. PULL the rod back, do not push the striker forward – this way you do not scatter the tinder.
4. Sparks at 3,000 °C fall on the tinder. Blow gently.

💡 With a magnesium rod: first scrape a coin-sized pile of shavings onto the tinder, then strike a spark.

4. Battery and steel wool

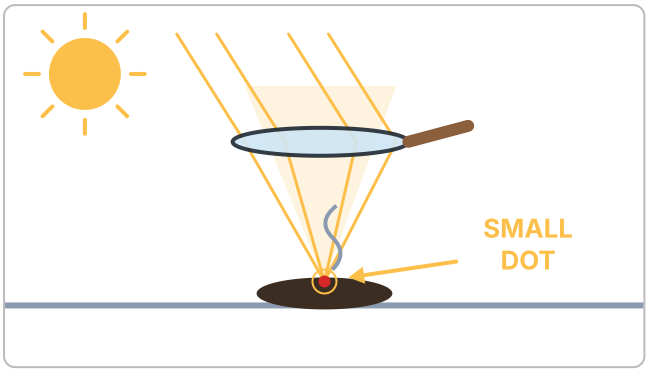
- You need very fine steel wool (grade 0000, not stainless).

1. Stretch out a piece of steel wool, fluff it up.
2. Touch the wool to both terminals of a 9V battery – it lights at once.
3. With an AA/AAA battery or powerbank: one thin strand of wool from one terminal to the other.
4. Drop the glowing wool into the tinder and blow.

⚠ Never carry a 9V battery and steel wool in the same pocket – it can ignite by itself.

💡 Car: the dashboard cigarette lighter lights paper, cotton or bark. Always away from petrol.

5. Lens and sun



Lens and sun: hold the lens so the bright dot is as SMALL as possible, and still, on dark dry tinder.

- Magnifying glass, READING glasses (for close-up – glasses for short-sightedness do not work), binocular or camera lens, card-sized Fresnel lens.
- Also: a clear bottle or bag full of water, ice polished into a lens.

1. Only in strong sun, ideally 10:00–15:00.
2. Dark, dry tinder: char cloth, dry rotten wood (punk), blackened paper.
3. Hold the lens so the bright dot is as SMALL as possible, and STILL.
4. As soon as smoke and a red dot appear, put it into tinder and blow.

💡 Never needs fuel. Keep a Fresnel lens in your wallet.

6. Flint, steel and char cloth

- High-carbon steel (old file, carbon knife spine) + hard stone with a sharp edge (flint, quartz).

1. Hold the stone with a piece of char cloth on it, just below the sharp edge.
2. Strike the steel downward, glancing off the edge of the stone. The sparks fall on the char cloth.
3. When the cloth shows a red dot, put it inside a "nest" of dry grass, close it and blow until it flames.

Make char cloth (at home or on the fire)

1. Cut 100% cotton cloth (old jeans, T-shirt) into 5×5 cm squares.
2. Put them in a metal tin with one small hole in the lid.
3. Put the tin in the fire. Smoke comes out of the hole.
4. When the smoke stops, take it out and let it cool CLOSED.
5. The squares must be black, not ash. They catch with the smallest spark.

7. Bow drill – with nothing

- Hard. Needs practice at home, not your first try in an emergency. The wood must be BONE DRY.
- Good woods: willow, poplar, lime (linden), cedar, cypress, ivy root. Not resinous pine, not hard oak.

1. Spindle: straight stick 20 cm, thumb-thick, pointed at the top end, rounded at the bottom.
2. Hearth board: same wood, 2 cm thick. Make a small depression near the edge and a V-shaped notch (1/8 of the circle) from the edge to the centre of the depression.
3. Handhold on top: a stone with a hollow or hard wood. Lubricate with soap, fat or leaves.
4. Bow: a branch about arm length, slightly curved, with a slightly slack cord.
5. Wrap the cord once around the spindle. Put a leaf or bark under the notch.
6. Hold the board down with your foot, the hand with the handhold locked against your knee.
7. Saw with long, steady strokes, slowly at first, then fast and with pressure. When there is lots of smoke and black dust, do 10–20 more.
8. The dust in the notch becomes a red ember. Carry it ON THE LEAF to the grass nest and blow.

8. Fire from your fire – keep it alive

- The easiest lighting is the one you do not need: cover the embers with ash at night, uncover in the morning and add thin twigs.
- Carrying: an ember in a tin can with holes or in a dry tinder fungus, wrapped in green leaves.

Always carry

☐ 2 BIC lighters in different pockets
☐ Ferro rod
☐ Stormproof matches in a waterproof case
☐ Petroleum-jelly cotton balls (10–20)
☐ Card-sized Fresnel lens

☐ A piece of fatwood or a candle
☐ Knife for shavings (feather sticks)

🚙 Sleeping in the car – like an overlander

Warm, safe, no carbon monoxide



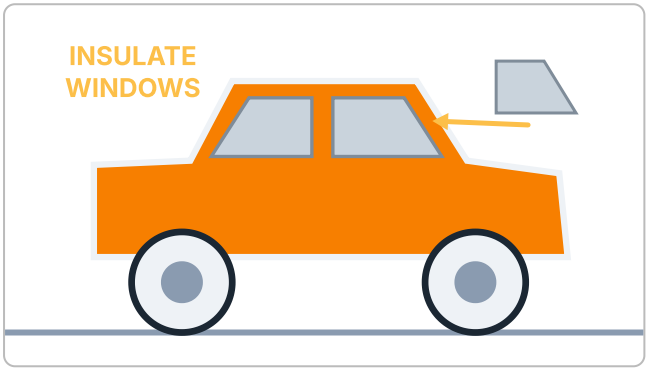
NEVER sleep with the engine running. Carbon monoxide (CO) gets into the cabin, especially if snow blocks the exhaust. It has no smell and you do not wake up.

⚠ NEVER sleep with the engine running. Carbon monoxide (CO) gets into the cabin, especially if snow blocks the exhaust. It has no smell and you do not wake up.

Where I park

- Level ground (you sleep much better). Nose or rear into the wind, so it does not hit the side.
- NOT in a stream bed, under dead branches/trees, below a slope with loose rocks or avalanche risk, next to a cliff.
- Away from the road (lights, snowploughs), but somewhere you can get out if it snows. In snow: nose toward the exit.
- Tell someone where you are (send the coordinates from the "Compass").

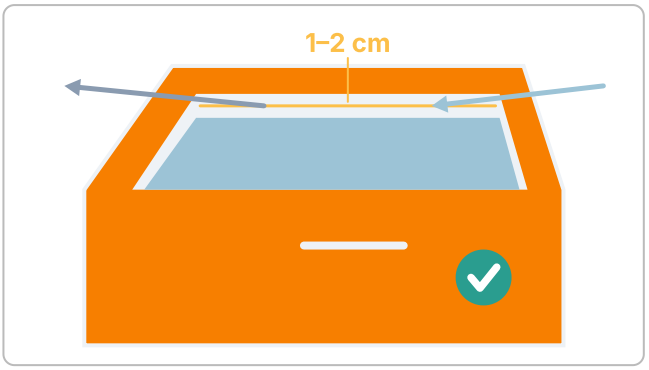
Insulating the cabin



Insulate the WINDOWS: that is where most heat escapes. Panels of reflectix or foam underlay, cut to the shape of each window, press-fit with no glue.

1. Insulate the WINDOWS: that is where most heat escapes. Cut panels of reflectix (foil bubble wrap) or foam underlay, shaped to each window. They press-fit, no glue.
2. Improvised: blankets, towels, foil blankets, cardboard held in by the doors/sun visors.
3. Curtain/blanket between the front seats and the rear – you heat only the sleeping area (microclimate).
4. On the floor/boot: foam pad + mattress. The car's metal is very cold.

Ventilation – condensation



Leave 1–2 windows open 1–2 cm. Without ventilation your breath turns to water and ice on the windows and sleeping bag.

- Leave 1–2 windows open 1–2 cm (with a mesh or wind deflector). Without ventilation your breath turns to water and ice on the windows and sleeping bag.
- Microfibre towel for the windows in the morning. Wet clothes in a bag, not spread out in the cabin.

Warmth

- The sleeping bag keeps you warm, not the engine. Winter in the north: comfort −15 to −20 °C, liner, foil blanket underneath.
- Hot-water bottle (heat water on a gas stove OUTSIDE the car).
- If you have a diesel heater: ONLY with proper installation, exhaust outside, and a CO detector inside. No CO detector, no heater.
- If you are stuck awake in snow: engine only 10 minutes every hour, exhaust clear of snow, window slightly open.

Fuel and safety

⚠ Petrol/diesel cans and gas canisters NEVER inside the cabin where you sleep. Fumes and fire. Outside, on the roof rack or in a closed external box.

⚠ Never a gas stove, candle or brazier inside the closed car.

- Fuel tank always above half. In the cold, diesel needs anti-gel additive/winter diesel.
- Do not drain the starter battery with lights and charging. Ideally a second battery (dual battery) or a power station.
- Lock the doors, keys in a fixed place (e.g. always the same pocket), head torch next to you.

Inside the sleeping bag I put

- Next day's clothes (warm in the morning).
- The water bottle (so it does not freeze) and the phone/powerbank (cold drains batteries).
- A bottle for peeing at night (marked!) – you do not go out into the cold.

In the morning

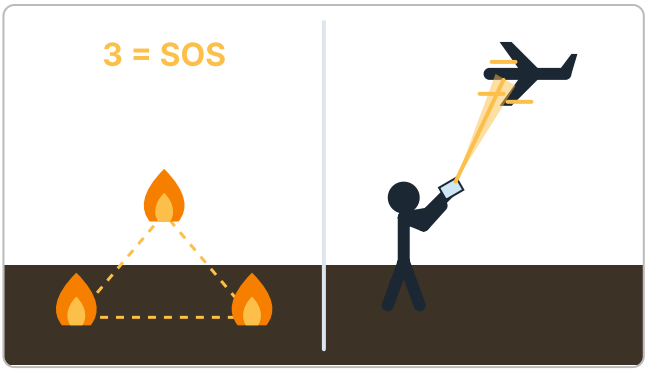
1. Clear snow from the roof, windows, lights, exhaust BEFORE starting the engine.
2. Put away the panels, air out the cabin.
3. Warm up the engine a little, drive gently for the first kilometres.

If you must move by car (evacuation, snow)

- Leave in daylight, tell someone your route, follow the authorities' instructions and the main roads.
- Snow chains INSIDE the car and you know how to fit them (try once at home).
- Car kit (see list), water, food, a sleeping bag for each passenger – you may be stuck for hours.
- In bad weather: slow, long distances between cars, no sudden braking. If you cannot see, stop in a safe place.
- Never drive into flowing water or into wildfire smoke.

📣 Signals so they can find you

Make yourself visible



THREE of anything = SOS, e.g. 3 fires in a triangle. With a mirror or CD, flash toward an aircraft – aim with your fingers in a V shape.

- THREE of anything = SOS: 3 whistle blasts, 3 fires in a triangle, 3 flashes.
- Whistle: carries much farther than your voice and does not tire you.
- Mirror / CD / phone: flashes toward an aircraft or ship. Aim with your fingers in a V shape.
- Smoke by day: green branches on a strong fire = white smoke.
- Light at night: torch in SOS (... – – – ...). In the app: the 🔦 SOS button.
- Bright clothes/cloths in an open spot.

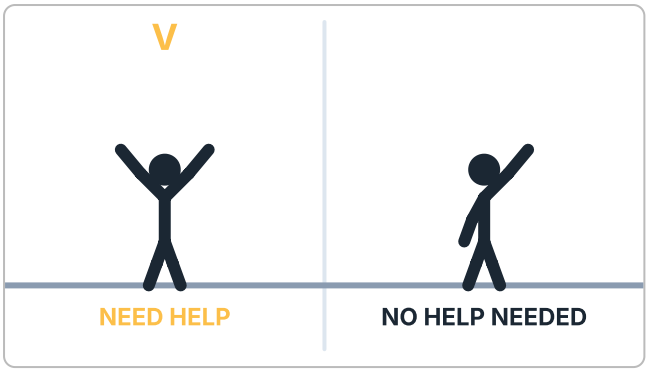
Ground-to-air signals (large, 3 m+)



Ground-to-air signals, large (3 m+), with stones, branches or cloth: V help, X medical help, Y yes, N no, arrow = I am going this way.

- V = I need help
- X = I need medical help
- Y = Yes
- N = No
- → (arrow) = I am going this way

Arm signals



Both arms up in a V = “I need help”. One arm up, one down = “I do not need help”.

- Both arms up in a V = “I need help”.
- One arm up, one down = “I do not need help”.

Morse SOS

- ··· —— ··· (3 short, 3 long, 3 short).

💡 The full Morse alphabet (Greek and Latin) and sending words with light and sound: 🔦 SOS → 📡 Morse.

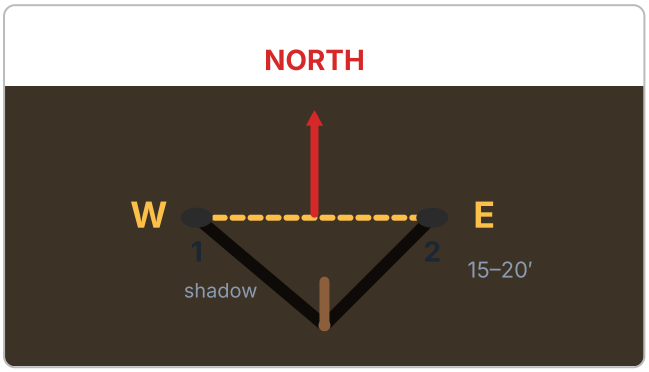
🌞 Navigation without a compass

Sun, shadow, stars

The sun

- It rises roughly in the EAST and sets roughly in the WEST. At midday (in Greece) it is in the SOUTH.

Stick and shadow (very reliable)



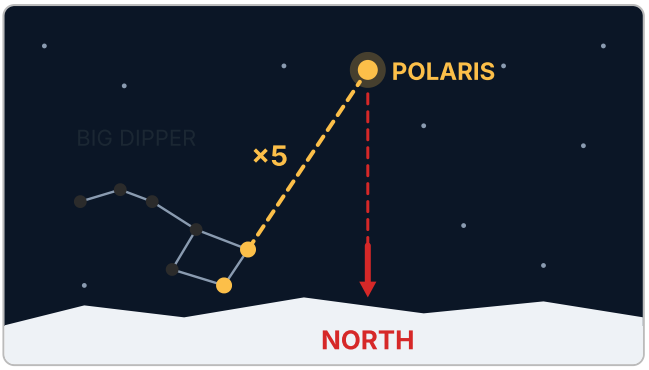
Stick in the ground. Pebble 1 at the tip of the shadow, after 15–20 minutes pebble 2 at the new tip. The line 1→2 points WEST→EAST. With 1 on your left and 2 on your right you face NORTH.

1. Push a straight stick into the ground. Put a pebble at the tip of the shadow.
2. Wait 15–20 minutes. Put a second pebble at the new tip.
3. The line from the 1st to the 2nd points WEST → EAST.
4. Stand with the 1st on your left and the 2nd on your right: you are facing NORTH.

Analogue watch

- Point the hour hand at the sun. Halfway between the hour hand and 12 (1 in summer, due to daylight saving time) points SOUTH.

Polaris (night)



Find the Big Dipper (the “saucepan”). The two stars at its end point to Polaris, about 5 times the distance between them. Polaris = NORTH.

- Find the Big Dipper (the “saucepan”). The two stars at its end point to Polaris, ~5 times the distance between them. Polaris = NORTH.

Signs that are NOT reliable

⚠ Moss “on the north side” and ants are not reliable. Do not trust them.

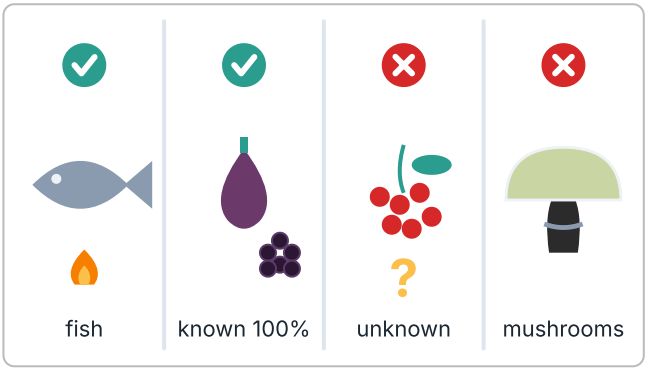
💡 In the app's “Compass”: hold the phone flat, away from metal and speakers. If it is wrong, move it in “figure eights” in the air to calibrate.

🍞 Food in the wild

The last thing to worry about

- A healthy person can live weeks without food. Without water, do not eat (digestion needs water).
- First eat what you carry, in portions. Spread the calories – half a portion for many days.

Safer sources



Well-cooked fish and known fruit you are 100% sure of (e.g. figs, blackberries): yes. NEVER unknown plants, berries or mushrooms.

- Fish (well cooked). Fishing line and hooks fit in a small bag.
- Shellfish from clean waters: limpets, clams – beware of enclosed bays and after rain.
- Snails: ONLY well purged (starved for days) and well boiled.
- Known fruit you are 100% sure of: blackberries, figs, strawberry-tree fruit, chestnuts, walnuts, almonds (sweet), carob.

⚠ NEVER unknown plants, berries, mushrooms. See "Mushrooms & wild plants".

⚠ Bitter almonds and many fruit pits contain cyanide.

🍄 Mushrooms & wild plants: why NOT

The most common deadly trap



In a survival situation we DO NOT eat wild mushrooms – never based on a photo, an app or "it looks like". Cooking does not make them safe.

⚠ In a survival situation we DO NOT eat wild mushrooms. Never based on a photo, an app or "it looks like".

Why

- The DEATH CAP (Amanita phalloides) and its relatives grow in Greece too and look like edible ones.
- Symptoms are delayed 6–24 hours. When they appear, the liver is already damaged. A "false recovery" may follow.
- Cooking, vinegar, the "silver spoon" test, "animals ate it" do NOT work. They are myths.
- Mushrooms give very few calories. The risk is huge, the gain is zero.

If someone ate a wild mushroom and feels unwell (or you are not sure)



1 Call the Poison Centre 210 7793777 or 166 IMMEDIATELY, even if they feel fine. 2 Keep the remaining mushrooms. 3 Note the time and who ate them.

1. Poison Centre 210 7793777 or 166 IMMEDIATELY – even if they feel fine.
2. Keep the remaining mushrooms (and leftovers) for identification.
3. Note the time they were eaten and who ate them. Everyone to hospital.

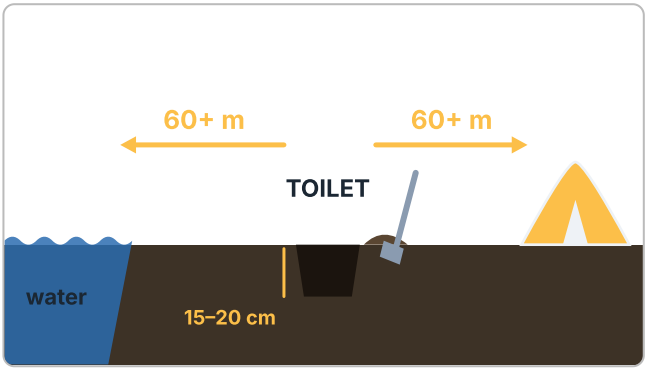
Wild plants

- Many poisonous plants look like edible ones (e.g. hemlock like wild carrot/fennel, oleander, thorn apple).
- Eat only greens/fruit you already know 100%, the way grandma picked them, and away from roads and sprayed fields.

💡 As a hobby: learn mushrooms with a mycological society and on outings with experts. Not from apps.

🧼 Hygiene and toilet

Disease kills after the disaster



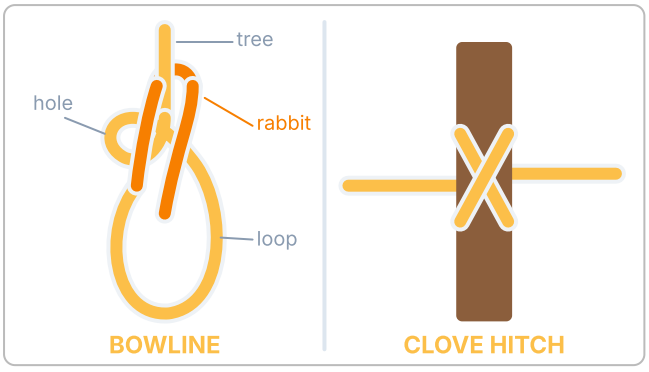
Toilet in the wild: a hole 15–20 cm deep, 60+ m away from water and from the shelter. Then cover it with soil. ALWAYS wash your hands.

- Wash hands before eating and after the toilet. ALWAYS.
- Toilet in the wild: hole 15–20 cm deep, 60+ m away from water and shelter, cover it.

- Toilet at home with no water: bucket with a double bag, a little bleach or ash/sawdust after each use, lid, keep it outside.
- Rubbish: in closed bags, away from the house (rats).
- Feet: dry socks, check for blisters every evening.
- Teeth: brush, even with salt/baking soda.

🪢 Knots worth knowing

4 knots for everything



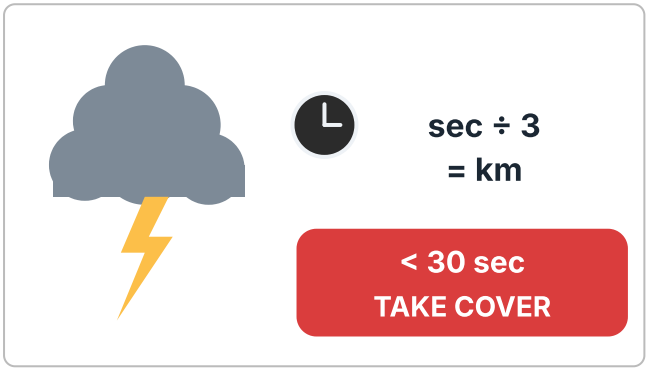
Bowline: a loop that does not tighten – "the rabbit comes out of the hole, goes around the tree and goes back in". Clove hitch: two turns around a post, crossed.

- BOWLINE: a loop that does not tighten. Rescue, tying to a tree. "The rabbit comes out of the hole, goes around the tree and goes back in".
- CLOVE HITCH: tie quickly to a post/branch.
- TAUT-LINE HITCH: adjustable tension for tarp and tent.
- SHEET BEND: joins two ropes of different thickness.

💡 Learn them at home with a cord, until you can tie them with your eyes closed.

🌦️ The weather talks to you

Signs without a forecast



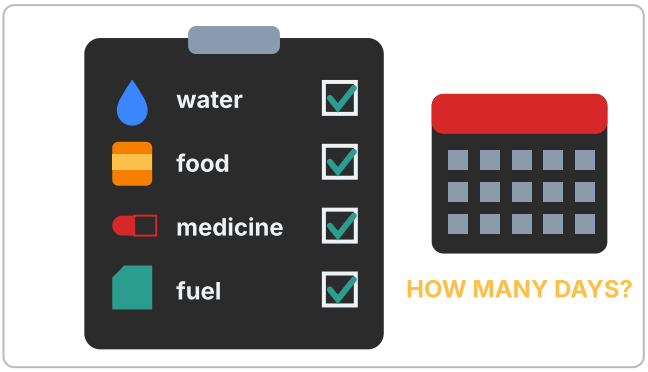
Lightning: count the seconds until the thunder and divide by 3 = kilometres. Under 30 seconds = take cover now. Clouds building like towers in the afternoon = thunderstorm.

- Clouds building up high like towers in the afternoon = thunderstorm, lightning.
- Halo (ring) around the sun/moon = moisture coming, often rain in 12–24 hours.
- Sudden temperature drop and wind change = a front.
- Red sky at night: usually good weather. Red in the morning: often turns bad.
- Lightning: count seconds until the thunder ÷ 3 = kilometres. Under 30 seconds = take cover now.

🔄 After 72 hours

Organising for weeks

First



Inventory: how much water, food, medicine and fuel we have, and for how many days. Then a consumption plan and shifts.

- Inventory: how much water, food, medicine, fuel do we have? For how many days?
- Rations: a consumption plan. Perishable fresh food first.
- Shifts: who fetches water, who cooks, who keeps watch, who looks after children/elderly people.

Community

- Organise with your neighbours: shared kitchen, a list of who needs what, who knows what (doctor, electrician, handyman).
- Find out where the aid distribution points and the municipality's shelters are.

Safety

- Do not show off your supplies. Lock up.
- Move in groups. Say where you are going and when you will be back.
- Beware of scams (fake "officials", fake fundraisers).

Health

- Clean water, hand washing, toilet far away – you stop epidemics.
- Small wounds: clean them daily (they get infected easily).
- Chronic illnesses: find a pharmacy/doctor early, before the medicine runs out.

Returning home

- Only when the authorities say so. Check for cracks, gas, electricity, water. Photograph damage for compensation before you clean up.

📡 Plotter – how to get back precisely (and elevation)

N-UP / H-UP / C-UP, RM / TM, marks, return

💡 The plotter works like a ship's radar or a Garmin: you, your track, your points and the target inside range rings. It works without internet (the background map only if you download it first).

Before you leave – 1 minute

1. Go to an open spot. Wait until "Accuracy" shows ±10 m or better (green).
2. Press "● Record my route". The first point becomes 🏁 Start.
3. Turn on "💡 Screen always on" and keep the app open – with the phone locked GPS stops.
4. If you want a map underneath: "📥 Offline map" (needs Wi-Fi, 2–3 km around you).

The buttons – like a radar

- N-UP (North up): North always up, like a map. Best to understand where you are.
- H-UP (Head up): up is where you face (phone compass). You turn, the picture turns. Easiest when standing and looking for a direction.
- C-UP (Course up): up is where you REALLY move (from GPS). Metal and magnets do not affect it – best when walking or driving.
- RM (Relative Motion): you always stay in the centre, the world "moves" around you.
- TM (True Motion): the picture stays still and you move across it. Near the edge it recentres by itself.
- ➖ ➕ AUTO: range 50 m – 50 km or 0.125 – 48 NM. AUTO fits your track and target by itself. Dashed rings are like a radar's (e.g. 4 NM → every 1 NM, 1 km → every 250 m).
- Green line = where you will be in 2 minutes (COG/SOG). White line = where you face. Yellow dashed = straight line to the target.
- 🚩 MARK: one-tap mark here (junction, spring, car). Put one at every turn.
- ⚓ NM / km: with "NM" ranges are in nautical miles like a radar (0.125 … 4 · 6 · 8 · 10 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 48 NM) and speed in knots (kn). With "km" in metres/kilometres.
- Courses from fix to fix: the light-blue line joins 🏁 → 🚩1 → 🚩2 → … → you and shows course ° and distance – like plotting on the chart on the bridge. "📋 Fixes" = a log with time, position, course, distance and speed.
- 💾 GPX: saves your track (with altitude) and waypoints to a file that opens in Garmin, Google Earth, OpenCPN, Navionics.
- 💡 Screen / 🔋 Pocket: with the screen off the phone does NOT record position. "💡 Screen" = it never turns off by itself. "🔋 Pocket" = a black screen with a few dim details – on an OLED screen it uses very little battery; exit with a 2″ long press so it does not exit by accident in your pocket. Do not press the lock button.
- If the screen turns off while recording, the app warns you when you reopen it and the missing part is shown as a thin dashed line (straight – not the real way).

Getting back (e.g. from 1 km)

1. 🏁 "Back to start": the start becomes the target. Follow the yellow arrow – BRG/RNG show bearing and distance.
2. Mountain, forest, smoke, dark: "↩️ Same way back" – leads you point by point along the way you came (safer than the straight line, which may cross a cliff or stream).
3. For the last 10–20 m look around: phone GPS has ±5–10 m error (a Garmin ±3–5 m).

How accurate it is

- The app averages many readings, throws away "jumps" and records nothing while you stand still – so the line does not "shake".

- Worst GPS: between tall buildings, in a gorge, in dense forest, inside a car. Keep the phone high, on top of the backpack or in your hand.
- The compass (H-UP) needs “figure-8” calibration and distance from metal. If it disagrees with C-UP while walking straight, trust C-UP (GPS).
- Battery: GPS + screen ≈ 10–15% per hour. Take a power bank. Low brightness.

⛰️ Elevation – how many metres you climb and descend

- ↗ Ascent / ↘ Descent: all the metres you climbed and descended since the start (like Garmin “Total ascent / descent”). Ups and downs under 4 m are ignored so GPS noise does not inflate them.
- Grade %: how steep uphill (+) or downhill (–) the stretch you are on is. Over 20% is steep.
- Profile: the shape of your route – start 🏁 on the left, you 🔵 on the right, ▲ the highest point. The green dashed line = the height of the start.
- “To go back the same way”: how much you will climb and descend on the way back. If you went 300 m down into a gorge you will climb it again – plan time, water and strength (≈ 1 hour per 300–400 m of climb with a backpack).
- GPS altitude has a ±10–20 m error; ascent/descent is more reliable because it measures differences. On some Android phones in Greece it reads ~35–40 m too high. Use “📏 Calibrate altitude” at a known point (a sign, a summit, 0 m at the sea).

⚠ The phone is an aid. In the mountains also carry a paper map and compass, and tell someone where you go and when you return.

🛒 Equipment guide

🛏 Blanket or sleeping bag?

What keeps you warmer

Short answer

- For SLEEPING in the cold: sleeping bag + sleeping pad. Much more warmth per kilo.
- For HOME, CAR, FIRE: wool blanket. Tough, does not catch fire easily, stays warm even when wet.
- For the BACKPACK: emergency (foil) blanket + sleeping bag if it fits.

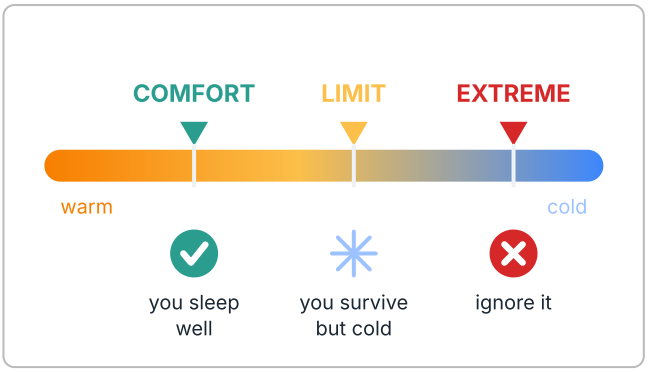
Comparison



Wool blanket: warm even when wet. Fleece: melts in fire. Cotton: no warmth when wet. Foil blanket: emergencies only.

- Wool blanket: + warm when wet, hard to burn, lasts for years, many uses (sling, stretcher). – heavy (2–3 kg), bulky.
- Fleece blanket: + light, cheap, dries fast. – melts in fire, less warmth.
- Cotton blanket: – gives no warmth at all when wet. Not for survival.
- Foil blanket (mylar): + 60 grams, blocks wind, keeps body heat, signalling. – tears, traps moisture inside. Emergencies only.
- Bivy / survival bag (like a mylar sack): better than a foil blanket, ~100–300 g.

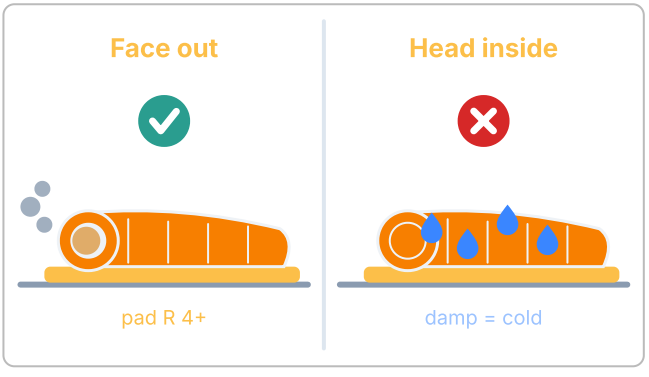
Sleeping bag: what to look for



Look at the COMFORT temperature: you sleep well at it. LIMIT means "you survive but you are cold". Ignore EXTREME.

- COMFORT temperature (ISO 23537 / EN 13537): you sleep comfortably at this. LIMIT means "survive while cold". Ignore EXTREME.
- Southern Greece / islands, winter: comfort about 0 °C to −5 °C. Summer: +10 °C.
- NORTHERN Greece, mountains, winter months (and a home with no power): comfort −15 °C to −20 °C. An unheated house in Florina or Metsovo drops below zero within a few days.
- Better too warm than too cold: if you are warm, open the zip. If you are cold, there is nothing you can do.
- Down: light, packs small, warm – but gives no warmth when wet. Fill power 600+.
- Synthetic: heavier and bulkier, but stays warm when damp. Better for home/car/humidity.
- A "mummy" shape keeps more heat. It needs a hood with a drawcord.
- Extra: a liner (inner bag) adds +2 to +5 °C.

Head outside



Nose and mouth OUTSIDE the sleeping bag, hood tight around the face, a pad underneath. Breathing inside wets the filling and you get cold.

- Keep your nose and mouth OUTSIDE the sleeping bag. Breath inside = moisture = wet filling = cold. Tighten the hood around your face and wear a beanie.

Foil blanket (emergency blanket): one for everyone

- 60 grams, smaller than a wallet, reflects body heat back. One for each family member in the backpack, one in the car, one in the jacket.
- Use: under the sleeping pad, or wrapped OUTSIDE the sleeping bag/blanket. Inside the sleeping bag only for 1 emergency night (it traps moisture).
- In a shipwreck/for an injured person: wrap the whole body and head, leave the face free.

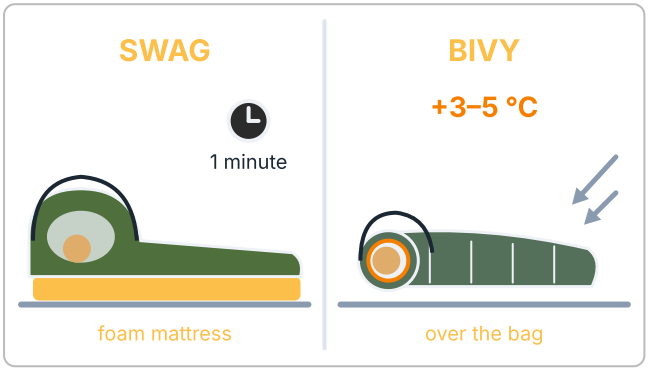
SLEEPING PAD: the most forgotten item

- The ground "sucks" the heat out of you. Without insulation you get cold even in the best sleeping bag.
- R-value: summer 2, winter 4+, snow 5+. Two pads together = values add up.
- Foam: cannot puncture, cheap. Inflatable: comfortable, small, but needs a repair kit.

💡 Sleep in DRY clothes and a beanie. Eat something fatty before bed. Pee before you sleep – the body wastes no heat on extra fluid.

🛌 Swag, bivy and one-person tents

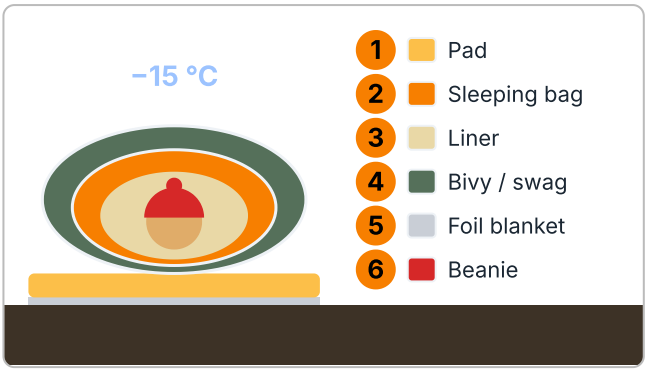
A bed-shelter for one person



SWAG: waterproof canvas with a foam mattress and a small hoop over the head, opens in 1 minute. BIVY: a waterproof bag over the sleeping bag, blocks the wind (+3–5 °C).

- SWAG (Australia): waterproof canvas with a built-in foam mattress and a small "tent" on top. Opens in 1 minute, you put your sleeping bag inside. Ideal for overlanding, a car roof, and also INSIDE the house when there is no heating.
- BIVY (bivvy bag): a waterproof bag that goes over the sleeping bag. Blocks wind, adds 3–5 °C, light (300–700 g). Some have a hoop over the head like a mini tent.
- Survival bag (emergency bivy, silver): 100–300 g, for the backpack and the car. Better than a plain foil blanket because it closes around you.

The combination that works in the cold



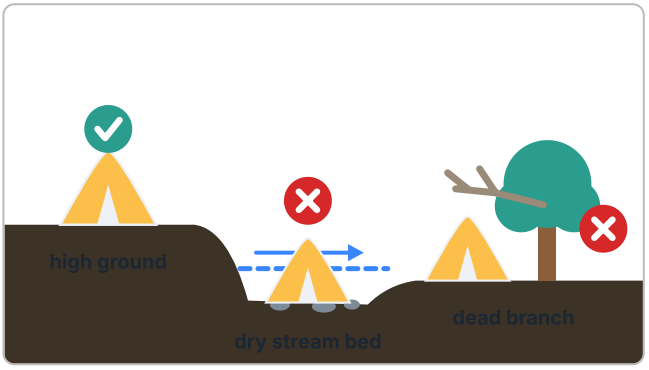
All together in the cold (seen from the head end): foil blanket and pad underneath, sleeping bag with liner, bivy or swag outside, beanie and face out.

1. Insulation underneath (foam + inflatable, or the swag mattress).
2. Sleeping bag comfort −15 to −20 °C for northern Greece/mountains in winter.
3. Liner inside (+2 to +5 °C).
4. Bivy or swag outside (wind, moisture, +3–5 °C).
5. Foil blanket under everything, or on top in very cold weather.
6. Beanie, wool socks, face outside.

💡 All of this also works inside a cold house: a swag or a small tent in the living room makes a huge difference.

⛺ Tent – shelter

Do I need a tent?



Pitch higher than the water. NEVER in a dry stream bed (flood) and NEVER under a dead branch.

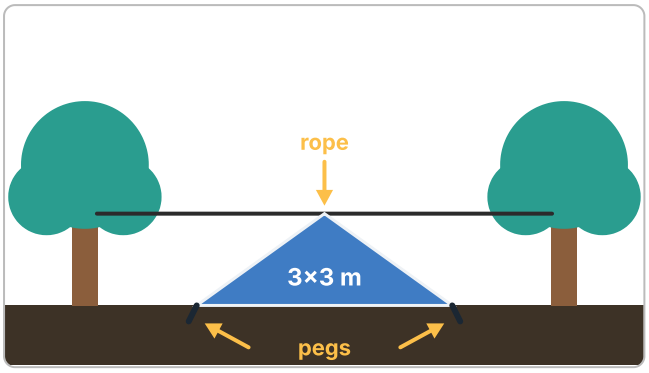
- For a disaster in the city: usually NO. Shelters, relatives, the car. But a tent helps if you cannot stay in a house after an earthquake.

- For outside the city/mountains: yes, or a tarp + rope, which is lighter.

What to look for in a tent

- 3-season for Greece. 4-season only for snow/mountains.
- Pitched in 5 minutes by 1 person. Try it at home first.
- Hydrostatic head: fly 2000+ mm, floor 3000+ mm.
- Capacity: get 1 person bigger (2 people → 3-person tent) for gear.
- Family tent: can become a "room" in the garden after an earthquake.

Tarp



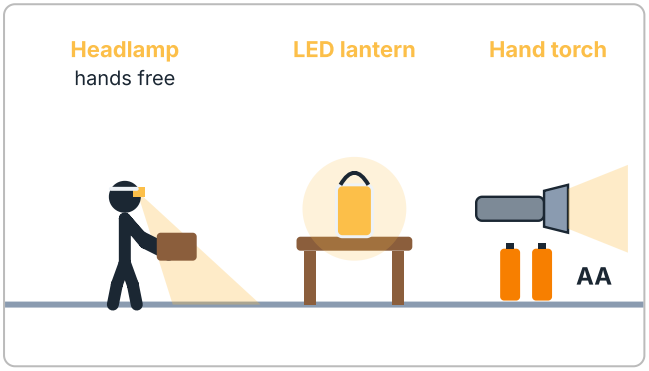
Tarp 3×3 m: a rope between two trees, the sheet over it and the edges fixed with pegs.

- 3×3 m with grommets, 300–600 g. A thousand ways to pitch it. Together with rope and pegs.
- Cheap option: thick builder's plastic sheet + rope.

💡 Always pitch higher than water, NEVER in a dry stream bed (flood) and NEVER under a dead branch.

🔦 Torches and lighting

What to get



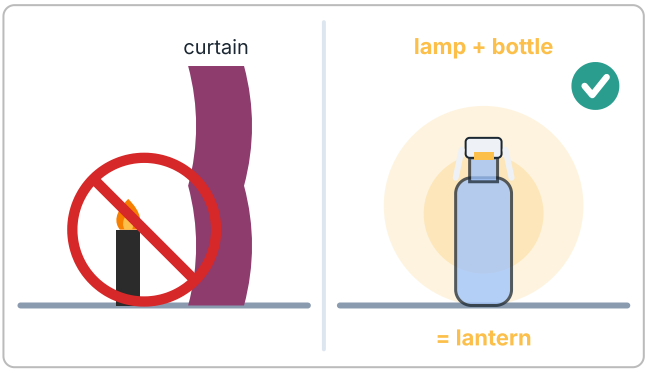
A headlamp for each member: light where you look and hands free. An LED lantern for the table, a sturdy hand torch with AA/AAA batteries.

- A HEADLAMP for each member: hands free. The most useful light.
- LED lantern for the room/table.
- Sturdy handheld torch, waterproof IPX4 or better IPX7.

What to look for

- Batteries: prefer AA or AAA – found everywhere. Or rechargeable via USB-C + spares.
- Lumens: 200–400 are enough for everything. 3000 lumens drain the battery quickly.
- A low mode (5–20 lm) that lasts 50+ hours – this is what you use most of the time.
- Red light: does not ruin night vision, does not wake others.
- SOS/strobe mode.
- Lithium AA batteries: handle cold and 10–20 years of storage. Alkaline ones can leak – take them out of torches in storage.

Candles?



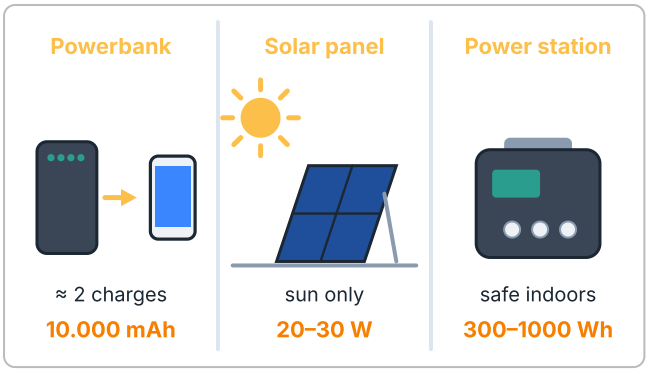
A candle only on a stable base, away from curtains, never while sleeping. Better: strap a headlamp onto a water bottle with the light facing the bottle = a lantern for the whole room.

- Only on a stable base, away from curtains, never while sleeping, never with children alone. Prefer LED.

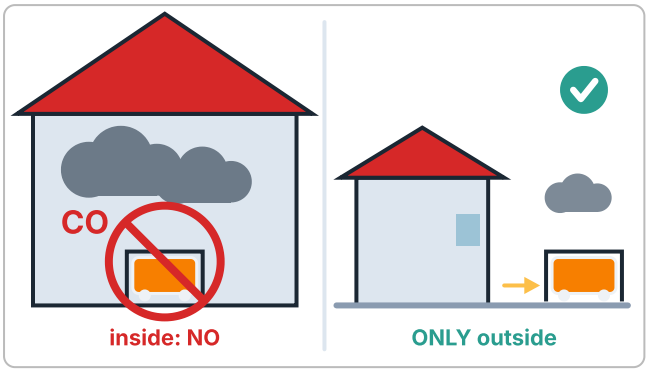
💡 Strap a headlamp onto a water bottle with the light facing the bottle = a lantern for the whole room.

🔋 Power – charging

Power bank, solar, generator



Power bank 10,000 mAh ≈ 2 phone charges. A foldable 20–30 W solar panel charges by day, only in sun. Power station 300–1000 Wh: safe inside the house.



A petrol generator ONLY outdoors, away from doors and windows. Inside the house or garage, carbon monoxide (CO) kills.

- Power bank 10,000 mAh ≈ 2 phone charges. 20,000 mAh ≈ 4. Recharge them every 3 months.
- Foldable solar panel 20–30 W: charges a phone during the day (only in sun).
- Power station (large battery 300–1000 Wh): light, router, medical devices, charging. Safe inside the house. With a solar panel = independence.
- Petrol generator: lots of power but noise, fuel, and ONLY outdoors (carbon monoxide).
- USB car charger.

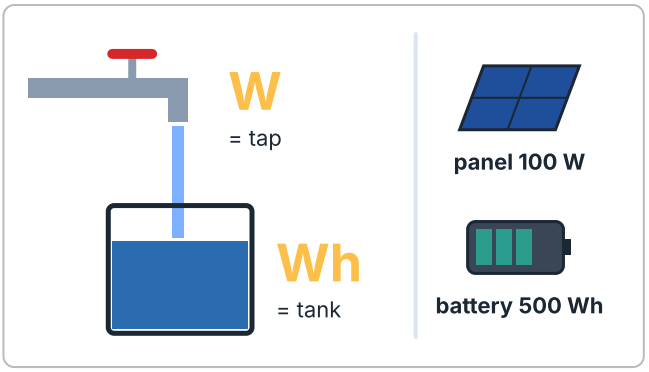
💡 Phone: low power mode, no data/Bluetooth, dim screen, no video. Airplane mode when you don't need signal. GPS still works in airplane mode on most phones.

☀️ Solar panels: correct use

Power from the sun when everything is down

💡 A solar panel with a battery (power station or powerbank) is the only power source that does not run out. In a crisis lasting many days it is vital.

The two numbers you need to know



Like a tap and a tank: W says how far the tap is open (how strong right now), Wh how much water is in the tank (how much energy it holds).

- W (Watt) = how "strong" something is RIGHT NOW. 100 W panel, 5 W lamp.
- Wh (watt-hours) = how much energy is stored or used. 500 Wh battery. 5 W lamp for 10 hours = 50 Wh.
- Like a tap and a tank: W is how far the tap is open, Wh is how much water is in the tank.

How much it really produces

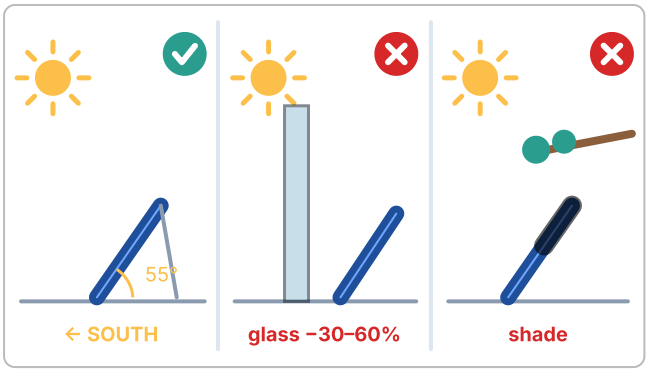
- In practice a panel gives about 50–70% of the W written on it. 100 W panel ≈ 60–70 W in good sun.
- Greece: ~3 hours of "strong sun" in winter, ~6–7 in summer.
- Example: 100 W panel in winter ≈ 100 × 3 × 0.7 ≈ 200 Wh per day. In summer ≈ 450 Wh.
- Cloud: drops to 10–25%. Shade: almost zero.

What can I power with 200 Wh a day

- Mobile phone: ~15 Wh per full charge → 10+ phones.
- 5 W LED lamp: 40 hours of light.
- Radio: practically all day.
- 10 W internet router: ~20 hours (if the line works).
- Laptop: 3–4 charges.

⚠ Fridge, electric heater, air conditioner, kettle, hair dryer: NOT with a small system. A 2000 W kettle empties a 500 Wh battery in 15 minutes.

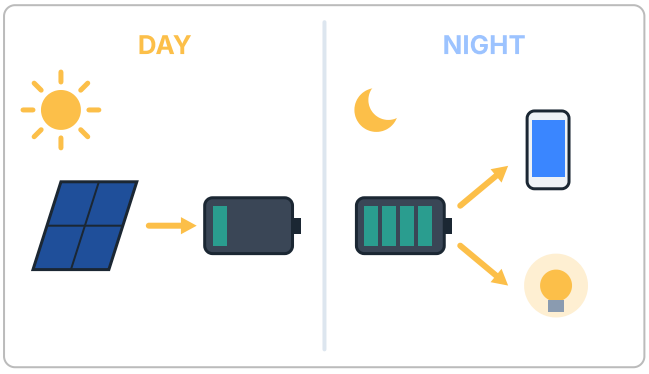
Correct use – step by step



Panel OUTSIDE, facing SOUTH, tilted (winter ~55°). Behind glass it loses 30–60%. A little shade on one part drops the WHOLE panel.

1. Put the panel OUTSIDE. Behind glass it loses 30–60% (modern insulated glazing even more).
2. Point it SOUTH (use the app's compass).
3. Tilt: in WINTER almost upright (~55° from the ground). In SUMMER flatter (~25°). Simple test: the panel's shadow behind it should be as small as possible.
4. Turn it towards the sun every 2–3 hours: morning east, midday south, afternoon west. You gain 20–40%.
5. NO shade at all – not even a branch or a railing. A little shade on one part drops the WHOLE panel.
6. Clean off dust, snow, leaves with a cloth.
7. Leave air space behind it: too much heat lowers output.

The big secret: charge a BATTERY, not the phone



By day: panel → battery (powerbank or power station). At night: battery → phone, light, radio.

- By day: panel → powerbank or power station. At night: battery → phone, light, radio.
- When a cloud passes, the phone stops and restarts charging and gets worn out. The battery in between protects it.
- Start charging in the MORNING. The day's sun does not come back.

What to buy

- ☐ Foldable 60–100 W panel with USB-C (PD) and DC output – for backpack and car
- ☐ 300–1000 Wh power station (LiFePO4 battery: safer, thousands of cycles) with solar input (MPPT)
- ☐ Match the PLUGS before the crisis (MC4, Anderson, DC8020, USB-C). Test the whole system once
- ☐ Small 10–20 W panel + 20,000 mAh powerbank for each backpack
- ☐ Short cables (long cable = lost energy)

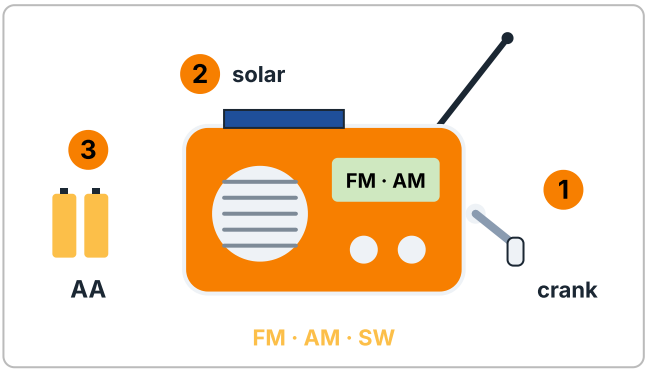
Safety

⚠ Lithium batteries: not in a hot car in summer, not covered while charging, not next to a child's bed. If they swell, smell or smoke: take them outside and move away.

- Foldable panels can take drizzle, but the sockets and the box on the back CANNOT. Bring them in when it rains.
- Medical devices (CPAP, oxygen concentrator): measure NOW how many W they draw and how many hours you need. These get first priority for power.
- The car is also a generator: it charges USB with the engine running – ONLY outdoors, never in a closed garage.

📻 Radio

The only news when everything goes down



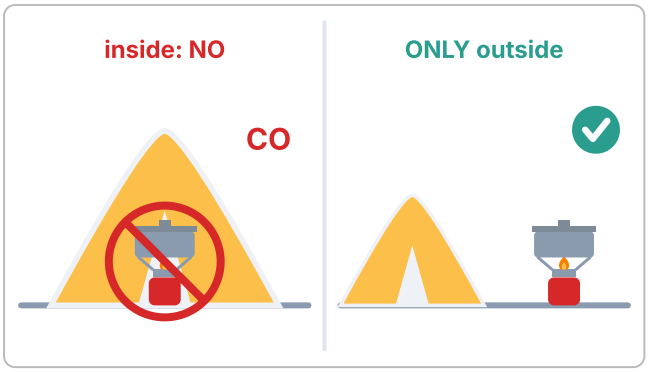
FM + AM radio (and SW if possible) with 3 ways to charge: 1 hand crank, 2 solar, 3 AA batteries.

- FM + AM (medium wave) at least. Hand crank + solar + AA batteries = 3 ways to charge.
- Useful: a torch and a USB output for the phone (a little charge).
- Shortwave (SW): you hear news from abroad if local stations go down.

- Write on paper the frequencies of the stations in your area (ERT).

Cooking – camping stoves

Hot food without power

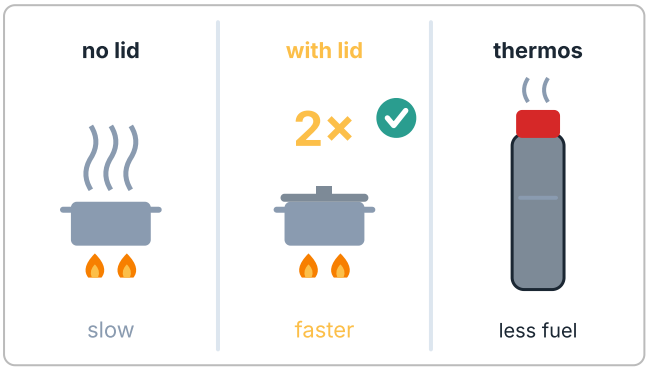


No flame stove inside a house, tent or closed space: carbon monoxide (CO) and fire. Cook ONLY outdoors.

- Camping stove with butane canisters: cheap, easy. In the cold (below ~0 °C) butane works poorly – get an isobutane/propane mix.
- Alcohol stove: simple, silent, no parts to break. Slow.
- Wood stove (small, foldable): fuel from nature, for outdoors.
- Charcoal grill: ONLY outdoors.

⚠ No flame stove inside a closed space or tent. Carbon monoxide and fire.

Cookware



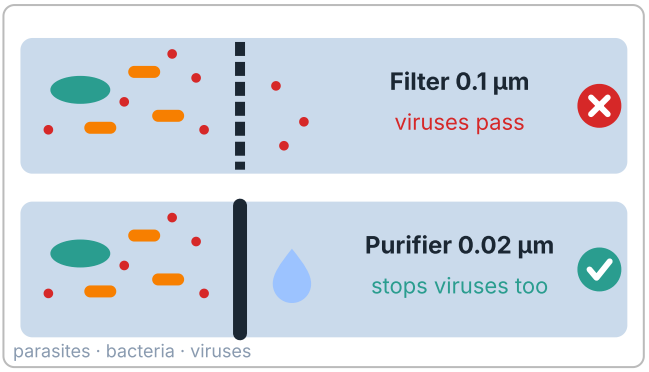
A lid makes boiling 2 times faster, with less fuel. A thermos keeps water hot.

- Stainless steel or titanium pot with a lid (the lid makes boiling 2 times faster).
- Stainless steel mug that can go on the fire (for boiling water).
- Spork (spoon-fork), knife, small sponge, lighter.
- Family: 2–3 L pot, frying pan, wooden spoon.
- Thermos: keeps water hot – less fuel.

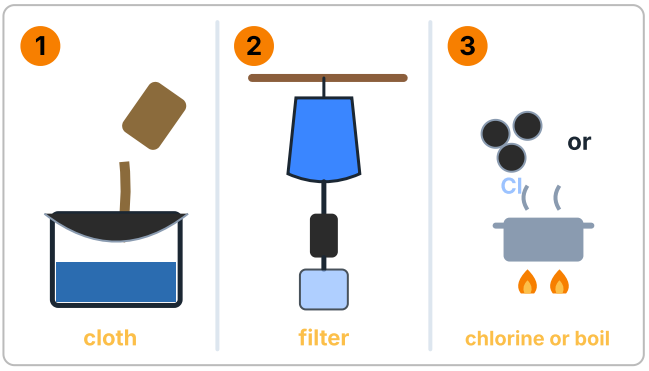
💡 "Haybox" cooking: boil rice/beans 5 minutes, wrap the pot in blankets for 1–2 hours. It cooks with little fuel.

Water: filters and treatment

What really cleans it



Filter 0.1–0.2 µm: stops bacteria and parasites, NOT viruses. Purifier 0.02 µm (or with chemical): stops viruses too.



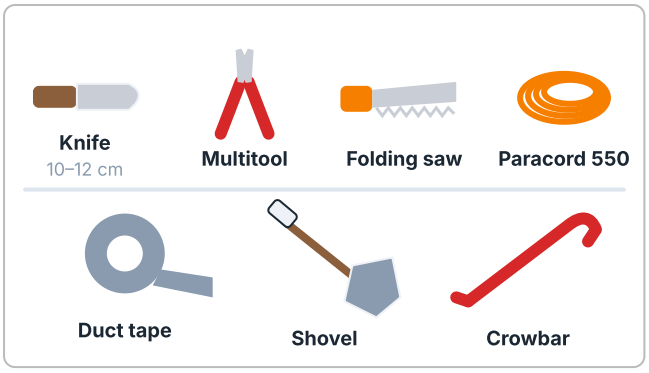
Best combination: 1 pre-filter with a cloth, 2 filter (e.g. a hanging gravity bag), 3 chlorine or boiling.

- Hollow-fibre filter (0.1–0.2 µm): stops bacteria and parasites. Does NOT stop viruses and chemicals.
- Purifier (0.02 µm or with chemical): also viruses. For cities after a disaster, prefer this or filter + chlorine.
- Chlorine dioxide tablets: kill almost everything, wait 30 minutes to 4 hours (see instructions).
- Boiling: the surest against germs. Does not remove chemicals.
- Activated carbon filter: improves taste, removes some chemicals, not germs.
- Gravity filter (hanging bucket/bag): ideal for a family.

💡 Best combination: pre-filter with cloth → filter → chlorine or boiling.

🔪 Knife – tools

The essentials



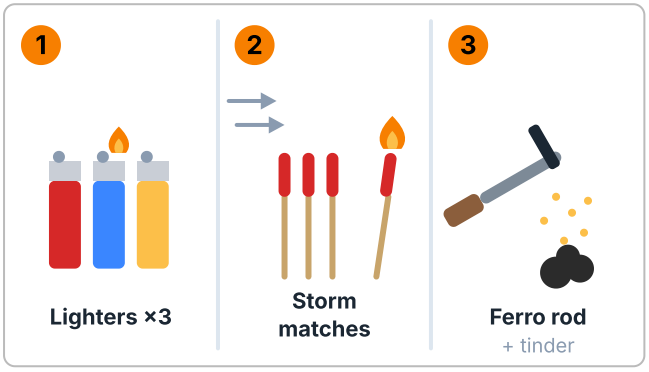
The essentials: fixed-blade knife 10–12 cm, multitool, folding saw, paracord, duct tape, folding shovel and a crowbar for doors after an earthquake.

- Fixed-blade knife 10–12 cm, stainless or carbon steel. For wood, fire, food.
- Multitool with pliers: for repairs.
- Folding saw: clean wood cutting, better and safer than an axe.
- Paracord 550: 250 kg strength, 7 inner strands.
- Duct tape: repairs, bandaging, blisters.
- Folding shovel: toilet, fire, snow.
- Crowbar: doors after an earthquake.

⚠ Check the law on carrying knives in the city. In the home backpack it is no problem.

🔥 Fire: lighters and tinder

3 ways, always



Always 3 ways to make fire: 1 lighters (take 3), 2 waterproof storm matches, 3 a ferro rod that works even wet, with ready tinder (cotton with petroleum jelly).

- BIC lighter or similar: the most reliable. Get 3.
- Waterproof / windproof matches (storm matches): burn even in wind.
- Ferro rod: thousands of sparks, works even when wet.
- Ready tinder: cotton with petroleum jelly in a film canister/zip bag, fire starter cubes, pine cone pieces with resin.

🧥 Clothes – footwear

Layering system



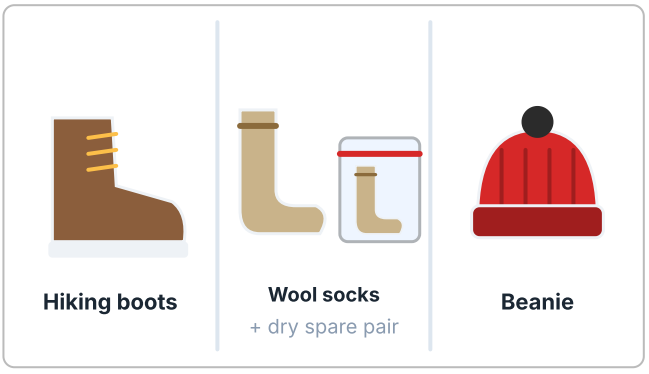
3-layer system: 1 base on the skin (merino or synthetic), 2 insulation (fleece or puffer jacket), 3 waterproof windproof shell with hood. NO cotton in the cold.

1. Base (next to skin): merino wool or synthetic that wicks sweat. NO cotton.
2. Insulation: fleece or down/synthetic jacket.
3. Outer: waterproof windproof shell with hood (Gore-Tex or similar).

- Remove a layer BEFORE you sweat. Sweat in the cold = hypothermia.

⚠ "Cotton kills" in the cold: when wet, it loses warmth and does not dry.

Footwear

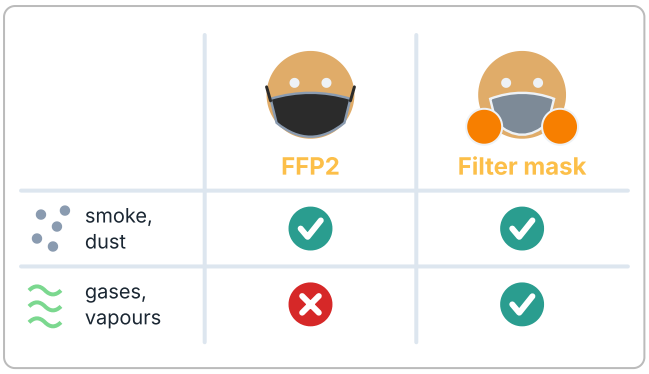


Worn-in hiking boots, wool socks and a spare pair always dry in a zip bag. A beanie is the cheapest way to stay warm.

- Hiking boots, broken in, with a good sole. Near fire: leather, not synthetic mesh.
- Wool socks + one spare pair always dry in a small bag.
- Beanie: the cheapest way to get warm.

😷 Masks – protection

What protects from what



FFP2 stops particles (dust, smoke, viruses) but NOT gases. For gases and vapours you need a respirator with filters (e.g. A2B2E2K2-P3). No particle mask protects against carbon monoxide.

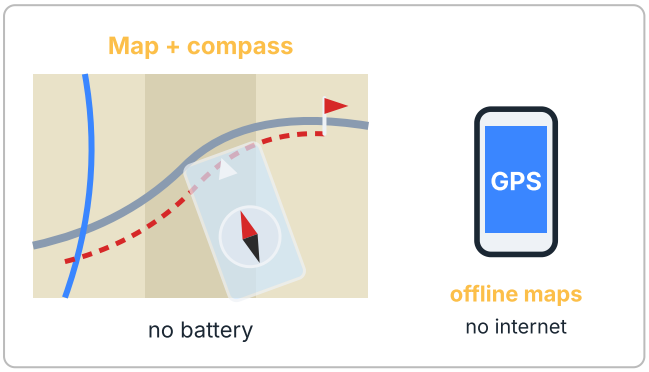
- FFP2: dust, smoke (particles), viruses. For earthquake, fire.
- FFP3: more protection against particles, radioactive dust.
- Respirator with filters (half/full face) A2B2E2K2-P3: gases and vapours – needs training, a fit without a beard.

⚠ No particle mask protects against gases or carbon monoxide.

- Closed safety goggles for ash and smoke.

🗺️ Map – compass – GPS

Don't rely only on your phone

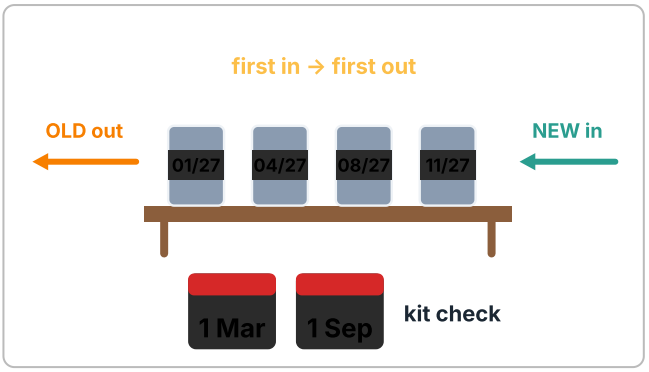


A paper map with your escape routes and a baseplate compass: no battery needed. On the phone, download offline maps in advance – GPS works without internet.

- Paper map of your area and your escape routes.
- Baseplate compass – cheap and needs no battery.
- On the phone: download offline maps in advance (Google Maps offline, Organic Maps, Maps.me). GPS works without internet.
- In the app: the 🧭 "Compass" shows coordinates and guides you back to your saved points without internet.

📦 Storage – rotation

So nothing goes bad



"First in, first out": new items go in at the back, you eat the old ones from the front first. Phone reminder on 1 March and 1 September: kit check.

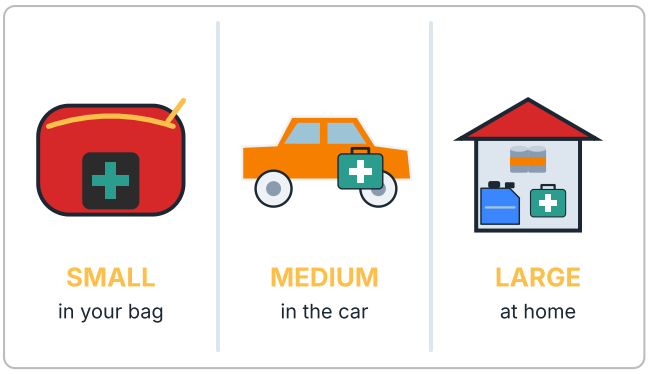
- Bottled water: in a dark cool place, not next to chemicals. Replace it as the date says.
- Food: "first in, first out". Eat from the stock and refill.
- Batteries out of devices. Power bank charging every 3 months.
- Medicines: check expiry dates every 6 months.
- Backpack: change clothes by season (March & September).

💡 Set a reminder in your phone calendar for 1 March and 1 September: "Survival kit check".

💡 Tips

💡 30 golden tips

From real experience



The best kit is the one you have with you: small in your bag, medium in the car, large at home.



Next to the bed: shoes and a torch. An earthquake at night means broken glass on the floor.

1. The best kit is the one you have WITH you when you need it. A small kit in your bag, a medium one in the car, a big one at home.
2. Don't save it "for when it happens". Use your gear once on a camping trip so you know it works.
3. Keep the fuel tank always above half.
4. Charge your phone every night, keep the powerbank always full.
5. Keep cash at home. Without power, cards and ATMs don't work.
6. Write the important phone numbers on paper.
7. Keep shoes and a torch next to the bed (earthquake at night = broken glass).
8. Keys in a fixed spot next to the door.
9. Learn where to shut off gas, water, power – and show everyone.
10. Take a first aid course. It is the most useful skill of your life.
11. Fix furniture to the wall.
12. Smoke and CO detector. Test every month.
13. Fill bottles with water in the empty spaces of the freezer.
14. Every time you go to the supermarket, buy 1–2 extra things for your stock. In a few months you have 2 weeks.
15. A whistle on every backpack and keyring. It costs very little, it saves lives.
16. Download offline maps of your area to your phone now.
17. Turn on Medical ID (iPhone: Health → Medical ID / Android: Emergency information) so it shows on the lock screen.
18. Pick a relative in another town as your "contact centre".
19. SMS gets through when calls don't.
20. Take photos of your home and belongings (for insurance/compensation).
21. If you leave home, leave a note: where you went, when.
22. Learn your nearest open assembly area and shelter.
23. Follow official instructions (112, Civil Protection), not rumours on social media.
24. In a crisis: first YOU are safe, then you help others (like the mask on the plane).
25. Panic is the biggest enemy. STOP – breathe – think.
26. Never touch unknown ammunition, fallen cables, or flood water with electricity in it.
27. No charcoal brazier, camping gas stove or generator inside the house. Ever.
28. Don't eat wild mushrooms.
29. Get to know your neighbours. In a disaster, the neighbour arrives first.
30. Practise with your family: "Earthquake now! Where do we go?". Twice a year.

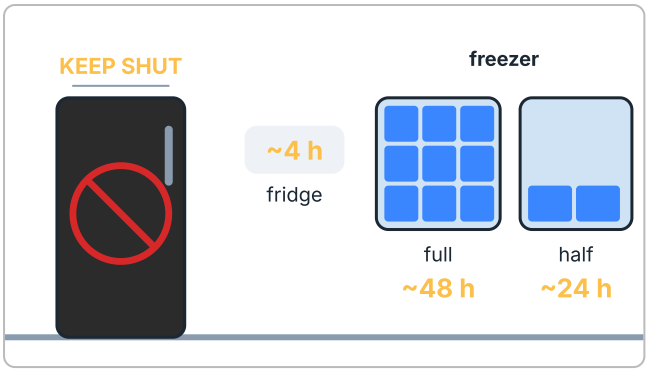
🧠 Powerful survival tricks

Small secrets that make a big difference

Before it hits (when a warning comes)

1. Fill the bathtub and containers with water.
2. Charge EVERYTHING: phones, powerbank, power station, flashlights, laptop.
3. Fill the fuel tank and withdraw cash (small notes).
4. Put bottles of water in the freezer: they keep the fridge cold and then become drinking water.
5. Set the fridge and freezer to the coldest setting.

Fridge without power

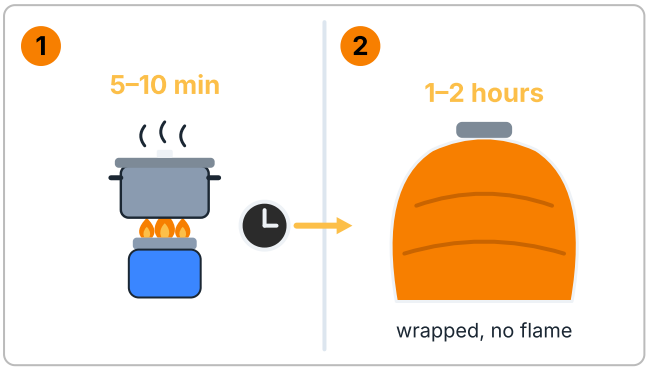


Do not open the fridge. Closed it stays cold ~4 hours, a full freezer ~48 hours, half full ~24.

- DO NOT open it. A closed fridge stays cold ~4 hours. A full freezer ~48 hours, half full ~24.
- Order of eating: fridge first, then freezer, canned and dry food LAST.

⚠ Meat, fish, milk, eggs more than 2 hours in the heat: throw them away. If in doubt, throw it out. Diarrhoea in a crisis is dangerous.

Cooking with half the fuel



Retained-heat cooking: boil 5–10 minutes, put the lid on and wrap the pot in a sleeping bag or blankets. It cooks by itself in 1–2 hours.

- Retained-heat cooking: boil rice, pasta or pulses 5–10 minutes, put the lid on and wrap the pot in a sleeping bag or blankets. It cooks by itself in 1–2 hours. You save up to 2/3 of the gas.
- Soak pulses overnight: half the boiling time.
- Pressure cooker = less fuel and less water.
- Always use a lid. Without a lid you use twice the gas.
- Warm a can in the sun or on the bonnet of a running car (opened slightly, not sealed).

Phone battery

- In the family: ONE phone on at a time, the others off. Swap every few hours.
- In the cold the battery “drops”: keep the phone inside your jacket, close to your body. When sleeping, inside the sleeping bag.
- An old phone with offline maps, this app and a charger = a spare in a bag in the backpack.

The car is a tool

- Shelter, heating, charger, radio, lights for signalling.
- Heating: engine 10 minutes every hour, with the window slightly open.

⚠ Snow or mud in the exhaust = carbon monoxide inside the car. Clear it before starting the engine.

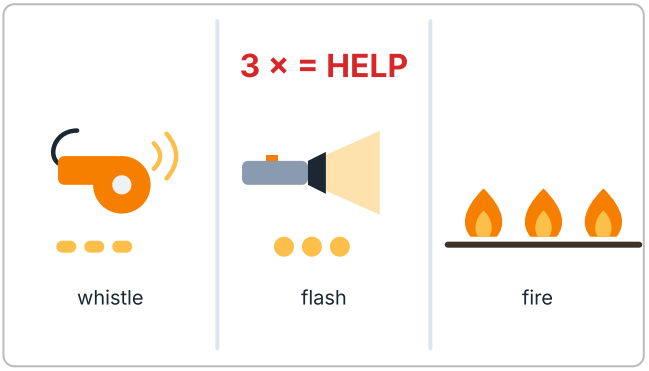
House without heating

- Insulation from household items: cardboard on the floor, blankets on the windows, foam or bubble wrap on the glass (spray with water and it sticks).
- Pitch a tent inside the room: a small space = it warms up from breath and bodies.
- Flowerpot-and-candle “heater”: gives very little heat and is a fire risk. Better: body, sleeping bag, one room.

Water and hygiene

- Hand sanitiser BEFORE eating and AFTER the toilet. In disasters diarrhoea kills more people than we think.
- Baby wipes = a bath without water.
- A hanging bottle with a hole in the cap = a tap for hand washing with very little water.
- Washing water → toilet. Nothing is thrown away.

Communication and searching



3 whistle blasts, 3 flashes or 3 fires mean «HELP» all over the world.

- If you leave home: write with a marker on paper on the door “We are 3, all OK, gone to ..., date”.

- SMS instead of a call. Keep it short: “OK. Home. Tomorrow 10:00 at the meeting point.”
- 3 whistle blasts / 3 flashes / 3 fires = HELP all over the world.

Health

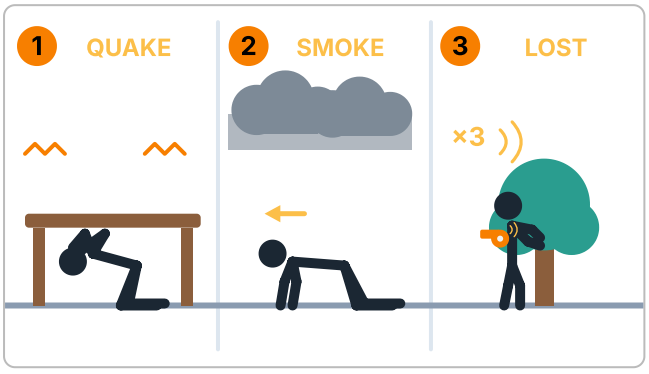
- Always keep 2 weeks’ extra supply of the medicines you take daily (talk to your doctor).
- Spare prescription glasses in the backpack. Without glasses many people cannot do anything.
- Keep on paper: blood group, allergies, medicines, phone numbers.

Mind

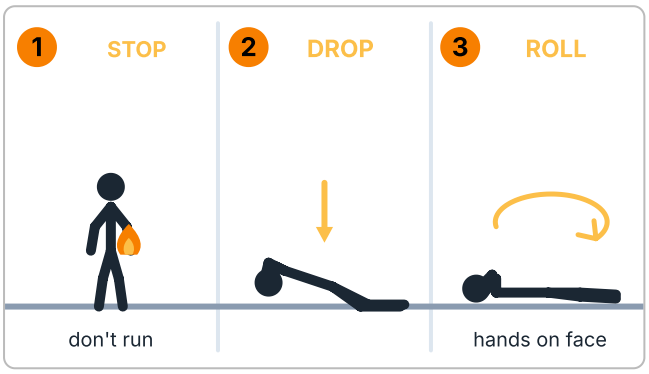
- A daily schedule: times for food, water, sleep, chores. Routine keeps you calm.
- Give children jobs (“you are in charge of the flashlights”). They feel useful and are less afraid.
- Help your neighbour. In crises neighbourhoods survive, not loners.

🧒 For kids

Simple words for little heroes



Earthquake: under the table and hold on. Smoke: I go low, on hands and knees. Lost: I stay put, hug a tree, whistle 3 times.



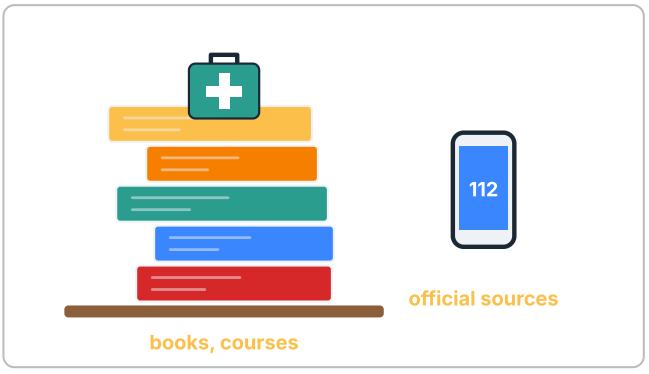
If your clothes catch fire: stop – drop – roll, with hands over your face.

- Earthquake: "I drop, I get under the table, I hold on". Then I go out only with a grown-up.
- Fire: "I go outside, I don't hide, I don't go back in". Never under the bed or in a wardrobe.
- Smoke: "I go low, on hands and knees".
- My clothes caught fire: "Stop – drop – roll".
- I am lost: "I stay where I am, I hug a tree, I whistle 3 times". I am not afraid of the people looking for me, even if they shout my name.
- I found something strange made of metal: "I DON'T touch it, I walk away, I tell a grown-up".
- Phone: "I call 112 and say my name, where I am, what happened".
- I know Mum's or Dad's phone number by heart.
- I know my family's meeting place.

💡 Make it a game: "Who finds the safe spot in the room first?".

📚 Books and sources

To learn more



Learn more from official sources (Civil Protection, 112), first-aid courses and good survival books.

- Greek Civil Protection – advice for each hazard: civilprotection.gov.gr
- 112 Greece: 112.gr
- Hellenic Red Cross – first aid courses.
- EKAB (Greek National Ambulance Service) – CPR courses.
- "SAS Survival Handbook" – John "Lofty" Wiseman (the classic SAS survival guide).
- "Bushcraft 101" – Dave Canterbury.
- "98.6 Degrees: The Art of Keeping Your Ass Alive" – Cody Lundin (cold/overheating).
- "Deep Survival" – Laurence Gonzales (the psychology of survival).

- European Union guidance on 72-hour preparedness (Preparedness Union Strategy).
- Preparedness guides from Sweden "Om krisen eller kriget kommer" and Finland (72tuntia.fi).
- Ready.gov (USA) and Get Prepared (Canada) – for nuclear/radiological.
- Seafarers: SOLAS LSA Code, IAMSAR Vol. III (on board), the ship's life-saving appliances instructions.

📡 Distress signals – SOS – Morse

🆘 SOS = ··· ——— ···

3 short – 3 long – 3 short. With a torch, mirror, whistle, knocking on a pipe or wall. Pause and repeat.

Rule of 3: 3 of anything = distress (3 whistle blasts, 3 flashes, 3 fires in a triangle, 3 piles of stones).

⏱ Morse timing

dot = 1 unit · dash = 3 · gap inside a letter = 1 · between letters = 3 · between words = 7.

Learn by heart: **SOS**, **OK** (——– ·–), **HELP**.

Latin letters & numbers

0	———	**8**	———··	**G**	——·	**O**	———	**W**	·——
1	·———	**9**	———·	**H**	····	**P**	·——·	**X**	—··—
2	··——	**A**	·—	**I**	··	**Q**	——·—	**Y**	—·——
3	···——	**B**	—···	**J**	·———	**R**	·—·	**Z**	——··
4	····—	**C**	—·—·	**K**	—·—	**S**	···		
5	·····	**D**	—··	**L**	·—··	**T**	—		
6	—····	**E**	·	**M**	——	**U**	··—		
7	——···	**F**	··—·	**N**	—·	**V**	···—		

Greek letters

A	·—	**H**	····	**N**	—·	**T**	—
B	—···	**Θ**	—·—·	**Ξ**	—··—	**Y**	—·——
Γ	——·	**I**	··	**O**	———	**Φ**	··—·
Δ	—··	**K**	—·—	**Π**	·——·	**X**	————
E	·	**Λ**	·—··	**P**	·—·	**Ψ**	——·—
Z	——··	**M**	——	**Σ**	···	**Ω**	·——

Ground-to-air signals (helicopter / plane)

Make them BIG (at least 3 m), in the open, in a contrasting colour: branches, stones, clothes, a trench in snow.

Sign	Means
V	We need assistance
X	We need medical help
N	No
Y	Yes
→	We went this way

Body signals (to a helicopter)

🙌 Both arms up (Y)

«YES – we need help, land here».

🙋 One arm up, one down (N)

«NO – we don't need help». Don't do it by mistake when waving!

💡 By day: a mirror or CD for flashes, bright cloth, smoke (green leaves on a fire = white smoke). At night: torch, fire. Whistle: carries much further than your voice and doesn't tire you.